

THE MARKETS ON THURSDAY

	change
Sensex	76,631.6 ↑ 93.3
Nifty	23,775.1 ↑ 22.3
Nifty Futures ¹	23,863.3 ↑ 86.2
Dollar	₹92.7 ↓ ₹92.6 ²
Euro	₹108.2 ↓ ₹108.1 ²
Brent Crude (\$/bbl)	95.8 ↓ 94.9 ²
Gold (10gm) ³	₹1,49,337.0 ↓ ₹1,49,290.0

¹ Over previous close. ² December Premium on Nifty Spot. ³ Spot price. ⁴ At 3pm IST. ⁵ Market rate exclusive of GST. Source: BSE

Business Standard

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CDSO moves to fast-track foreign drug import approvals



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10 years of UPI: Many records but limited incentives slow growth

POLITICS & PUBLIC AFFAIRS 7

Assam, Puducherry register record voter turnout; Kerala gains



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IN BRIEF

RBI paper suggests 1-hr lag for digital payments

To curb rising fraudulence in digital payments, the Reserve Bank of India, in a discussion paper released on Thursday, has suggested measures such as introducing a requirement of one hour delay for digital payments worth over ₹10,000 to be credited to a beneficiary's account. Among other measures suggested is additional authentication by "trusted individuals" for vulnerable users, a tighter scrutiny of accounts getting large credits, and expanded customer-controlled safeguards.

Banking system liquidity at 4-yr high

Liquidity in the banking system — as indicated by banks parking their excess funds in the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI's) liquidity adjustment facility (LAF) window — hit around a four-year high on the back of maturity of government securities (G-Secs), said market participants. Net liquidity was in a surplus of ₹4.57 trillion on Wednesday, the highest since May 19, 2022, the latest data by the RBI showed.

India-US trade talks to resume this month

An Indian delegation will be travelling to Washington later this month to further discussions on the interim trade pact with the United States in February, US Ambassador to India and Special Envoy to South and Central Asia, Sergio Gora said on Thursday. The travel dates are currently under discussion. This will be the first in-person meeting of the negotiating team, after its visit to Washington DC was postponed over two months ago.

DAY AFTER RELIEF RALLY

Mkts slip, crude spikes as US-Iran truce hopes fade

SUNDAR SETHURAMAN
Mumbai, 9 April

A day after benchmark indices jumped nearly 4 per cent and the Sensex posted its best session in over five years, domestic equity markets slipped back on Thursday as global risk appetite weakened and optimism over the US-Iran ceasefire faded.

The Sensex fell 931 points, or 1.2 per cent, to close at 76,631, while the Nifty 50 declined 222 points, or 0.9 per cent, to settle at 23,775. The drop marked the steepest single-day decline for both indices since March 30.

Brent crude prices edged up to about \$99 a barrel but recovered to \$95.80 (at 8.50 pm IST) after Israel said it would start direct negotiations with Lebanon. The rupee snapped its five-day winning streak and government bond yields climbed again.

The rupee weakened to 92.94 per dollar intraday before recovering slightly, likely aided by the Reserve Bank of India's intervention via dollar sales. It settled at 92.66, compared with the previous close of 92.58.

The yield on the benchmark 10-year government bond rose 6 basis points to settle at 6.96 per cent.

Broader markets were more resilient, with smallcap and midcap indices ending in the green. As a result, the total market capitalisation of BSE-listed firms slipped only marginally, down around ₹72,000 crore to about ₹44.8 trillion. Investor sentiment turned cautious after Washington and Tehran announced each other of violating the ceasefire announced a day before, following nearly six weeks of hostilities. A key point of contention is whether the truce also covers Israel's ongoing military operations against Hezbollah in Lebanon.

Turn to Page 7

WEST ASIA CONFLICT

EDIT: UNEASY CEASEFIRE

Oil uptick

Brent crude (\$/bbl)

94.87 95.80

Oil (10gm)

₹1,49,337.0

Oil (10gm)

₹1,49,290.0

Oil (10gm)

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Call on Tata Sons listing likely soon

NIVEDITA MOOKERJI
& MANOJIT SAHA
New Delhi/Mumbai, 9 April

A decision is likely to be taken soon on whether Tata Sons, the holding company of the salt-to-software conglomerate, will get listed. It is learnt. At a time when Tata Trusts — majority owner of Tata Sons with a 66 per cent stake — is being rocked by controversies, a stocks market listing of the holding company is expected to bring stability to the group. Sources close to the development pointed out.

While there are indications that the status of Tata Sons as

an upper-layer non-banking finance company (NBFC) may be on the table, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has not commented on any specific company issue.

A questionnaire sent to the RBI on the matter remained unanswered until the time of going to press.

The RBI had in 2022 categorised 15 entities, including Tata Sons, as upper-layer NBFCs, mandating them to list by September 30, 2025. Tata Sons had subsequently, in a request to the RBI, sought to surrender its Core Investment Company (CIC) registration by becoming net debt-free to

WHILE THERE ARE INDICATIONS THAT THE STATUS OF TATA SONS AS AN UPPER-LAYER NBFC MAY BE ON THE TABLE, THE RBI HAS NOT COMMENTED ON ANY SPECIFIC COMPANY ISSUE

avoid the mandatory listing requirement. The RBI has not made any public comment on the subject even as Tata Sons has remained a private company beyond the mandated IPO (initial public offering) date of September 30, 2025.

On Wednesday, during the post-policy conference, RBI

Governor Sanjay Malhotra said a revised framework for classification of NBFCs would come out very soon. Earlier, the RBI categorised NBFCs into four layers based on a scale-based regulation framework, rolling it out in October 2022 for stricter regulations.

Since then, the RBI released the names of 15 upper-layer NBFCs every year. The last list came in January 2025, when the RBI said, "Inclusion of Tata Sons Private Limited in the list of NBFC-UL is without prejudice to the outcome of its application for de-registration, which is under examination."

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TCS net profit grew over 12% in Q4

SHIVANI SHINDE
Mumbai, 9 April

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) on Thursday kicked off the fourth-quarter earnings season for India's information technology (IT) players by beating estimates, even as macroeconomic challenges continued to impact the industry.

The company reported a total contract value (TCV) of \$12 billion in the January-March quarter (Q4FY26) and a total order book of \$40.7 billion, stepping into FY27 with strong deal wins.

India's top IT services company's net profit rose 12.2 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y) to ₹13,718 crore. On a sequential basis, net profit after tax increased 28 per cent from ₹10,657 crore. Revenue for the quarter grew 9.6 per cent Y-o-Y to ₹70,698 crore, while sequential growth stood at 5.4 per cent. Ac-

"IF THIS (GEOPOLITICAL DEVELOPMENT) LEADS TO FURTHER SUPPLY-CHAIN DISRUPTION OR ANY OTHER SECONDARY ISSUE, IT MAY HAVE SOME IMPACT"

K Krithivasan,
MD & CEO, TCS



According to Bloomberg estimates, revenue was expected to be ₹69,019 crore and profit after tax at ₹13,551 crore. The Mumbai-headquartered company, which does not provide forward revenue guidance, said its annualised artificial intelligence (AI) revenue reached \$2.3 billion in Q4FY26, up from \$1.8 billion in Q3FY26. Turn to Page 7

Ending FY26 on a high

TCS is the first major Indian IT company to report Q4 results

	Q4FY26 (₹ cr)	Q-o-Q	Y-o-Y
Revenues	70,698	5.4	9.6
Other income	757	-32.3	-26.4
Net profit*	13,718	28.7	12.2
PBT	18,362	5.1	11.9
PBDIT	20,033	3.3	11.2

PBT: Profit before tax; PBDIT: Profit before interest, depreciation, and taxes. *Attributable to shareholders of the company. Q3FY26 net profit had seen exceptional expenses, including statutory impact of new Labour Codes of ₹2,025 crore and provision towards legal claim of ₹1,070 crore. Source: Company

TCS announces salary hike, headcount continues to fall



War may weigh on India Inc's Q4 results

KRISHNA KANT
Mumbai, 9 April

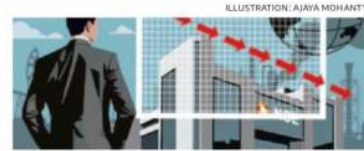
Corporate earnings during January-March 2026 (Q4FY26) are likely to feel the pinch of the West Asia conflict and the resulting turmoil in global energy markets.

The combined net profits of the Nifty 50 companies are likely to grow 4.2 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y) in Q4FY26, as against 10 per cent in Q3FY26 and 7.6 per cent in Q4FY25, according to estimates by various brokerages.

If the estimates turn out correct, this will be the slo-

west earnings growth rate for the index companies in the last seven quarters.

According to brokerage estimates, the earnings slowdown is likely to be led by companies such as Interflex, Globe Aviation (IndiGo), Dr Reddy's Lab, Cipla, Hindalco Industries, Coal India, SBI Life Insurance, Wipro, and NTPC. At the other end of the spectrum, the brokerages expect high double-digit growth from Eternal (Zomato food delivery app), Tata Steel, Titan Company, JSW Steel, Mahindra & Mahindra, and Tech Mahindra, among others. Turn to Page 7



In Chennai's auto nerve centre, Ambattur, conflict ripples through supply chains, delaying deliveries, testing small manufacturers' resilience

Detroit of Asia sputters as LPG dries up, input costs spike, labour thins

SHINE JACOB
Ambattur, 9 April

The restless symphony of clanging metal invites an outsider to the Ambattur Industrial Estate, widely considered South Asia's largest small-scale



Director Ravilla Sekhar was already in discussion with his staff regarding the stock of commercial liquefied petroleum gas (LPG). A unit that used to run on a stock of 10 days of LPG is now in a "hand-to-mouth" situation. Heat-treatment units are the most

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industrial estate, covering 1,430 acres. As one moves deep into the industrial hub, the air is dense with a tang of paint, grease, oil, and chemicals — a signature smell of the region.

The majority of around 1,800 units are key suppliers who play a crucial role in maintaining Chennai's fame as the Detroit of Asia, as the city houses over 30 per cent of India's automotive industry and 35 per cent of its auto components industry. However, the region that braved Covid-19, floods, and even the goods and services tax



Workers at a unit of Delcosys, a major supplier of auto parts in Ambattur
PHOTO: DELCOSYS

blues is now facing a crisis beyond its control — the war in West Asia.

When fuel becomes a fault line
When *Business Standard* reached Chennai Auto Heat Industry, a heat treatment unit at Pattaravakkam, its

affected industry in the Ambattur area due to the crisis. "Earlier, we used to consume around 150 cylinders a month. In March, it came down to 100. In April, we are just managing to run the operations. This is one industry that needs LPG, and there is no other option before us," Sekhar says.

Chennai Auto Heat Industry is a Tier-III supplier to one of the largest carmakers in the country, with its manufacturing unit in Chennai, and also an iconic two-wheeler brand with strong export numbers.

Sekhar's company is trying every weapon in the armour to brave the crisis, but with little result.

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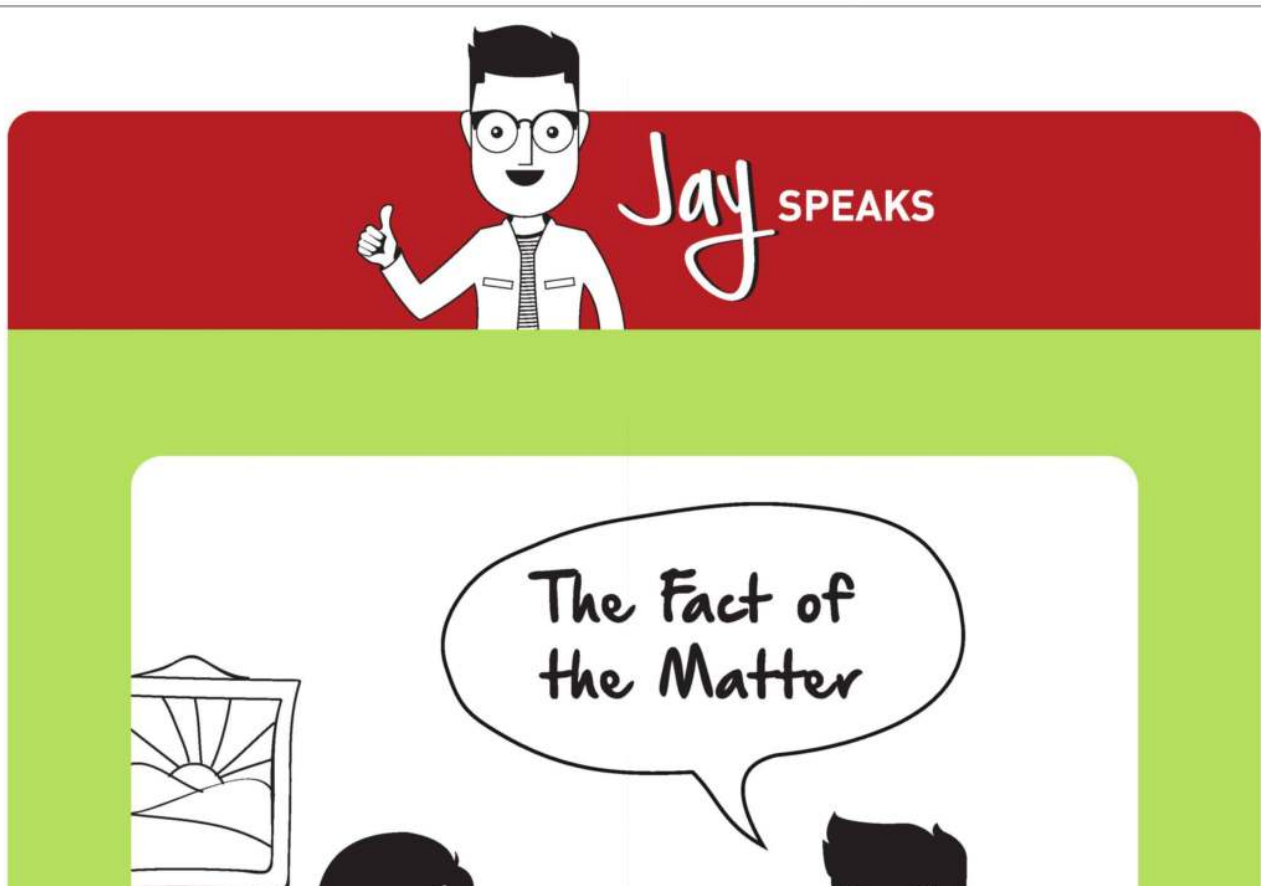
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2 COMPANIES

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STOCKS IN THE NEWS

■ Anand Rathi Wealth

Q4FY26 PAT grows 28 per cent Y-o-Y to ₹92 crore
 ₹ 3,553.7 CLOSE
 ▲ 4.6% up*

■ BEML

Partners with DMRC to pursue opportunities for rail and Metro projects
 ₹ 1,602.2 CLOSE
 ▲ 1.0% up*

■ Persistent Systems

Launches merchant risk management solution powered by Databricks AI
 ₹ 5,472.6 CLOSE
 ▲ 1.8% up*

■ Dilip Buildcon

N wins ₹268 crore Ged Barrage project in EPC mode
 ₹ 429.8 CLOSE
 ▲ 1.0% up*

■ HBL Engineering

Bags ₹84 crore order from Patiala Loco Works for on-board Kavach equipment
 ₹ 722.4 CLOSE
 ▲ 0.5% up*

*OVER PREVIOUS CLOSE

Merc-Benz drives past war turmoil with Q1 India growth

SOHINI DAS
Mumbai, 9 April

Mercedes-Benz India posted sequential growth in the January-March quarter (Q1) of 2026, defying the disruption caused by the West Asia crisis, volatile financial markets, and rising input costs, as demand for its top-end luxury and electric vehicle (EV) models offset pressure in the entry-level segment.

The German luxury carmaker sold 5,131 vehicles in Q1, up 7 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y) from 4,775 units a year earlier, and also 5 per cent higher quarter-on-quarter (Q-o-Q) than the roughly 4,800 units sold in the preceding October-December quarter, according to company data. The Q1 performance capped Mercedes-Benz India's best ever financial year, with 2025-26 (FY26) sales rising to 19,363 units.

"We are the only luxury brand to have registered back-to-back quarter growth of plus 5 per cent," Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer (MD&CEO) Santosh Iyer said, underlining that the company had expanded volumes despite geopolitical tensions, exchange rate deterioration, and two rounds of price increases.

The resilience came largely from Mercedes-Benz's premium mix. Its top-end luxury segment — which includes Maybach, AMG, S-Class, and EQS models — rose 25



Full throttle

- Company retained 5,131 units in Q1 2026, marking 7% Y-o-Y growth and a 5% Q-o-Q increase
- Also, recorded its best ever annual sales of 19,363 units in FY26, up from 18,928 in FY25
- The top-end luxury segment accounted for 27% of the company's total FY26 sales
- BEVs made up 20% of all top-end segment sales in FY26

per cent in Q1 and 16 per cent for FY26, contributing 27 per cent to total sales. Battery EVs accounted for 20 per cent of all top-end vehicles sold, with the EQS SUV emerging as the company's highest-selling luxury EV in India.

Iyer said customers continued to buy because of strong product appeal rather than macro sentiment. "Product is what excites customers," he said, citing strong advanced bookings for the newly launched V-Class and the soon-to-be-launched electric CLA.

Iyer said order intake remained robust in the quarter, though some deliveries were deferred because of shipping and launch timelines.

The company's performance also reflects a deliberate strategic choice: prioritising profitability and brand equity over chasing headline volumes in a discount-heavy market. While Mercedes-Benz's entry luxury segment

declined 18 per cent in FY26 amid aggressive pricing by rivals, the company has refused to dilute specifications or deepen discounts to protect volumes.

Iyer said: "We cannot achieve that by decontesting products or by deep discounting, because it affects the residual value of the car. What we will not do is discount deeply, neither will we compromise on product substance."

This "value over volume" positioning comes at a time when rivals are expanding aggressively in lower-price luxury categories to widen their customer funnel. Mercedes-Benz is instead betting that long-term brand aspiration and stronger retention in core and top-end segments will protect margins and strengthen pricing power.

Mercedes-Benz's entry luxury models are priced between ₹45 lakh and ₹60 lakh, core luxury vehicles are priced in the range of

₹65 lakh to ₹1.2 crore, and the top-end vehicles are priced ₹1.2 crore and above.

However, currency weakness and cost inflation remain overhangs on the sales outlook. Since January, the rupee has depreciated by roughly 2.5 per cent against the euro, increasing the landed cost of euro-denominated imports such as CKD kits, CBUs, and components. Mercedes-Benz raised prices by 2 per cent in January and again in April, and Iyer indicated another increase may come in Q3.

"What we have announced is a 2 per cent Q-o-Q price increase so that we do not pass on the shock in one go to the market. This will surely not mitigate all cost impact... we will not be able to pass on everything to the market," he said. Even so, Mercedes-Benz says demand remains intact. The company sees another strong quarter ahead, although Iyer cautioned that geopolitical risks remain fluid. "At this stage, we are quite optimistic of continued growth even in the next quarter," he said.

With 20 new outlets planned in 2026 and over ₹450 crore committed by franchise partners toward network expansion, Mercedes-Benz is doubling down on customer reach — not to chase discount-led volume, but to deepen service access and reinforce its premium positioning in an increasingly competitive luxury market.

VW group targets 5% India PV mkt share by decade-end

SOHINI DAS
Mumbai, 9 April

Skoda Auto Volkswagen India is targeting a 5 per cent share of India's passenger vehicle market by the turn of the decade, banking on fresh product interventions — including alternate fuel vehicles — and opening up to entering the high-volume sub-4 metre SUV segment, where group brand Skoda has already found traction with the Kodyak.

The group had 2.34 per cent market share in India's passenger vehicle segment in 2025-26 (FY26), according to Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations (Fada) data. "Today we are below 3 per cent, typically between 2.5 per cent and 2.7 per cent on a monthly basis," Piyush Arora, managing director (MD) and chief executive officer (CEO) of Skoda Auto Volkswagen India, said. "To reach 5 per cent, we need more product interventions, and those will come in ICE (internal combustion engine) as well as alternate fuel formats before the turn of the decade."

The company did not commit to a timeline for a Volkswagen-branded sub-4 metre SUV, but Arora indicated the segment remains under evaluation. "It is a compelling segment because it is almost close to 20-30 per cent of the overall market, and we continue to evaluate that segment," he said, suggesting the group sees room to expand beyond its current SUV line-up.

For now, however, Volkswagen's



Piyush Arora, MD & CEO of Skoda Auto Volkswagen India, said the firm would need more product interventions to meet the target

immediate focus is on scaling volumes through the Taigun, its mid-sized SUV, rather than filling lower-segment portfolio gaps.

Nitin Kohli, brand director, Volkswagen Passenger Cars India, said the strategy is to extract more growth from existing India 2.0 products, led by Taigun and Virtus.

"Any new model intervention in the industry typically gives growth in the range of 18-22 per cent. Our attempt is to do better than that with the new model we have today," Kohli said, outlining the company's volume expectations from the refreshed Taigun.

Volkswagen has positioned Taigun as central to its premiumisation strategy. The model covers a substantial part of the addressable SUV

market and will remain the volume driver in the near term, Kohli said. The company recently began production of the updated Taigun at its Pune plant, where Skoda Auto Volkswagen India crossed cumulative output of 143,000 units of the model.

The group's future portfolio expansion will not be limited to ICE vehicles. Arora said alternate fuel products — including EVs and potentially CNG — will form part of the roadmap before 2030. On EVs, he said India remains at an early adoption stage with around 4 per cent penetration, but Volkswagen expects that to rise into double digits by decade-end.

The company is "actively evaluating opportunities," in the CNG vehicle space, even as it does not align with Volkswagen's customer profile, Arora said. This is because the fuel now accounts for 19-20 per cent of India's passenger vehicle market, he added.

Exports remain a strategic pillar for the group, with around 30 per cent of total production from India shipped overseas. Arora said West Asia contributes to exports, though it is not the largest regional market, with Mexico, South Africa, North Africa and Southeast Asia accounting for bigger shares.

The conflict in West Asia, however, is beginning to create pressure on logistics and input costs. "We have seen some disruption in material movement, but because of lead times, the impact may only be seen in future periods. At this point, our operations are not affected," Arora said.

IN BRIEF

'Minor' fire breaks out at Terminal 1 of Mumbai international airport

A fire broke out at Terminal 1 of the Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport (CSMIA) in Mumbai on Thursday evening and it was brought under control swiftly, officials said. The airport operations remained unaffected and there were no casualties, they added. A short circuit caused the fire, which was reported at 6.10 pm, and it was brought under control by the emergency response teams within minutes, the CSMIA spokesperson said. He described the fire as "minor". There were no casualties, said civic officials.

Royal Enfield's EV brand Flying Flea launches 1st motorcycle

Flying Flea, the new electric mobility brand from Royal Enfield, on Thursday embarked on its journey with the launch of its first motorcycle, the Flying Flea C6. Hardcored to be agile, visceral and resilient, the FF C6 will be available from Friday at the first Flying Flea store in Jayanagar, Bengaluru. Bookings for the FF C6 will begin at 12 pm on Friday, with deliveries set to begin at the end of May. With a top speed of 115 kmph and over 400 Newton meters of wheel torque, all within a lightweight 124kg, the FF C6 offers swift acceleration while maintaining stability through lean-angle sensing, ABS, traction control, and rider aids like tip-over alert and live location sharing. Available in Storm Black and Flea Green colourways, the FF C6 is priced at ₹2.79 lakh (ex-showroom) and ₹1.99 lakh with battery-as-a-service option. Priced at ₹3.91 kWh battery, the motorcycle offers seamless connectivity via WiFi, Bluetooth and 4G, along with remote monitoring.

'India's real estate recorded \$4.3 billion PE deals in FY26'

India's real estate capital markets rebounded in FY26 after two subdued years, with 60 private equity (PE) deals worth \$4.3 billion, returning investment levels to those last seen in FY22, according to Anarock. Deal value rose 13 per cent over FY24 (\$3.8 billion) and 16 per cent over FY25 (\$3.7 billion), while the number of transactions increased to 60, the highest in seven years, from 41 deals in FY25 and 51 in FY24. Investments had stood at \$4.3 billion in FY22 and \$4.4 billion in FY23. "India's real estate capital markets have moved from a period of concentration and caution to one of breadth and conviction," said Shubhit Agarwal, chief executive officer, Anarock Capital. He noted that, unlike FY24 and FY25 — when single large transaction accounted for 37 per cent and 41 per cent of deal value — the largest deal in FY26 contributed only 9 per cent, reflecting improved market depth. Equity investments accounted for 77 per cent of total deal value, while debt made up the remaining 23 per cent.

TCS announces annual salary hike

2,356 staffers added at end of Q4 FY26, overall headcount down by 23,460

SHIVANI SHINDE
Mumbai, 9 April

India's largest IT services firm Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) announced that it is implementing annual salary hikes. These would be applicable from April 1 across grades. However, the quantum of hikes could not be ascertained.

Sudeep Kunnammal, chief HR officer, said: "We have announced annual increments to all eligible employees across (21-32) grades effective April 1 with top performance getting a double-digit increase. In Q4, we continued to invest in a future-ready workforce with strong additions across experienced talent and campus hires."

Kunnammal added that building an AI first culture and equipping people with AI skills remained a key priority in FY26 and will continue into FY27, "as we align closely with our customers' evolving needs." He also said that TCS will continue to hire freshers and experienced people with a focus on AI, data, enterprise solutions, software engineering, cloud, cybersecurity, and digital engineering. "In FY26, we also hired

Wipro mulls share buyback next week

Wipro is considering a share buyback proposal when it announces its Q4 results next week, the company said on Thursday.

The shares of the company, India's fourth-largest IT services provider, have dropped nearly 23 per cent in the last three months, in line with its peers, as investors remained worried about the impact of AI on the future of services companies. The macro uncertainties and war have not helped either as earnings forecast have become bleak.

"The board of directors of the company will be considering a proposal to buyback equity shares of the Company at its meeting scheduled to be held over April 15-16, 2026," the company said in a filing with the BSE. This will be the first time in nearly three years that Wipro will do a buyback. The last one was in June 2023.

AVIK DAS

over 750 employees with deep advisory and consulting expertise. We stepped up our investments in talent development initiative as well," he added.

The total headcount of the company at the end of the fiscal year was at \$84,519. On year-on-year (Y-o-Y) basis headcount continued to fall. The headcount at the end of FY25 was 6,07,979. However, on a quarter basis, at the end of Q4 FY26 the company added 2,356 people.

The company said that it has a total of 270,000 employees with higher proficiency in AI and ML. In FY25 the company had delayed salary hikes, effective September 2025, this was after a delay of five months. The quantum of salary hikes was in the range of 4.5 per cent to 7 per cent. While high performers continued to

get double digit increases.

TCS extends tie-up with UK's M&S TCS on Thursday announced the renewal of its multi-year strategic partnership with Marks & Spencer (M&S). As part of this continuing partnership, TCS will support M&S as it transforms to become an omnichannel, data driven retailer supported by globally best-in-class modern technologies.

TCS will utilise AI in its transformation approach — supported by its extensive domain expertise and one of the world's largest AI talent pools. This will support future-readiness, provide right base for long term growth, and create superior customer experience. The financial detail of the deal were not disclosed. Sacha Berendji, Operations Director, Marks & Spencer, said, "Technology transformation is a key strategic priority for M&S as we invest for growth."

Hyatt plans five new hotels in India in 2026

AKSHARA SRINIVASTAVA
New Delhi, 9 April

New York Stock Exchange (NYSE)-listed Hyatt Hotels plans to open five new hotels in India this year while keeping an eye out for inorganic growth opportunities.

"India remains our top priority market in the Asia Pacific region. Over the past several years, we focused a lot on China, but India is at the top now. We believe there's different types of growth to be seen here — organic and even inorganic opportunities where we can look at partnering with players to leapfrog," said David Udell, group president, Asia Pacific, Hyatt, during a select media round table at the sideline of the three-day Hotel Investment Conference South Asia (HICSA) being held in Mumbai.

"We acknowledge the talent that exists in India. It is not just about doing it all yourself. We are looking to collaborate and create something differentiated in the market. We can set up a fund here wherein we can also invest like we have done in Japan, and we can also look at existing properties," said Stephen Ho, president, Greater China and growth, Asia Pacific, Hyatt.

Speaking about the impact of the military conflict in West Asia on global travel, Udell said, "Several countries in the APAC region have been severely impacted by the war in terms of arrivals, but India has a very strong domestic market which has been a silver lining during this time."

He added, "The exciting thing about



OVER THE PAST SEVERAL YEARS, WE FOCUSED A LOT ON CHINA, BUT INDIA IS AT THE TOP NOW

David Udell
Group president, Asia Pacific, Hyatt

India is that it has people with higher discretionary incomes and an expanding middle class which is exploring the country, which has been a big area of opportunity for us."

The company is adopting a three-pronged 2030 Elevate Strategy, which will include elevating the company's brand offerings, elevating talent within the company, and elevating technology to help drive efficiencies.

"We are very bullish on India. The company's significant growth ambitions and culture is what attracted me to the company," said Vikas Chawla, the company's newly appointed president, India and Southwest Asia.

India's e-retail aisles buzz again, market hits \$66 billion

PEERZADA ABRAR
Bengaluru, 9 April

India's online retail market closed 2025 on a stronger footing, with electronic retail (e-retail) gross merchandise value (GMV) reaching \$65.66 billion, up 19-21 per cent in value terms, according to "How India Shops Online 2026", a report by Bain & Company in collaboration with Flipkart.

In 2025, private consumption growth rose from 8 per cent (2022-24) to 10.5 per cent, helped by goods and services tax cuts, income-tax relief, easing inflation, and lower lending rates.

Even as e-retail posted solid growth, the broader retail sector's march towards



towns and GenZ," said Shyam Unnikrishnan, managing partner at Bain & Company. "As India's gross domestic product (GDP) per capita approaches the \$4,000 inflection point — where discretionary spending has historically accelerated in other emerging markets — it will provide further tailwinds. The next five years should unlock the next wave of growth."

Consumption picks up

- E-retail at \$65.66 billion in 2025, growth back at 19-21%
- With nearly 300 million shoppers, market size has doubled in five years
- GenZ drives the surge, powering half of new demand
- Tier-II markets contribute 50% of incremental orders
- Quick commerce at \$10-11 billion, scaling rapidly towards \$70 billion estimated by 2030

GenZ has emerged as a key cohort, accounting for 40-45 per cent of e-retail shoppers and contributing 50 per cent of incremental orders in 2025, with spend per shopper growing 2.5x faster than other cohorts in metros.

Growth is also becoming more geographically distributed, with Tier-II cities contributing about 50 per cent of

incremental online orders in 2025, despite shopper penetration of just 25-30 per cent of internet users (versus 45-50 per cent in metro and Tier-I markets). Despite the expansion, India's e-retail penetration remains low at 1.6 per cent of GDP, compared with 13-14 per cent in China and 4-5 per cent in Indonesia, pointing to a long runway ahead. The report projects the market will reach \$70-\$80 billion by 2030, sustaining about 20 per cent annual growth, driven by rising shopper penetration and higher spend per user.

The 10-minute economy

India has emerged as a global leader in quick commerce (qcom), with 16-17 per cent of e-commerce GMV flowing through the channel — well ahead of most markets, including China.

The segment has doubled annually over the past two years, reaching \$10-11 billion GMV in 2025. It is projected to scale to \$65-70 billion by 2030, contributing 45-50 per cent of incremental e-retail GMV. Traditional e-retail, however, is expected to retain a 60-65 per cent share.

Qcom is also accelerating online grocery adoption. E-grocery penetration has grown fivefold since its launch and now accounts for nearly 1.5 per cent of the overall e-commerce market. The model serves a dual role — as a convenience channel for essentials (85-90 per cent of GMV) and a fulfilment layer for discretionary purchases. It now operates more than 7,000 micro-fulfilment centres across 200 cities, with two-thirds of new capacity concentrated in the top 10.

"Shopping behaviour here is distinct, with high-intent missions driving faster checkout velocity and higher conversions," said Manan Bhasin, partner at Bain & Company.

Balaji Thangarajan, chief product and technology officer at Flipkart, said scaling digital commerce in India is "a precision game, not just a volume game." This is why Flipkart's conversational engine is built for Indian context — by Indians, for Indians. By layering generative AI, we are ensuring a vernacular conversation for a customer in Muzaffarpur feels as effortless as one in a metro," he said.

Semaglutide generics hit Mounjaro sales, mkt share

Sales in March were ₹59 cr, 23% higher than ₹48 cr the previous month

SANKET KOUL
New Delhi, 9 April

The launch of several generic versions of diabetes and weight-loss drug semaglutide has dented March sales of rival drug Mounjaro (tirzepatide), according to data from market research firm Pharmack.

More than 23 versions of semaglutide entered the market within days of the molecule's patent expired on March 20 this year, boosting sales of drugs based on the molecule during the month.

Semaglutide sales rose about 23 per cent month-on-month (Mo-o-M) to ₹59 crore in March, from ₹48 crore in February. Its contribution to the glucagon-like peptide-1 (GLP-1) market also increased to 33 per cent last month, up from 25 per cent in February.

At the same time, tirzepatide, while still dominating the market with 64 per cent of total GLP-1 sales, saw monthly sales decline 15 per cent to ₹11.4 crore in March 2026, from ₹13.5 crore in February.

As a result, Eli Lilly, the maker of Mounjaro, saw its share in the GLP-1 market erode significantly, falling from



GLP-1 market scenario in 2026
Sales Value (in ₹ cr)

Note: Semaglutide lost patent on March 20, 2026
Source: Pharmack

Molecule	Jan	Feb	Mar
Tirzepatide	131	135	114
Semaglutide	41	48	59
Duraglutide	5	5	5
Liraglutide	3	3	3

Mounjaro best-selling drug in India in FY26 with ₹923 cr sales

Eli Lilly's anti-obesity drug Mounjaro (tirzepatide) became India's highest-selling drug by value in FY26, recording sales of ₹923 crore within a year of its launch in March 2025.

Data from market research firm Pharmack showed Mounjaro overtook long-time market leaders, including CSK's anti-infective brand Amant (₹96 crore in sales) and USV's anti-diabetic drug Glycomet (₹89 crore), pushing them to second and third place, respectively. The achievement is notable given the sharp price gap between Mounjaro and the other leading brands. Mounjaro is priced at ₹14,000 per month for the 2.5 mg dose and ₹17,500 per month for the 5 mg dose. **BS REPORTER**

"However, a normalised trend for March (multiplied by 3) shows that while there was almost a two-time jump in the number of units sold, we do not see the same phenomenon in value. This was primarily due to the extreme price cuts for generics," said Sheetal Sapale, vice president (commercial) at Pharmack.

The lower pricing of generics has, however, created a divergence between sales value and unit sales in the semaglutide segment.

Since the generics were launched only on March 21, they influenced sales for just 10 days in the month.

Distributors' body writes to PM on Zepto's IPO, flags its impact on trade

SHARLEEN D'SOUZA
Mumbai, 9 April

The All India Consumer Products Distributors' Federation (AICPDF) has written to Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Zepto's proposed initial public offering (IPO) and its potential impact on the traditional fast-moving consumer goods (FMCG) distribution network.

In its letter, the AICPDF stated that the expansion of quick-commerce platforms such as Zepto, Blinkit, and Swiggy (Instamart) has caused significant disruption.

In December, the distributors' body had written to the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) seeking regulatory intervention in relation to IPO filings by loss-making quick commerce (qcom) and e-commerce (ecom) companies. This move follows Zepto receiving in-principle approval from Sebi for its IPO.

"During the financial year 2024-2025, nearly 200,000 kirana and small retail stores are estimated to have shut down. In FY26, the situation has escalated sharply, with an estimated 1 million kirana stores reportedly shutting down due to sustained pricing pressure, loss of margins, and diversion of demand towards heavily discounted qcom platforms. Existing retailers have also reported sales decline of 25 to 30 per cent, with higher declines in several urban markets," AICPDF said in its letter.

The letter also noted that the share of traditional kirana stores in FMCG distribution has declined from around 81 per cent to 79 per cent.

"Simultaneously, FMCG manufacturers are increasingly required to incur higher trade discounts, platform commissions, and advertising expenditures to participate in qcom channels. This has resulted in margin compression across the supply chain, affecting distributors and retailers and weakening the sustainability of the traditional distribution system," the letter said.

The letter added, "In this context, the proposed IPO of Zepto assumes critical importance. Zepto was founded in 2020 as KiranaKart by Aditi Palicha and Kaivalya Vohra during the Covid-19 pandemic. In April 2021, the company pivoted to a dark-store model and rebranded as Zepto, offering 10-minute grocery delivery." It said Zepto rapidly expanded across major metropolitan markets

and introduced services such as Zepto Cafe, Bloom, and Zepto Pets. It said that the company's revenues grew significantly from nearly ₹4,454 crore in FY24 to around ₹9,669 crore in FY25, losses also widened to approximately ₹3,367 crore due to aggressive expansion.

"The company has undertaken one of the most aggressive capital-raising cycles in India, raising nearly ₹2.3 billion and reaching a valuation of around \$7 billion. On 7 April, Sebi granted in-principle approval for its proposed IPO of nearly ₹11,000 crore," the letter stated. It has requested that Zepto's IPO be kept in abeyance and asked for Sebi to respond to its representation made in December and has asked for the Competition Commission of India to examine the issue of predatory pricing.

Calderys targets East, Southeast Asia exports from its Odisha facility

HEMANT KUMAR ROUT
Bhubaneswar, 9 April

Calderys, a global leader in high-temperature industrial solutions, has announced a production road map for its new manufacturing facility in Odisha, which was set up with an investment of about ₹800 crore.

Spread over 45 acres at Bhubaneswar in Khurda district, the plant is designed to house six production lines catering to acidic and basic monoliths and bricks, steel casting fluxes and tap-hole clays, along with modern quality testing units.

Chief Minister Mohan Charan Mahli inaugurated the facility on Wednesday. Strategically located near major industrial clusters, the facility is aimed at servicing India's iron and steel, cement, aluminium, petrochemical, energy and foundry sectors.

The facility's two lines — acidic monoliths and basic monoliths — deliver high-performance refractory solutions to customers across India. Additional acidic and basic brick lines, steel casting fluxes and tap-hole clay lines are under development and scheduled to become operational later this year. Once fully operational, the facility will be the world's largest single-site refractory and flux plant.

The facility is expected to generate around 350 skilled jobs, along with vocational training initiatives to support local workforce development.

Ish Mohan Gang, senior vice-president for Asia Pacific at Calderys, said the project, called CAPES (Calderys Plant in East and South India), has achieved rapid progress, with production already under way in less than two years after ground breaking.

"The facility is being developed as the world's largest single-site refractory plant, and it will serve the export markets in East Asia, Southeast Asia and the Asia Pacific region," he said, thanking the Odisha government and local stakeholders in enabling the swift execution of the project.

OpenAI releases policy blueprint to prevent digital child abuse

AASHISH ARYAN
New Delhi, 9 April

ChatGPT maker OpenAI on Thursday introduced a policy blueprint to build a practical path to strengthen the digital protection framework for children, especially with respect to artificial intelligence (AI).

The policy blueprint, OpenAI said, would focus on modernising laws to address child sexual abuse material (CSAM) generated and altered by AI, improve reporting and coordination between organ-

isations to support more effective investigations into misuse of AI for generating such content, as well as building safety-by-design measures directly into AI systems to prevent and detect misuse.

"This framework brings together legal, operational, and technical approaches to better identify risks, accelerate responses, and support accountability, while ensuring that enforcement authorities remain strong as tech-

nology evolves," OpenAI said. The policy blueprint will initially help protect children in the US. OpenAI said. With this blueprint, OpenAI and its partners will attempt to disrupt efforts that use AI to exploit children and create synthetic images or videos.

Though cybercriminals have always used digital services for the sexual abuse of children, generative AI introduced new challenges, such as

synthetic images and videos that cybercriminals can create or manipulate even without direct access to the victim. This, OpenAI said, creates new challenges for traditional legal and investigative models.

"These developments strain investigative resources and expose gaps in statutory definitions, reporting expectations, and prevention mechanisms, while also creating opportunities for earlier detection and disruption when paired with clear safeguards and standards," OpenAI said.



Anthropic joins hands with AWS, Apple, Microsoft, Nvidia for Project Glasswing

AASHISH ARYAN
New Delhi, 9 April

Shortly after releasing a preview of its new general-purpose large language model (LLM), Claude Mythos, Anthropic has joined forces with several leading companies to launch Project Glasswing, an initiative to address potential misuse of its LLM's coding capabilities.

The new initiative will see leading global companies such as Amazon Web Services (AWS), Apple, Broadcom, Cisco, CrowdStrike, Google, JPMorgan Chase, the Linux Foundation, Microsoft, Nvidia, and Palo Alto Networks join hands with the Dario Amodei-led Anthropic to find solutions to deploy Claude Mythos's prowess "for defensive purposes".

"Mythos Preview has already found thousands of high-severity vulnerabilities, including some in every major operating system and web browser. Given the rate of AI progress, it will not be long before

such capabilities proliferate, potentially beyond actors who are committed to deploying them safely. The fallout — for economies, public safety, and national security — could be severe," Anthropic said in a blog post announcing Project Glasswing.

As part of this project, Anthropic and its partners will use Claude Mythos for their defensive security work and share the learnings with other industry partners worldwide. The companies that have joined this project will also have access to the LLM's preview to find and fix cybersecurity vulnerabilities and weaknesses in their own foundational systems.

"We anticipate this work will focus on tasks like local vulnerability detection, black box testing of binaries, securing endpoints, and penetration testing of systems," Anthropic said. "We will also collaborate with leading security organisations to produce a set of practical recommendations for how security practices should evolve in the AI era," the company said.

AI can help general trade, boost annual revenues up to 20%: BCG research

AKSHARA SRIVASTAVA
New Delhi, 9 April

Artificial intelligence (AI) can help companies transform the general trade channel, enabling them to unlock 15-20 per cent growth in annualised revenue, a new study by Boston Consulting Group (BCG) has found.

The research highlights that companies can integrate AI across functions such as sales planning, frontline execution and back-end operations to drive efficiency.

"AI can integrate structured data such as billing records and loyalty data with unstructured inputs, including store images, handwritten notes and sales conversations. By analysing these inputs together, organisations can generate insights and recommendations that support sales planning, store-level execution and operational decision-making," the study stated.

These functions include smarter planning, where AI can analyse location data, footfall patterns and store profiles to identify high-potential micro-markets, prioritise the right outlets, and tailor product mix and trade decisions for each individual store.

Meanwhile, an AI-powered sales companion can help salespeople plan their daily routes, pull up summaries of past retailer conversations, and recommend what to pitch at each store. A round-the-clock, AI-led digital sales agent can help engage retailers throughout the day, capturing orders through voice calls in local languages, resolving queries and sending payment reminders.

Prestige group may look at Reit as office rentals rise; land prices remain key factor

ANEKA CHATTERJEE
Bengaluru, 9 April

Bengaluru-based real-estate major Prestige group could explore launching a real estate investment trust (REIT) in the near future

with more room for upside, opening up the opportunity for instruments like REITs.

Prestige's business spans residential, office, retail and hospitality segments, with 126 million square feet (mn sq ft) of space under construction across the country

more in the pipeline across Mumbai, NCR, Hyderabad, Chennai, Bengaluru and Goa.

Despite rising land prices emerging as the biggest pressure point, Prestige plans to stick to its annual land investments of about ₹5,000 crore. Budgeted for the year 2025-26, the company's land investments are expected to be around ₹5,000 crore.

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once its office portfolio reaches sufficient scale and stabilisation, with exit rentals expected to approach ₹4,000 crore by FY30.

"I would not necessarily describe it as an asset play; rather, it is a channel for us to access a different pool of capital. Our commercial portfolio rentals could reach nearly ₹4,000 crore. Once we achieve a critical scale, or about 80 per cent of the portfolio is already operational and a significant portion is leased out, maybe at that stage, we can certainly evaluate options such as a Reit, or monetisation of the assets we continue to hold," said Zayed Noaman, executive director to CMD office, Prestige group.

As of December 2025, exit rentals from commercial segment were at ₹255 crore on an annualised basis. In India, Reits comprise only office assets. India's office market is among a handful globally that is clocking record building and occupancy numbers.



"STREAMLINING HOW RERA IS IMPLEMENTED ACROSS STATES WOULD HELP BRING CONSISTENCY FOR DEVELOPERS"

Zayed Noaman, ED to CMD Office, Prestige group

60 mn sq ft across 63 projects coming up. Residential makes up the bulk of the ongoing and planned development.

Within that segment, which is its largest contributor to revenues, the group plans to expand into Pune, Goa and Kochi, even as it expects growth to be concentrated in five to seven core markets, including Delhi-NCR, Mumbai, Bengaluru, Hyderabad and Chennai.

The developer is also expanding its retail footprint, with multiple projects in the pipeline over the next four years. It currently operates about four malls, with around 13

of internal accruals and debt. Prestige group reported its highest-ever annual pre-sales of ₹30,024 crore in FY26, up 76 per cent year-on-year. "Land is the main input cost for us, and in several markets supply is limited. That has led to consistent pressure on land pricing over the past two to three years," Noaman said in an interaction.

The senior executive also called for greater uniformity in the implementation of the Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act (RERA) across states. "Some level of streamlining in how RERA is implemented across states would help bring consistency for developers operating in multiple markets," he noted.

Execution, however, remains the biggest challenge for the sector, Noaman said.

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4 ECONOMY & PUBLIC AFFAIRS

MUMBAI | FRIDAY, 10 APRIL 2026 Business Standard

IN BRIEF

Axis Bank to infuse ₹389 cr in Axis Max Life to meet funding needs

Axis Bank to infuse ₹389 cr in Axis Max Life to meet funding requirements. Axis Bank, India's third-largest private sector lender, will infuse ₹389 crore in Axis Max Life Insurance to meet its funding requirements, and accordingly, the board of Max Financial Services has decided to reduce its proposed fund raise to ₹1,600 crore from the earlier stated ₹2,000 crore for business expansion, according to an exchange filing. Earlier, the board of Max Financial Services had approved to raise funds worth ₹2,000 crore to support the business growth and expansion plans and balance for general corporate purposes. Upon completion of the proposed infusion, Axis Bank, Axis Capital and Axis Securities will collectively hold 19.99 per cent of the equity share capital of Axis Max Life, and Max Financial Services' shareholding in Axis Max Life will be nearly 80.01 per cent.

BS REPORTER

Sanjay Khanna appointed BPCL CMD

State-run Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited (BPCL) on Thursday said the Appointments Committee of the Cabinet has approved the appointment of Sanjay Khanna as chairman and managing director (CMD). Khanna, currently director (refineries) and interim CMD, would retain the new role till his superannuation on May 31, 2029, or until further orders. He has over three decades of experience in refinery operations and technical services.

BS REPORTER

IndusInd Bank names Jagdeep Mallareddy consumer banking head

IndusInd Bank on Thursday said it has appointed Jagdeep Mallareddy as its consumer banking head, effective April 9. He has also been designated as a senior management personnel of the bank. Mallareddy has over three decades of experience in the financial services sector, with exposure across retail banking, lending, credit, operations, and risk management. Prior to joining IndusInd Bank, he was associated with Piramal Finance as chief business officer. Earlier, he has also worked with Axis Bank, where he held senior leadership roles. His previous experience also includes associations with ICICI Prudential Life Insurance Company, HDFC Bank, and others.

BS REPORTER

Sajja Chowdary principal officer of Policybazaar

Policybazaar Insurance Brokers has appointed Sajja Praveen Chowdary as principal officer, effective April 7, with the insurance regulator's approval, following Tarun Mathur's stepping down from the position due to personal commitments. Chowdary will also be a whole-time director of the company. Chowdary joined PB Fintech Group in 2011 and has led multiple verticals. He currently heads 'Policybazaar for Business' the corporate or SME Insurance & Reinsurance arm of Policybazaar.

BS REPORTER

India elected to various subsidiary bodies at UN

India has been elected to various subsidiary

Reliance on Hormuz for imports above global avg: Oil secy

SHUBHANGI MATHUR
New Delhi, 9 April



"THE WEST ASIA OR THE GULF CRISIS HAS SHOWN THAT WHAT WE DEVELOP AS NATIONAL INFRASTRUCTURE WHEN THINGS ARE NOT AS BAD AS THEY COULD BE, WE FORGET TO PLAN FOR ADVERSITIES"

Neeraj Mittal
Secretary, Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas

India's dependence on imports for crude oil, natural gas and liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) through the Strait of Hormuz remains higher than the global average, underscoring the need for better preparedness in building resilient energy infrastructure, Neeraj Mittal, secretary at the (MoPNG), said on Thursday.

The West Asia or the Gulf crisis has shown that we develop as national infrastructure when things are not as bad as they could be, we forget to plan for adversities. The world's energy dependence on Strait of Hormuz is roughly 20 per cent but ours is more than that in all three, crude oil, natural gas, and LPG. In LPG, our import dependence comes roughly to about 90 per cent on Strait of Hormuz," said Mittal at an industry event.

Amid the West Asia crisis, India is facing a sharper shortage of LPG compared with crude oil and liquefied natural gas (LNG), due to its higher dependence on imports of the cooking fuel from the region.

India has taken steps to diversify its sourcing

over the past decade, the official said. Crude oil imports now come from 41 countries, up from 27 earlier, while LNG is sourced from 30 nations compared with six previously. LPG sourcing has also expanded to 15 countries from 10.

Mittal also highlighted the importance of adoption of natural gas for India to ensure energy security, in line with the government's target of increasing the share of natural gas to 15 per cent by 2030.

"Energy security is not just about having enough gas or molecules, it is also about if we can secure our environment. Can we get it at proper cost? Will it be sustainable? Do we have enough sources to buy in such an eventuality? And that's where natural gas fits in," he said.

Meanwhile, city gas distribution (CGD) companies need to improve customer service and infrastructure speed to meet expansion goals, he added.

Commenting on the blending of compressed biogas (CBG) with piped natural gas (PNG), Mittal said the initiative needs to be consolidated under a single framework rather than being handled by five different government ministries.

Operators not passing on port relief to exporters: Regulator

DHRUVAKSH SAHA
New Delhi, 9 April

A month after the government asked ports to provide relief to exporters on logistics-related costs, India's maritime regulator has found that concessions granted since the West Asia crisis have not uniformly reached exporters and asked operators to clearly pass concessional benefits through.

"It has been observed that concessions granted by Port Authorities, particularly relating to detention charges, ground rent, reefer plug-in (connected load), and similar terminal charges, are not being uniformly passed on to the exporters," the Directorate General of Shipping (DG Shipping) said in a circular dated Wednesday.

It added that terminal operators are charging the Non-Vessel Operating Common Carriers (NVOCC) and are pas-

THE REGULATOR ORDERED THAT THE CURRENT PRACTICE OF ROUTING SUCH ADJUSTMENTS THROUGH PROCEDURAL REIMBURSEMENTS OR POST-FACTO CLAIMS BE DISCONTINUED WITH IMMEDIATE EFFECT

sing on the concessional benefits on a reimbursement basis. "This circuitous process delays the concession reaching the exporters," it said.

In its sternly worded advisory, the regulator ordered that the practice of routing such adjustments through procedural reimbursements or post-facto claims be discontinued. Port authorities will be responsible for and monitor compliance at the terminal level. All concessions approved by port authorities shall be directly and transparently passed on to

stakeholders, including freight forwarders and NVOCCs, who in turn shall reflect the same to exporters, it said.

In March, the regulator had issued an advisory asking shipping lines to refrain from non-transparent and predatory pricing, as shipping costs skyrocketed. This was primarily on account of War Risk Premiums on marine insurance rising by as much as 1,000 per cent in the last month. Now, the regulator has moved from advising to enforcement for the first time, warning action if evidence of undue charges is found.

"Shipping lines are to ensure that any revision in War Risk Premium is transparently and proportionately reflected in freight charges. Any deviation or non-alignment between actual risk premiums and freight components shall be subject to review and action thereof," DG Shipping's circular said.

More use of speciality fertilisers can help tide over supply shocks: Experts

SANJEEV MUKHERJEE
New Delhi, 9 April

As the government grapples with rising fertiliser subsidies in the wake of the West Asia crisis, experts gathered at a discussion in New Delhi on

phosphate) and others, and hence are relatively insulated from global supply shocks like the ones currently happening due to the West Asia situation.

The supply shocks have pushed global urea rates to almost \$800 per tonne from the near-zero levels

conventional urea, DAP, and NPK (nitrogen, phosphorus, and potassium), and are required in lesser quantities. Therefore, they can be an ideal replacement for traditional products," said Sanjeev Kanwar, managing director of Yara International South Asia.

Oil minister in Qatar amid energy supply disruptions

Jaishankar scheduled to visit UAE on April 11-12

SHUBHANGI MATHUR
New Delhi, 9 April



Union Minister for Petroleum and Natural Gas Hardeep Singh Puri will arrive in Doha on Thursday for a two-day official visit, amid disruptions in liquefied natural gas (LNG) supplies from the country's largest supplier, QatarEnergy.

Oil minister's visit to Qatar comes a day after the US and Iran announced a two-week ceasefire and agreed to reopen the Strait of Hormuz, raising hopes of a resumption in energy supplies from the region.

QatarEnergy had halted LNG production amid attacks on its facilities during the escalating tensions in West Asia, hitting India's energy supplies. Qatar is India's largest LNG supplier, providing around 40 per cent of the country's gas requirements. The West Asian country also supplies liquefied petroleum gas

review bilateral cooperation and further strengthen the partnership between the countries, said Randhir Jaiswal, official spokesperson of MEA, in a press briefing.

The ministers' discussions with officials in West Asia would include talks around energy supplies, a source said.

Meanwhile, the government said India is not paying any toll to Iran for the passage of its vessels through the Strait of Hormuz.

For gas supply, the government said, priority sectors continue to receive protected supplies, including 100 per cent supply to domestic PNG and CNG transport. Based on available inventory and scheduled LNG cargo arrivals, the overall gas allocation to fertiliser plants is being further enhanced by 5 per cent to reach approximately 95 per cent of their six-month average consumption.

Oil shock threatens India despite robust buffers: World Bank

HIMANSHI BHARDWAJ & RUCHIKA CHITRAVANSHI
New Delhi, 9 April

Prolonged periods of elevated oil prices can significantly impact the Indian economy, even though there were ample buffers to cushion shocks due to prevailing geopolitical uncertainties, World Bank economists said on Thursday.

Speaking at an event hosted by the National Council of Applied Economic Research (NCAER), Aurelien Kruse, World Bank Lead Economist for India, highlighted how the turmoil, marked by energy market disruptions and financial volatility, has already dented growth momentum, entering the fiscal year from a position of strength built on prior robust performance.

Kruse emphasised India's buffers, noting the economy's exposure through net energy imports is notable but middling compared to peers like Korea or Thailand. "India has the luxury, in a way, to even not let prices pass through to retail fuel, which is very significant," he said, underscoring policy space to cushion the blow.

However, prolonged shocks could amplify vulnerabilities — from trade dependencies to capital outflows — driven by foreign investor risk aversion, rather than domestic fundamentals, he cautioned.

Franziska Ohnsorge, World Bank Chief Economist for South Asia, echoed this. The current situation is a slowdown "largely because of headwinds in the global energy market dislocation", according to her. She framed the West Asia crisis as a temporary energy disruption layered atop shifting financial expectations, like stalled US Fed rate cuts. The energy markets will "sort of normalise" she said.

Growth metric

Real GDP growth at constant prices (%)



very strong, gross performing region compared to other emerging markets across the world," said World Bank Regional Practice Director, Prosperity, for South Asia, Sebastian Eckardt at a separate press conference.

The South Asia Economic Update updated India's 2026-27 (FY27) gross domestic product (GDP) forecast by 30 basis points to 6.6 per cent on Wednesday. The Bank, however, said that updated growth projection would mark a deceleration from the 7.6 per cent uptick expected in FY26, reflecting headwinds from the West Asia conflict.

Separately, Kruse said that the authorities had struck the right balance between taking measures to manage supply without doing massive rationing, or restrictions, and maintaining retail prices of oil relatively constant. "Having said that, the risks are absolutely

rowed resiliently, buoyed by services, remittances, and unexpectedly sturdy goods exports. Remittances from Gulf migration, often low-skilled, have proven "remarkably resilient," he said, as senders scrape funds amid shocks.

On household impact, Ohnsorge highlighted India's EU and UK trade pacts, which double its preferential access to global GDP shares and favour rural households consuming imported goods. Taming them "pro-household reforms," she said that the FTAs will boost rural income, especially for rural and poorer households consuming tariff-affected goods like processed foods.

Ohnsorge also highlighted how artificial intelligence (AI) disruptive shadow loomed large over jobs. She detailed how information and communication technology (ICT) services — 25 per cent of regional exports — thrive in output, but shed hiring post-ChaGPT, with AI-exposed firms cutting 1 per cent more than others. "AI adoption is eroding job prospects in some of the best-paid jobs, especially in AI-exposed jobs. And that compounds the long-standing subnational labour market divergence that holds back certain regions in almost every country in the region," she emphasised.

NITI Aayog Vice Chairman, Suman Bery, questioned India's manufacturing push, asking if policymakers are clear "what we want manufacturing for" and the cost of each formal job, noting it as a key policy pillar.

He highlighted regional challenges in monetising semi-skilled labour compared to eastern regions, calling these issues "not idiosyncratic" to India, but tied to South Asia's unique hurdles in climbing the manufacturing ladder.

bodies at the UN Economic and Social Council, one of the six main organs of the United Nations. The Permanent Mission of India to the UN said on Wednesday that India has been elected by acclamation to the United Nations Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC) subsidiary bodies, including Commission on Science and Technology for Development (2027-2030); Committee on Non-Governmental Organisations (2027-2030); and the Committee for Programme and Coordination (2027-2029).

rising sales of non-subsidised speciality fertilisers at around 10-12 per cent per annum show that farmers have an appetite for good products irrespective of the price charged. Also, non-subsidised speciality fertilisers have a much more diverse sourcing range than that of urea, DAP (diammonium

of less than \$450 per tonne, while DAP prices have also crossed \$800 per tonne from around \$650-670 per tonne before the war. "Most speciality or non-subsidised fertilisers are sourced from Europe, China, Taiwan, and the Middle East. Also, their transportation is not difficult as they pack more punch than

In India, speciality fertiliser sales have been growing at a rate of 10-12 per cent per annum. Though their total sales volume is quite small at around 0.4-0.5 million tonnes (mt) compared to over 65 mt of subsidised fertilisers sold in India every year, the volume rise shows that niche products that give better value for money do command a market, experts said.

"This global financial environment is what's really changed, and it may last a little longer than the energy market disruption," she observed, pointing to heightened forecast uncertainty as markets price in stability over easing. "India came into the crisis from a very strong position and buffers... Despite the global headwinds, we do see India and the region, continuing to be a

massive. They're tilted to the downside," he said. The economists downplayed major inflation risks from energy shocks. Onshore noted South Asia's energy share in consumer price baskets aligns with emerging market averages, giving governments leeway to act. Kruse added that despite US tariffs and global headwinds, India's current account nar-

Kruse flagged the backcasting phase of the base year revision of GDP to 2024 as particularly noteworthy, stressing an overlooked impact: rebasing doesn't just revise national figures, it reestimates subnational GDPs. These shifts carry "very significant impact on states' borrowing ability and subnational fiscal rules". The Bank would watch closely for the back series data, he added.

CDSCO injects speed into Form 40 approvals

SANKET KOUL
New Delhi, 9 April

India's central drug regulator is seeking to speed up approvals for imported medicines by accelerating the disposal of Form 40 applications, which pharmaceutical (pharma) companies use to obtain registration certificates for foreign manufacturing facilities and drugs before importing them into India.

Form 40 is a crucial regulatory document in India, under the Drugs & Cosmetics Rules 1945, used for submitting an application for the registration of a manufacturing site and drugs intended to be imported into India.

India imported drugs worth \$8.85 billion during April-February of 2025-26, according to the Directorate General of Commercial Intelligence and Statistics data shared by the Pharmaceuticals Export Promotion Council of India (Pharmexcl). According to an office order seen by Business Standard, the

Fast-tracking applications

- Form 40: Used by drugmakers to apply for registration certificates for import of drugs into India
- Recent CDSCO analysis said administrative delays were extending timelines before files reached the final decision stage
- Form 40 files, wherever appropriate, can now be submitted directly to DCGI from Deputy Drug Controller level
- Experts say move can cut months off the present approval timeline of 6-12 months

Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO) said a recent review of Form 40 applications revealed administrative delays extending timelines before files reached the final decision stage. "To ensure faster disposal of applications, reduce pendency, and enhance decision-making efficiency, it

has been decided that Form 40 files shall, wherever appropriate, be submitted directly to the Drugs Controller General of India from the level of Deputy Drug Controllers, without routing through the level of Joint Drugs Controller," the April 7 order observed. Experts say the move removes a

structural bottleneck, improving regulatory capacity and making the process more efficient. "Several applications remain pending despite due processing at lower levels, indicating a procedural bottleneck," the order added.

A pharma executive said the regulator's move to eliminate an intermediate layer that has become a procedural checkpoint rather than a value-adding step, allowing direct escalation instead. Pharma imports are largely dominated by bulk drugs and intermediates, as well as formulations and biologicals. "It supported well at the decision-making level, it will increase the velocity of bringing drugs to market without compromising regulatory rigour or diluting control," said Rishi Agrawal, chief executive officer and founder of compliance firm TeamLease RegTech. He added that such internal delays slow product introduction and technology transfer, with approvals often stretching from six to 12 months.

RBI mandates faster credit of inward remittances

SUBRATA PANDA
Mumbai, 9 April

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has on Thursday laid down tighter timelines for banks to process inward cross-border remittances, mandating immediate customer intimation and faster reconciliation of nostro accounts to reduce delays in credit.

The central bank flagged delays at the beneficiary leg — the time taken by banks to credit funds after receiving payment messages — as a key bottleneck in cross-border remittances.

"The speed of cross-border payments is affected by several factors. One of the challenges with speed of payments is experienced at the beneficiary leg is the time taken from receipt of the payment at the beneficiary bank till credit to the beneficiary account," the central bank said. It added that a review of the extant process for inward cross-border payments indicated the need to streamline processes at the beneficiary bank to ensure timely intimation of payment information and credit to the beneficiary's account.

Accordingly, the RBI has mandated that banks inform customers immediately upon receipt of inward payment messages. Messages received after the closing of operating hours must be conveyed at the start of the next business day.

RBI also observed that several banks rely on end-of-day nostro account statements to confirm and reconcile receipts, resulting in delays in crediting beneficiary accounts. To address this, it has advised banks to undertake reconciliation of credits in the nostro account more frequently — either on a near real-time basis or at periodic intervals, with the gap not exceeding one hour.

GSPC GUJARAT STATE PETROLEUM CORPORATION LIMITED
NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Gujarat State Petroleum Corporation Ltd. (GSPC), the Operator of Onshore Blocks, invites competitive bids for a Tender under two bid system for uninterrupted sale of emulsified crude oil as is where is and as available base refined from Ankleshwar Field (CB-ONN-2032) as per tender No. GSPC/SALE OF EMULSIFIED CRUDE/2025-26/ANKLESHWAR/635.

THE KARUR VYSYA BANK LIMITED
Regd. & Central Office, No. 25, Ende Road, Vellore Nagar, L.N.S., Karur - 630002
[CIN: L85107TN19PLC001295]
[E-mail: kvb, sig@kvb.com] [Website: www.kvb.co.in]
[Tel No: 94324-26544]

NOTICE TO SHAREHOLDERS
Special Window for Transfer and Dematerialization of Physical Securities
Notice to Investors is hereby given that pursuant to SEBI Circular No. HQ/381/31/2025-MIRSD-PD-12/3759/2025, dated January 30, 2026 another special window is open for re-lodgement of transfer requests of physical shares.

Execution Date of Transfer Deed	Lodged for transfer before April 01, 2019?	Original Security Certificate Available?	Eligible to lodge in the current window?
Before April 01, 2019	No (It is fresh lodgement)	Yes	✓
	Yes (It was rejected/returned earlier)	Yes	✓
	No	No	✗
	Yes	No	✗

The following cases will not be considered in the Special window:
• Cases involving disputes between transferor and transferee (to be settled through court/NCLT process)
• Shares which have been transferred to Investor Education and Protection Fund (IEPF)
• Re-lodgement/fresh lodgement of transfer requests executed prior to April 01, 2019 where original share certificate is not available.

Note: Shares re-lodged under this window shall be issued only in Demat mode after due verification of original share certificates.
Eligible investors are requested to avail the opportunity by submitting hard copies of the transfer requests along with all the requisite documents to: M/s. MUGF Intime India Private Limited, (Unit: The Karur Vysya Bank Limited) "Surya" 35 Mayflower Avenue, Behind Senthil Nagar, Sornapalayam Road, Coimbatore-641028, Tamil Nadu.
E-mail: investor.helpdesk@in.mgms.mugf.com
Website: www.in.mgms.mugf.com
Tel: 0422-2314792/498995/2539835/2539836
Update KYC and convert physical shares into demat mode:
Shareholders who hold shares in physical form are requested to update their KYC to get credit of dividend to their bank account through electronic mode and convert shares from physical form to demat form at the earliest possible as it will be beneficial for market liquidity.

OSBI
Anytime Channels, Centre, 3rd Floor, The Arcade, World Trade Centre, Cuff Parade, Mumbai - 400005
NOTICE INVITING TENDER
BFP No. SBI/ACV/2026-27/001 DATED: 10.04.2026
Bids are invited for procurement of 60 Small Value Dispensing Machines (SVDMs) - OPEX Model by State Bank of India under BFP No. SBI/ACV/2026-27/001, dated 10.04.2026 from the eligible bidders. Interested Bidders may visit "Procurement News" on the Bank's website <https://sbi.bank.in> and GEIP portal <https://gem.gov.in> to submit bids.

Zerodha Fund House
Disclosure of Half Yearly Portfolio Statement of the Schemes of Zerodha Mutual Fund
Notice is hereby given to the Unitholder(s) of the scheme(s) of Zerodha Mutual Fund (the "Fund") that in accordance with Regulation 59A of SEBI (Mutual Fund) Regulations, 1996 read with SEBI Master Circular for Mutual Funds, dated June 27, 2024, the Half Yearly Portfolio Statement of the following scheme(s) of the Fund for the period ended March 31, 2026 namely:-

- Zerodha Multi Asset Passive FoF
- Zerodha Overnight Fund
- Zerodha Nifty Smallcap 100 ETF
- Zerodha Nifty Short Duration G-Sec Index Fund

have been posted on the AMC/ Fund's website viz., www.zerodhafundhouse.com and on the AMFI website www.amfiindia.com.

Further, Unitholder(s) may also request for a physical copy of the Half Yearly Portfolio Statement by writing an email to us at support@zerodhafundhouse.com from their registered email id.

For Zerodha Asset Management Private Limited
(Investment Manager to the schemes of Zerodha Mutual Fund)
Place: Bengaluru Sd/-
Date: April 10, 2026 Authorized Signatory

Zerodha Asset Management Private Limited
Registered Office: Indique Park, New No. 51 (Old No. 14), Richmond Road, Bengaluru - 560025
Contact: +91 80 8960 1101 Email: info@zerodhafundhouse.com

Statutory Details: Zerodha Mutual Fund has been set up as a Trust under the Indian Trusts Act, 1882. **Sponsor:** Zerodha Broking Limited. **Trustee:** Zerodha Trustee Private Limited. **CIN:** U67109KA2011PTC155731, a company incorporated under the provisions of the Companies Act, 2013, with limited liability. **AMC/Investment Manager:** Zerodha Asset Management Private Limited (CIN: U67109KA2011PTC155731), a company incorporated under the provisions of the Companies Act, 2013, with limited liability.

MUTUAL FUND INVESTMENTS ARE SUBJECT TO MARKET RISKS. READ ALL SCHEME RELATED DOCUMENTS CAREFULLY.

ABB India Limited
CIN: L32202KA1949PLC032923
Registered Office: Disha - 3rd Floor, Plot No. 5 & 6, 2nd Stage, Peenya Industrial Area IV, Peenya, Bengaluru - 560 058
Ph: +91 80 22949113, Website: www.abb.co.in e-mail: investor.helpdesk@in.abb.com

This Notice is published pursuant to the provisions of Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013 (The Act) read with the Rule 20 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014.

(A) ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING AND RECORD DATE:
Notice is hereby given that the 76th Annual General Meeting (AGM) of the Members of the Company will be held on Saturday, May 9, 2026 at 11.00 A.M. (IST) at Disha, Plot No. 5 & 6, 2nd Stage, Peenya Industrial Area IV, Peenya, Bengaluru - 560 058, to transact the businesses set forth in the AGN Notice dated February 19, 2026.

In accordance with Section 101 of the Companies Act, 2013, read with Rule 18 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, and the MCA circulars, the Integrated Annual Report of the Company for financial year 2025, including the notice convening the AGM, is being sent by e-mail to members whose e-mail addresses are available with Company/Depository Participant(s)/KFin Technologies Limited, (KFin), the Registrar and Share Transfer Agents of the Company. However, Members including Members who have not registered their e-mail addresses with Company/Depository Participant(s)/KFin, can download the AGM Notice and Annual Report from the Company's website i.e., www.abb.co.in - Investors - General Meeting - 2026. The AGM Notice and the Integrated Annual Report are also available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges where the shares of the Company have been listed viz., BSE Limited - www.bseindia.com and National Stock Exchange of India Limited - www.nseindia.com.

Members who have not registered their e-mail addresses with the Depository Participant(s)/KFin are urged to do so promptly. For a detailed procedure on how to register their email addresses and receive e-voting credentials, as well as instructions on voting, kindly refer to the Notes section of the AGM Notice accessible on the aforementioned websites.

A letter containing the web link, along with the exact path to access the complete details of the Annual Report, is being sent to members shareholders who have not registered their e-mail address with KFin or DP.

The Members are requested to note that, in order to avoid any loss/interception in postal transit and also to get prompt credit of dividend through National Electronic Clearing Service (NECS) / Electronic Clearing Service (ECS) they should submit their NECS / ECS details to KFin. For more details, please refer the AGM Notice.

The Register of Directors and Key Managerial Personnel and their shareholding maintained under Section 170 of the Act

TERMS AND CONDITIONS:
1. **AGM Voting:** This draft notice has been placed before the Stakeholders' Consultation Committee for its review and comments prior to publication, in accordance with the Liquidation Regulations.
2. **Non-Binding Instruction:** This instruction is only an invitation to make an offer and does not, by itself, create any binding obligation on the Liquidator or the Corporate Debtor to conclude any sale. The Liquidator reserves the right, at any stage, to accept, modify or withdraw the sale process and/or to reject or disqualify any offer.

The reserve price indicated herein is based on the last attempted auction, with provision for reduction up to 10% as advised by the SCC, subject to applicable regulations.

Block A: Description of Assets: 1250/2025 Date of time of Auction: 11:30 am Reserve Price: 5,37,64,000 Lakh EMD: 5% Bid Incremental Value: 50 Lakh

Block B: Description of Assets: 1250/2025 Date of time of Auction: 11:30 am Reserve Price: 5,37,64,000 Lakh EMD: 5% Bid Incremental Value: 50 Lakh

Block C: Description of Assets: 1250/2025 Date of time of Auction: 11:30 am Reserve Price: 5,37,64,000 Lakh EMD: 5% Bid Incremental Value: 50 Lakh

Block D: Description of Assets: 1250/2025 Date of time of Auction: 11:30 am Reserve Price: 5,37,64,000 Lakh EMD: 5% Bid Incremental Value: 50 Lakh

clear objective and later articulated in the central bank's Payments Vision 2018 to promote interoperability. That principle led to a record 22.64 billion UPI payments

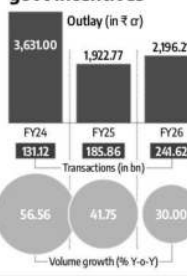
discount rate (MDR), limiting the incentives to invest in its further growth. Here is a look at how UPI has grown over the years.

Capturing UPI thresholds

Month	Volume (in mn)	Time taken from previous milestone (months)
December 2016	2	8*
June 2017	10.35	6
November 2017	105.02	5
November 2018	524.94	12
October 2019	1,148.46	11
October 2020	2,071.62	12
March 2022	5,405.65	17
August 2023	10,586.02	17
August 2025	20,008.31	24

*These are months in which UPI (transactions) crossed a certain threshold, since launch

Interplay of UPI and govt incentives



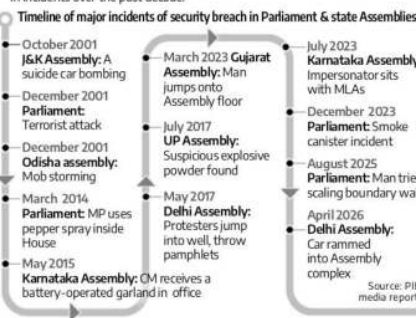
Launches over the years

- Type: UPI 1.0
Launch year: 2016
Use case: Bank-to-bank transfer via mobile
- Type: Bharat Interface for Money (BHIM)
Launch year: 2016
Use case: Sovereign UPI-app launched by PM Narendra Modi
- Type: UPI Autopay
Launch year: 2020
Use case: Recurring payments
- Type: RuPay Credit Card on UPI
Launch year: 2022
Use case: Linkage of RuPay credit cards to UPI apps for merchant payments
- Type: UPI Lite
Launch year: 2022
Use case: Process low value payments below ₹1,000 in a PIN-less manner; reduce loan on core banking system
- Type: UPI Lite X
Launch year: 2023
Use case: Process fully offline payments
- Type: Credit line on UPI
Launch year: 2023
Use case: Access pre-sanctioned credit lines from banks, low-bidder high volume lending
- Type: UPI Circle
Launch year: 2024
Use case: Ability to delegate transactions
- Type: UPI Reserve Pay
Launch year: 2025
Use case: Block part of credit limit/pre-sanctioned credit line limits for repetitive payments

*List is not exhaustive; Sources: National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI), Union Budget 2026-27, Press Information Bureau (PIB), Kaggle

Security breaches have risen sharply in past decade

Between 2001 and 2026, Parliament and state Assemblies have recorded 12 major breaches, with seven occurring since 2017 — pointing to a marked rise in incidents over the past decade.



Source: PIB, media reports

Non-life insurance premium saw over 9% growth in FY26

AATHIRA VARIER
Mumbai, 9 April

The non-life insurance industry reported 9.3 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y) growth in premiums to ₹336 trillion in 2025-26 (FY26), aided by the health insurance segment, after the Goods and Services Tax (GST) rate rationalisation slashed the levy to nil from 18 per cent.

However, the 1/1 accounting regulations weighed on the industry's premium growth in the first half of the fiscal (H1FY26), along with decline in crop insurance.

In March, non-life insurance premium grew around 9 per cent to ₹28,921.9 crore.

In FY26, general insurance companies' gross direct premium underwritten was up 8 per cent Y-o-Y to ₹2.79 trillion.

The standalone health insurers posted 19.4 per cent Y-o-Y growth to ₹45,865.81 crore, while specialised insurance companies saw 5.14 per cent Y-o-Y growth to ₹11,676.2 crore.

In FY25, the non-life insurance industry saw a muted growth of 6.20 per cent Y-o-Y due to the change in accounting and regulatory push towards achieving the 'Insurance for All by 2047' vision.

In FY26, the government's decision to reduce GST rates on retail health insurance policies in September 2025 gave a push to health insurance premiums in the second half of the financial year (H2FY26),

The surge

Non-life insurers' gross direct premium underwritten

Year	% Y-o-Y	YTD Growth
Apr'25	13.38	13.38
May'25	6.46	10.41
Jun'25	5.16	8.85
Jul'25	2.76	7.11
Aug'25	1.63	6.05
Sep'25	13.17	7.32
Oct'25	0.07	6.1
Nov'25	24.17	8.01
Dec'25	13.68	8.62
Jan'26	14.88	9.32
Feb'26	9.68	9.35
Mar'26	8.78	9.29

Source: General Insurance Council

by strong health insurance momentum, with standalone health insurers (SAHIs) delivering robust 19 per cent growth and continuing to gain market share in the retail segment. This reflects a clear shift towards customer-centric product and solution offerings, alongside a steady recovery in the motor segment."

He added that the industry outlook remains positive with an expected growth of 15-20 per cent in FY27, supported by rising insurance penetration, digital adoption, and regulatory push towards achieving the 'Insurance for All by 2047' vision.

In FY26, the government's decision to reduce GST rates on retail health insurance policies in September 2025 gave a push to health insurance premiums in the second half of the financial year (H2FY26),

with companies reporting an increase in both policy sales and average ticket size. In addition, the rationalisation of GST for vehicles nudged the growth in motor insurance premiums.

"Excluding specialised insurers, industry GDP growth by 9.4 per cent in FY2026, driven by the low base of FY2025 and GST relaxations that supported growth in the health segment. This was partly offset by the impact of the 1/1 regulations on long-term policies, which weighed on H1FY2026 growth, and a sharp decline in crop insurance. Growth strengthened materially in March 2026, with industry GDP rising 10.6 per cent Y-o-Y, while SAHI outperformed significantly with a growth of 21.9 per cent," said Neha Parikh, vice president and sector head, financial ratings, Ica.

"Ica expects GDP to grow stronger by 9.7-10.6 per cent in FY2027, with health insurance remaining the primary growth driver," she added.

Among the major insurance companies — New India Assurance's premium saw 10.9 per cent Y-o-Y growth to ₹42,821.8 crore, ICICI Lombard General Insurance's premium grew by 7 per cent Y-o-Y to ₹28,712.5 crore, Bajaj General Insurance's premium expanded by 8.23 per cent Y-o-Y to ₹23,178.5 crore and United India Insurance's premium increased by 6.7 per cent Y-o-Y to ₹21,422.6 crore.

RBI paper proposes steps to combat digi payment frauds

AJINKYA KAWALE
Mumbai, 9 April

To curb rising fraudulence in digital payments, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), in a discussion paper released on Thursday, has suggested measures such as introducing a requirement of one hour for digital payments worth more than ₹10,000 to be credited to a beneficiary's account.

Among the other measures suggested is additional authentication by "trusted individuals" for vulnerable users, a tighter scrutiny of accounts receiving large credits, and expanded customer-controlled safeguards.

The central bank has kept the window for comments on the discussion paper open until May 8. After that it will review the feedback and consider issuing draft guidelines. During the one-hour lag the RBI has suggested for authorised push payments (APPs), the payer's bank will provisionally have the account debited while allowing the customer to cancel the transaction at any time.

During the one hour, the bank may flag anomalies and alert the customer. Should the customer choose to proceed after reviewing these prompts, the transaction will be executed. This, however,

will slow the movement of funds. The suggestion comes at a time when transactions over ₹10,000 account for about 45 per cent of fraud cases by volume and 98.5 per cent by value.

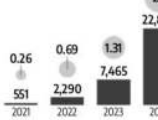
This system will come with exemptions for merchant payments, recurring payments, and payments by cheque. This is because most payments to merchants are enabled only after due diligence by banks and payment aggregators while no comparable safeguard exists for account-to-account transactions.

The paper suggested a "whitelisting" mechanism by which payers can authorise certain transactions to payees bypassing the lag. It noted that frauds related to account takeover were negligible. However, APP frauds thrived at a time when frictionless payments were widely adopted before users realised that they had been duped.

However, lagged transactions may conflict with the immediacy principle of digital payments and implementing such a system, across bank systems and payments infrastructure, involves costs and effort. The paper has outlined that certain sections of people such as citizens more than 70 or those differently able may be vulnerable to socially engineered frauds. For them, a "trusted person" des-

Scam spike

Number of frauds reported (in mn)
Value of frauds (₹ Cr)



Source: National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal

ignated by such vulnerable customers can act as another layer of authentication for high-value transactions over ₹50,000. This prioritisation ensures tailored protection for those at a higher risk of fraud or exploitation due to age or disability, while allowing for flexibility for the broader customer base, the paper said. This is important because 92 per cent of the value of fraudulent transactions reported is above this limit.

Any change of a trusted person may be permitted only after a mandatory 24-hour cooling period, ensuring that such decisions are deliberate and informed. For opting out, vulnerable customers

may withdraw from the safeguard system after a 24-hour waiting period following their request, the paper said.

Banks will be expected to explain to customers of associated risks before processing such requests. Exceptions will be similar to lagged credit mechanisms such as merchant and recurring transactions and payments by cheque.

Another proposal aims to curb the use of accounts as conduits of fraud by aligning permissible credits with a customer's verified financial profile under KYC norms. It suggests a ceiling of ₹25 lakh annually on inflows for accounts without enhanced due diligence, with such accounts flagged as low-credit turnover.

Any credit beyond this limit will be held in shadow mode and released only after the bank verifies its legitimacy, or else it will be reversed. The measure builds on ongoing due diligence requirements, seeking to tighten monitoring of fund flows while limiting disruption to genuine users. The measure applies to individual, joint, sole proprietorship and partnership (including LLP) accounts, while excluding companies, listed entities, and government accounts.

The paper also proposes extending account-level controls across digital payment modes.

Term money market access likely to raise volumes for NBFCs

ANUPREKSHA JAIN
Mumbai, 9 April

The Reserve Bank of India's decision to allow non-banking financial companies (NBFC) into the term money market is expected to boost volumes, improve price discovery, and strengthen the link between overnight and longer-term rates, officials from shadow banks said.

The move will diversify funding sources and aid liquidity management beyond the volatile overnight segment. However, given its unsecured nature, strict prudential limits and counterparty-level safeguards will be key to managing risks, they said.

"It will help in increasing volumes, enhance price discovery, and improve the link between overnight rates and longer-term interest rates," said a treasury official at an NBFC. "But at the same time, due to the unsecured nature of this market, the framework requires strict prudential, counterparty-specific, and regulatory limits."

The term money market is a segment where funds are borrowed and lent for a period of at least 14 days up to one year. These transactions are typically uncollateralised and non-transferable, unlike instruments such as commercial paper (CP) and certificates of deposit (CD).

The RBI said that the step was taken to

deepen liquidity and strengthen monetary policy transmission.

"It is still in draft phase but the decision is positive for NBFCs. It will help with liquidity and diversification," said Vinay Surana, head of treasury at Cynai Global. At the same time, NBFC players noted that even if they are allowed to borrow in the term money market, access is likely to remain limited to tenors of up to 90 days, as volumes beyond this period are expected to stay thin.

Consequently, borrowing in the term money market would largely mirror short-term instruments such as CP.

"NBFCs already issue CP for around 90 days, so term money borrowing may

effectively function as another form of short-term borrowing. It remains uncertain whether lenders would be willing to extend funds for longer tenors, particularly up to one year, given the limited appetite in that segment," said a treasury official at another NBFC.

He added that while CP rates have hardened and issuances declined in March, it is not clear whether NBFCs will be able to borrow at rates different from the CP market. Even though term money rates are around or below 6.5 per cent, borrowing costs for NBFCs may not diverge significantly from CP rates.

More on business-standard.com

Assam sees 85% turnout, Kerala records over 78%

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Gowahati/Thiruvananthapuram/Puducherry, 9 April

Assam registered a record voter turnout of over 85 per cent while Kerala witnessed an impressive polling with more than 78 per cent in the assembly elections on Thursday, according to the latest Election Commission figures, as the ruling dispensations in the two states eye a third consecutive term in power.

Dubbing the high voter turnout as "historic," Assam Chief Minister Himanta Sarma said the result of this "election is already visible — in the hope, pride, and happiness" on the faces of our people. However, Congress leader Gauvay Gogoi asserted that the overwhelming turnout was for a "new and greater Assam" and a new leadership at the helm.

"It is now the responsibility of the ECI to ensure the security of EVMs and conduct the counting of votes accurately," Gogoi added. Both Sarma and Gogoi are among the 722 candidates contesting from 126 constituencies in these elections. The total



A Bodo tribal woman shows her ink-marked finger after casting her vote in the Assam Assembly elections, in Tamulpur, on Thursday

the BJP, Congress leader Deepthi Mary Varghese, however, said the reasons behind the rise in the polling percentage in the union territory. While the polls in Kerala will decide whether the LDF secures a rare third

India-US to resume trade talks later this month in Washington

SHREYA NANDI
New Delhi, 9 April

An Indian delegation will travel to Washington later this month for further discussions on the interim trade pact with the United States (US) in February.

"Highly productive meeting with US Trade Representative Ambassador (James) Green to discuss advancing POTUS (President of the US) trade priorities in South and Central Asia. The United States and India have previously agreed to a trade deal, and we

look forward to welcoming an Indian delegation to Washington later this month," US Ambassador to India and Special Envoy to South and Central Asia, Sergio Goro said on Thursday.

The travel dates are currently under discussion. This will be the first in-person meeting of the negotiating team, after its visit to Washington DC was postponed over two months ago amid uncertainty surrounding the tariff situation following the US Supreme Court judgment.

On February 20, the US Supreme Court revoked President Donald Trump's authority to use the International Emergency Economic Powers Act (IEEPA) for imposing country-specific "reciprocal" tariffs. Thereafter, the US administration

imposed a blanket 10 per cent surcharge on all countries for 150 days from February 24.

India and the US had announced a trade deal on February 2 and had planned to sign the pact by March. A joint statement for the same was released on February 7 and the 25 per cent additional ad-valorem tariffs imposed by the US on certain Indian exports due to the country's Russian oil imports were removed. According to the interim deal, the US had agreed to reduce tariffs on India to 18 per cent.

Since the Supreme Court judgment, the Indian side has reiterated that it will "wait" to sign the interim trade deal with the US till the administration is "ready" with the new global tariff architecture. The meeting later this month is expected to give clarity on the way forward for the tariffs. Both sides are also expected to finalise details related to the non-tariff barriers and matters related to the US tariff under section 232 — finalised under the interim deal. India is also expected to seek clarity on the Section 301 investigations initiated by the US.

235 Gw fresh power capacity being built: CEA

number of voters is 2.5 crore. In 2021, Assam recorded 82.04 per cent in the assembly polls.

In Kerala, where competition between the CPI (M)-led Left Democratic Front (LDF) and the United Democratic Front (UDF) has traditionally driven high participation, 88 candidates are contesting from the 140 assembly constituencies. The total number of voters is 2.71 crore. CPI(M) leader C N Mohan said an increase in the polling percentage would benefit the LDF because its workers had come to ensure maximum voter turnout.

BJP Ernakulam district president K S Shaju said the increase in polling percentage resulted from a higher turnout of women voters, and this would favour

age required detailed analysis. "Usually, the trend is that when the polling percentage rises, it turns favourable to the UDF. However, a detailed analysis is required in this matter," she said.

Meanwhile, Kerala Chief Electoral Officer Rathan U Kellar expressed confidence that the current voting trend indicates that a turnout of 90 per cent will be achieved. In the 2021 assembly polls, 74.06 per cent voter turnout was registered in Kerala.

Along with Kerala and Assam, the voting for the 30-member Puducherry assembly was also held on Thursday. It registered a record turnout of more than 86 per cent in the polls, where the opposition Congress-led bloc is pushing to wrest power from the AINRC-led

consecutive term, the Congress-headed UDF stages a comeback after a decade, or the NDA makes deeper inroads into state's traditionally bipolar political space, in the high-stakes polls in Assam, there is a close fight between the ruling BJP, which is aiming for a third consecutive term, and the Congress that seeks to wrest power after being ousted in 2016. Thursday's elections are the first leg of the polls in four states and one UT: Kerala and Assam, West Bengal, Tamil Nadu and Puducherry. The elections in West Bengal will be held in two phases on April 23 and April 29, and in Tamil Nadu, the polls will occur in one phase on April 23. Vote counting for all four states and the UT will be on May 4.

SUDHEER PAL SINGH
New Delhi, 9 April

India is currently constructing a massive 235 Gigawatt (Gw) of power generation capacity across various resources, including fossil fuel and clean energy projects, the Central Electricity Authority (CEA) has said, as part of its long-term ten-year resource adequacy plan.

This includes thermal power projects of 40,865 Megawatt (Mw) capacity, hydro power projects with 12,723 Mw capacity, nuclear power projects of 6,600 Mw capacity, 13,200 Mw of Pumped Storage Projects, 10,658 Mw of battery Energy Storage System (BESS), and the largest ever under-construction portfolio of renewable energy projects at 154,830 Mw.

"Additionally, 47,920 Mw of Renewable Capacity (35,440 Mw Solar, 2,400 Mw Wind and 10,080 Mw Hybrid Power) is under-tendering. In addition, about 1,34,000 Mw capacity is planned to be added under the Green Energy Corridors scheme.

Several other RE generation projects are being planned by states," CEA said in its report.

India's installed power capacity currently stands at 320 Gw, with non-fossil sources accounting for about 52 per cent. This share is projected to rise to 70 per cent by 2035-36, while fossil fuel-based capacity is expected to decline from 48 per cent to around 30 per cent.

"The projected installed capacity by end 2035-36 is 1,121 Gw comprising 315 Gw coal, 20 Gw gas, 22 Gw nuclear, 78 Gw large hydro, 509 Gw solar, 155 Gw wind, 16 Gw biomass and 6 Gw small hydro," CEA said.

It also noted that 22,400 Mw of coal and lignite-based capacity has already been awarded and is under construction, while an additional 16,420 Mw is in the planning stage. Similarly, 7,000 Mw of nuclear power capacity is under various stages of planning and approval, 9,580 Mw capacity of Pumped Storage Projects (PSPs) is under construction and yet to be taken up for construction.

The report also stated that India's peak electricity is expected to increase at a compound annual growth rate of 5.58 per cent between 2024-25 and 2035-36.

▶ FROM PAGE 1

Detroit of Asia Ambattur sputters

From having a single LPG dealer until March, the company is now sourcing gas from three dealers, in addition to trying to source gas from private-sector players. However, the cost escalation since March has hit their profits harder than ever before.

"For a 10-kilogram (kg) cylinder, we used to procure it at a cost of around ₹1,500. It is now coming to around ₹3,000, doubling our expenses. The government is also giving priority to household cooking gas. We have asked some of our customers to extend delivery time until we tide over the crisis," he adds.

Though small in numbers, these heat treatment units play a crucial role in the entire value chain.

The first domino has fallen

To those who consider the Iran-US-Israel war as only an LPG crisis, Ambattur issues a warning. It is having a cascading effect across the value chain.

"Prices of raw materials like steel, aluminium, and copper, among others, have increased by 30-40 per cent since the war started. Some of the raw materials are not even in stock. If the crisis continues, it will affect the auto industry, as we are one of the key arteries of Chennai's and India's auto ecosystem," says Ravichandran G, president of the Ambattur Industrial Estate Manufacturers' Association.

At First Main Road is the office of Delcoys Manufacturing, a major supplier of parts for engines of tractors and cars. Muthiah Balachandran, chief executive of Delcoys, highlights an even more concerning issue — manpower shortage. "Because these kg LPG cylinders are not available, we are not getting employees from North and East India, who form the major workforce. The majority of the units are working on a workforce of 50-60 per cent," he adds.

Though Delcoys even made an innovative move by providing an experimental diesel stove for cooking, it could not bring the employees back.

"Steel prices are up; chemicals like nickel, too, have zoomed. More importantly, rates of plastic items have increased, affecting the industry's existence," says Balachandran. When his company tried to procure high-quality plastic trays last week, it was costing over ₹350 per kg versus around ₹250 before. More importantly, retail players indicate that the same product may well be crossing ₹400-450 soon if the crisis

continues. He too echoes that anything that affects Ambattur will gradually hit major original equipment manufacturers in the auto industry.

Ambattur supplies precision, machined, and forged parts reportedly to major auto-makers like TVS Motor Company, Honda Motorcycle & Scooter India, Ola Electric Mobility, JSW MG Motor India, Hyundai Motor India, Tata Motors, Maruti Suzuki India, Nissan India, Mahindra & Mahindra, and Yamaha Motor India. Based on rough estimates, the combined revenues of companies in Ambattur come to ₹3,000-3,500 crore.

A N Giresnan, managing director of Avon Seals, a Tier-1 supplier to major water pump manufacturers, including Kirloskar Brothers, Suguna Pumps, Sharp Hydro Products, and CRI Pumps, is also in a spot.

"Companies dependent on LPG may be as few as 5 per cent in Ambattur, especially those having furnaces. I have a unit that produces premium-quality sintered carbon, which is a high-strength, porous material. Because of the LPG shortage, I had to stop operations there and shift employees to my other units," says Giresnan.

Sintered carbon is used in water pumps, and the company has now requested customers to accept a downgraded version of the same product. "My main factory is not affected, as I have downgraded the quality of the product," he says.

Ayyappan Kandasamy's Hybrid Auto Cast is a leading precision manufacturer of aluminium and zinc pressure die-cast components. Kandasamy's concern is the aluminium shortage.

Close to 170 container ships carrying aluminium were reportedly stuck in the Strait of Hormuz. Adding pressure to the rising costs, Bahrain's Alba, one of the world's largest aluminium smelters, has declared force majeure on deliveries and cut output by 10 per cent, citing its inability to ship through the Strait of Hormuz.

"Prices increased from ₹240 per kg to around ₹365 per kg, up by over 50 per cent following the crisis. Scrap is also not available in the market. As of now, there is a severe scarcity of aluminium alloys," he says. Aluminium suppliers have also stopped offering credit to these units, which used to make payments a month earlier. "Now, we are sourcing it on a cash-and-carry model," Kandasamy says. He

also adds that even if he procures products, workers from Bihar and Odisha have gone back due to the LPG crisis, signalling the manpower crisis is an even bigger concern.

The machines fall silent, not the resolve

As one moves out of the

hub, the clatter of metal and the hum of machines gradually fade. But the words of Balachandran continue to echo in the ears: "Whether it is a pandemic or war, the show will go on. Ambattur will sustain."

Series concludes

Mkts slip, crude spikes as US-Iran truce hopes fade

Despite heightened rhetoric, there were tentative signs that the ceasefire was largely holding, with a noticeable decline in attacks across the Persian Gulf.

Amid the volatility, Morgan Stanley remained constructive on the medium-term outlook. Risham Desai, head of India research and chief India equity strategist at Morgan Stanley, said domestic equities could be on the cusp of a sharp move, backed by improving macro signals and valuations. "The market appears set up for a big move. The trailing 12-month performance is almost the worst in history and relative valuations are at previous troughs," Desai said.

Market breadth remained mixed, with 2,180 stocks declining and 1,211 advancing on the BSE. Sectoral trends were also evenly split. Financials led the losses, with the

Nifty Financial Services, PSU Banks, and Private Bank indices each falling over 1 per cent. In contrast, metal and health care stocks bucked the broader weakness.

Over two-thirds of Sensex constituents ended in the red, with HDFC Bank slipping 2.3 per cent, the biggest drag on the index. Experts said the key question for investors was whether the escalation would lead to a durable de-escalation, and the conflict's impact on global growth and earnings.

Foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) sold shares worth ₹1,711 crore, while domestic institutional investors bought equities worth ₹956 crore. For a second straight session, the intensity of FPI selling remained below the average of around ₹7,000 crore per session seen since the conflict began.

Call on Tata Sons' listing likely soon

While answering a query on when this year's top layer NBFCL will come out, Mahindra spoke about the new framework.

The new framework is expected to indicate if Tata Sons will continue to be categorised as an upper-layer NBFCL or not. Based on that clarity, Tata Sons will possibly take action on listing, a source said.

Within the Tata universe, the view on listing the holding company is split. While Tata Sons had sought an exemption from mandatory listing by turning net debt-free more than a year ago, its opinion on the issue seems to be guarded now, according to a person in the know. Tata Sons' largest shareholder, Tata Trusts, is also a divided house on listing. The company was caught in a lengthy legal battle with the Tata group after Cyrus Mistry (scion of the Shapoorji Group) was ousted as Tata Sons chairman in 2016. Shapoorji Group, keen to monetise its stake in Tata Sons to reduce its debt, called the listing of Tata Sons a moral and

Chairman N Chandrasekaran Chandra as he's popularly known) in February to give an assurance that Tata Sons would remain a private unlisted company. Noel Tata also raised questions over financial viability of some of the group businesses, linking it to Chandra's tenure getting renewed. This came just months after Tata Trusts recommended a three-five-year term for Chandra as executive chairman of Tata Sons starting February 2027.

If Tata Sons is listed, the special vote rights of Tata Trusts, under Article 121A, may have to go away.

Shapoorji Pallonji Group, the second largest shareholder in Tata Sons with an 18 per cent stake, has been pushing for Tata Sons' listing.

The company was caught in a lengthy legal battle with the Tata group after Cyrus Mistry (scion of the Shapoorji Group) was ousted as Tata Sons chairman in 2016. Shapoorji Group, keen to monetise its stake in Tata Sons to reduce its debt, called the listing of Tata Sons a moral and

social imperative to ensure transparency.

War may weigh on India Inc's Q4 results

The combined net profits of the index companies excluding banks, financial services and insurance (BFSI) are likely to grow just 3.6 per cent Y-o-Y in Q4FY26, slowing from 9.9 per cent in Q3FY26 and 10.5 per cent in Q4FY25.

Excluding BFSI and oil & gas, their net profits are likely to grow just 3.1 per cent — the lowest in the last 13 quarters — and down sharply from 11.1 per cent in Q3FY26 and 17.3 per cent in Q4FY25.

The rise in energy prices due to the United States-Iran war is, however, likely to push up revenue growth. The index companies' combined net sales (gross interest income in the case of banks and non-bank lenders) are likely to grow 11.2 per cent in Q4FY26, an improvement from 10.4 per cent in Q3FY26 and 8.3 per cent in Q4FY25.

The analysis is based on the average earnings estimates of 47 among the 50 in the index. Brokerages include Batilivala & Karani Securities, JM Financial, Motilal Oswal, Nuvama, Axis Securities, and Kotak Institutional Equity. The companies excluded from the sample are Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles, Adani Enterprises, and Jio Financial Services.

The biggest beneficiaries of the rise in commodity prices are likely to be companies dealing in oil and gas such as Oil & Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC) and Reliance Industries, followed by those in mining & metals.

The combined net sales of ONGC and Reliance Industries are likely to grow 15.4 per cent in Q4FY26, up sharply from 6.2 per cent in Q3FY26 and 5.8 per cent in Q4FY25.

Similarly, the combined net sales of four mining & metal companies that are part of the index are likely to grow

TCS net grew over 12% in Q4

TCS also highlighted strong progress in its Hypervault business, with significant strides by winning customer engagements, land parcel finalisation, and partner relationships.

K Krithivasan, chief executive officer and managing director, said in the analyst call that the company was pleased to report its third consecutive quarter of sequential growth, supported by three mega deals and a \$12 billion TCV. "We are building the next phase of TCS

10.3 per cent in Q4FY26, up from 7.8 per cent in Q3FY26 and 2.4 per cent in Q4FY25.

The revenue gains of energy and commodity producers are likely to be more than offset by lower demand in the rest of the economy from higher energy prices and a decline in the availability of industrial fuels such as natural gas and liquefied petroleum gas (LPG).

The combined net sales of the index companies excluding the BFSI, oil & gas, and mining & metals sectors are likely to grow 13.3 per cent, slowing from 15.6 per cent in Q3FY26 but improving from 11.3 per cent in Q4FY25.

"Q4FY26 earnings are likely to stay soft — a continuation of the previous seven quarters. The overall profit growth to remain subdued at 8-9 per cent and likely to result in FY26 earnings being cut. Profits are likely to be weak/slow in banks, FMCG (fast-moving consumer goods), pharma, EMS (electronics manufacturing services), but strong in domestic auto, metals, retail," wrote Prateek Parekh and Priyanka Shah of Nuvama Wealth Management in their earnings preview for Q4FY26.

Analysts at Kotak Institutional Equity (KIE) also expect single-digit growth in earnings. "We expect Q4FY26 net income of the KIE universe to increase 8 per cent Y-o-Y, led by automobiles & components, diversified financials, IT (information technology) services and metals & mining sectors. However, consumer durables & apparel, oil, gas & consumable fuels, pharmaceuticals and transportation are likely to deliver weak PAT growth," wrote Sanjeev Prasad, Sunita Baldawa, and Anindya Bhownik of KIE in their Q4 earnings preview.

West Asia and the travel and transportation industry. "We haven't seen any major impact in other industries so far...but if this leads to further supply chain disruption or any other secondary issue, then it may have some impact. But nothing at this time," he added.

During Q4, the company expanded its client base across deal sizes, with \$100 million clients increasing by two to six, and \$50 million clients rising by nine to 139.

Krithivasan explained five key elements for the quarter: continued growth for the third consecutive quarter; expansion across verticals after nearly two years; company-wide salary increments; strong progress in the Hypervault business; and growing momentum in AI services. Hypervault has now partnerships with OpenAI, AMD, and AWS, among others.

Krithivasan said the company's restructuring programme, which impacted about 2 per cent of employees, had been completed and had no effect on the Q4FY26 performance.

For the full year, TCS reported revenue of ₹2.67 trillion, up 4.6 per cent YoY. In constant currency terms, revenue declined by 2.4 per cent. Net profit for FY26 stood at ₹902.0 crore, up 1.3 per cent Y-o-Y. The company's annual revenue touched \$30 billion by the end

of FY26. TCS continued to see strong growth in AI-driven business. In Q4, annualised AI revenue reached \$2.3 billion.

Aarth Subramanian, executive director, president, and chief operating officer, said in the analyst call that FY26 marked a pivotal year for enterprise AI adoption. "For the first time since the advent of GenAI in late 2022, the shift from experimentation to scaled AI deployment showed a marked improvement. AI became a part of every customer conversation and solutioning, creating a tailwind for enterprise AI adoption. We experienced strong deal momentum across new services in enterprise transformation, digital engineering, and cloud modernisation," she said. Geographically, the UK led growth in Q4 with a 2.4 per cent quarter-on-quarter (Q-o-Q) increase, followed by North America at 1.4 per cent.

Among emerging markets, India grew 1.7 per cent, the Middle East and Africa (MEA) rose 0.4 per cent, while Asia Pacific declined 0.5 per cent. On a Y-o-Y basis, India's business continued to decline, falling 23 per cent in Q4.

Across verticals, all segments reported growth. Banking, financial services, and insurance (BFSI), TCS' largest vertical, registered marginal growth of 0.4 per cent Y-o-Y and 0.1 per cent Q-o-Q.

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8 WORLD

IN BRIEF

China mulls financial aid for airlines hit by oil shock

China is considering financial relief and other measures for its struggling state-run airlines as the Iran war sends fuel costs soaring, according to people familiar with the matter, in what could be the industry's biggest lifeline since the Covid pandemic. Government subsidies, preferential tax treatment and state-backed low-interest loans are options being explored by authorities, said the people, who asked not to be identified due to the sensitivity of the matter. Mergers are also being considered, they said. Deliberations

Israeli strikes on Lebanon threaten truce

▶ Pakistan set to host negotiations between US and Iran today as Hormuz remains under blockade

▶ Iran says Lebanon a part of ceasefire, attacks render talks 'meaningless'; Netanyahu offers direct talks

AGENCIES
Dubai/Berlin/Islamabad, 9 April

Israel bombed more targets in Lebanon on Thursday, putting the US-Iran ceasefire into further jeopardy after the biggest Israeli attacks on its neighbour of the war killed more than 250 people and threatened to torpedo Donald Trump's truce.

In Pakistan, authorities locked down the capital Islamabad in anticipation of the war's first peace



MUMBAI | FRIDAY, 10 APRIL 2026

Business Standard

are at a preliminary stage, and no decisions have been made, the people said. China's top three airlines didn't respond to a request for comment. The State-owned Assets Supervision and Administration Commission and the Civil Aviation Administration of China didn't respond to faxed seeking comment. **BLOOMBERG**

Jim Whittaker, first American mountaineer to summit Everest, dies

Celebrated mountaineer Jim Whittaker, the first American to summit Mount Everest, has died. He was 97. Whittaker, who also served as the first full-time employee of the outdoor retailer REI and later as its president and CEO, died Tuesday at his home in Port Townsend, Washington, according to a statement from his family. "Whether at home, in the mountains, or at sea, he sought to share adventure, joy, and optimism with those around him," said the statement, which was emailed by Leif Whittaker, one of his sons. "His warmth, humility, and belief in the power of nature to bring people together left an enduring legacy of care for our planet and for one another." Whittaker's 1963 ascent of Everest alongside Nawang Gombu came 10 years after the pioneering climb of Sir Edmund Hillary and Tenzing Norgay. **AP/PT**

OpenAI pauses Stargate UK data centre, citing energy costs

OpenAI said it is pausing its Stargate artificial intelligence (AI) infrastructure project in the UK, as it reins in ambitious spending plans ahead of a highly anticipated public listing. "We see huge potential for the UK's AI future," the company said in an emailed statement on Thursday. "AI compute is foundational to that goal—we continue to explore Stargate UK and will move forward when the right conditions such as regulation and the cost of energy enable long-term infrastructure investment." Stargate is OpenAI's costly plan to expand global data center capacity to run and train its AI models, starting in the US. Its first campus is in Texas, with similar projects underway in Norway and the United Arab Emirates. It announced Stargate UK in September. **BLOOMBERG**

Amazon cloud unit's annualised AI revenue exceeds \$15 bn, says CEO

Amazon's AI services at its cloud-computing unit are generating annualised revenue of more than \$15 billion, CEO Andy Jassy said, the first time the company has reported numbers on a business it has backed with billions of dollars in investment. The figure, based on first-quarter performance, represents roughly 10 per cent of Amazon Web Services' \$142 billion revenue run rate and follows years of wait from investors and analysts. The disclosure was one of several Jassy made on Thursday in his annual shareholder letter that sketched an increasingly confident portrait of the technology giant's AI ambitions. Amazon shares were up 1.5 per cent in premarket trading. Likewise, Amazon is under pressure to prove its spending on AI would pay off. The e-commerce giant predicted in February its capital outlay would total \$200 billion this year, mainly focused on AI development. **REUTERS**

talks. Access was blocked from a zone 3 km (2 miles) around the luxury Serena Hotel, where both the US and Iranian delegations are expected to stay. Guests were told to check out until Sunday as it had been "requisitioned" for an important event.

But there was no sign Iran was lifting its near-total blockade of the Strait of Hormuz, which has caused the worst disruption to global energy supplies in history, Tehran said there would be no deal as long as Israel was striking Lebanon.

In the first 24 hours of the ceasefire, just a single oil products tanker and five dry bulk carriers sailed through a strait that typically accommodated 140 ships a day before the war.

Iran will allow no more than 15 vessels a day to pass through the Strait of Hormuz under the ceasefire agreement it agreed with the US, Russia's state TASS news agency quoted an unnamed senior Iranian source as saying on Thursday.

Question of Lebanon

Israel, which invaded Lebanon last month in parallel with the war on Iran to root out the Iran-aligned armed group Hezbollah, says its actions there are not covered by the ceasefire announced late on Tuesday by Trump. Washington has also said Lebanon is not covered by the truce, but Iran and Pakistan, which acted as mediator, say it was explicitly part of the deal.

Iran's Parliament Speaker Mohammad Baqer Qalibaf, expected to head the Iranian delegation opposite US Vice President JD Vance, tweeted that Lebanon and the rest of Iran's "resistance axis" of regional allies were inseparable parts of any ceasefire.

"Ceasefire violations carry explicit costs and strong responses. Extinguish the fire immediately," he wrote on social media platform X.

Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian said attack on Lebanon "signal deception and non-compliance" and render negotiations "meaningless".

A Pakistani source said Pakistan was working on ceasefires for Lebanon as well as Yemen, where Israel has also hit Iran-aligned forces. "It will be discussed during the (upcoming) talks and we will settle it."

Israel said the ceasefire in the Iran war doesn't apply in its fight against Hezbollah.

However, Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said that he has given an instruction to begin peace talks with Lebanon that would also include the dismantling of Hezbollah. "In light of Lebanon's repeated requests to open direct negotiations with Israel, I instructed the cabinet yesterday to start direct negotiations with Lebanon as soon as possible," Netanyahu said in a statement. "The negotiations will focus on dismantling Hezbollah and establishing peaceful relations between Israel and Lebanon."



«RENEWED AGGRESSION BY THE ZIONIST REGIME AGAINST LEBANON BLATANTLY VIOLATES THE INITIAL CEASEFIRE. OUR HANDS REMAIN ON THE TRIGGER. IRAN WILL NEVER FORSAKE ITS LEBANESE BROTHERS AND SISTERS»

Masoud Pezeshkian, Iran President

«ALL US SHIPS, AIRCRAFT, AND MILITARY PERSONNEL, WITH ADDITIONAL AMMUNITION, WEAPONRY... WILL REMAIN IN PLACE IN AND AROUND IRAN, UNTIL SUCH TIME AS THE REAL AGREEMENT REACHED IS FULLY COMPLIED WITH»

Donald Trump, US President



Rescuers stand at the site of an Israeli strike carried out in Al-Mazraa in Beirut

PHOTO: REUTERS

There was no immediate response from the Lebanese government to Netanyahu's remarks.

An hour before Netanyahu's statement, Lebanese President Joseph Aoun said that the only solution to the situation in Lebanon is to achieve a ceasefire between Israel and Lebanon, followed by direct negotiations between them. He said he was working on a diplomatic track on this matter that was starting to be seen positively by international actors.

Earlier, the Israeli military said it had killed the nephew of Hezbollah's Secretary-General Naim Qassem and struck river crossings in southern Lebanon overnight. Israel hit Beirut's southern suburbs just before midnight and at dawn, and hit towns across the south on Thursday morning, Lebanese state media said.

Zeev Elkin, a member of Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's security cabinet, described Wednesday's huge attacks as a one-off, made possible because the ceasefire meant warplanes that would be flying sorties over Iran were available to hit Lebanon. "As long as this fragile ceasefire in Iran exists, we can use the entire might of our air force to badly hurt Hezbollah."

Hezbollah announced at least 20 military oper-

ations on Thursday, saying it had targeted Israeli vehicles on Lebanese territory as well as firing into northern Israel. Following Wednesday's attacks, which Lebanese officials described as a "massacre", Lebanon declared a day of mourning.

"We're picking up body parts for the most part. It's very rare that we find entire bodies intact," said a rescue worker on condition of anonymity because he was not authorised to speak to the press.

Mourning for Khamenei

Inside Iran, where the halt to six weeks of US and Iranian airstrikes has been portrayed as total victory for the clerical rulers, huge crowds turned out to commemorate 40 days of mourning for Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, killed on the war's first day.

State TV showed crowds in Tehran and other cities, with mourners in black carrying Iranian flags and portraits of Khamenei and his son and successor Mojtaba. Commemorative billboards were displayed and a huge Hezbollah flag hung from one building.

Pakistan ready for talks

Pakistan on Thursday beefed up security in the

national capital as it prepares for high-stakes talks between the US and Iran this weekend.

Pakistan Army Chief Field Marshal Asim Munir called on Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif and they reviewed the progress of Pakistan's mediation efforts to achieve sustainable peace in the region, said a statement issued by the PMO.

They vowed to provide all support to the US and Iran to reach a peaceful settlement of their conflict. They "appreciated the restraint demonstrated by all sides and reiterated Pakistan's commitment to facilitate and provide all-out support to both sides to arrive at a peacefully negotiated settlement."

Interior Minister Mohsin Naqvi assured US Charge d'affaires Natalie Baker of foolproof security for all foreign dignitaries when she met him to discuss the preparation for the upcoming talks.

Naqvi assured Baker of the security arrangements taken ahead of the talks and stated that the US delegation members were "our special guests," according to a statement issued by the Ministry of Interior. "A comprehensive plan has been prepared to provide foolproof security to all foreign guests in every respect," he was quoted as saying by Dawn.

Trump wants Hormuz commitments within days: Nato's Rutte told allies

AGENCIES
9 April

Nato Secretary General Mark Rutte has briefed some capitals that United States (US) President Donald Trump wants concrete commitments within the next few days for help securing the Strait of Hormuz, two European diplomats told Reuters on Thursday.

Rutte met with Trump in Washington on Wednesday, amid tensions within the alliance over the Iran war.

"We note the frustration in Washington, but they did not consult allies either before or after starting this war," said one of the diplomats.

"Nato as such would not play a role in the war against Iran, but allies want to be helpful in seeking longer-term solutions for Hormuz. With negotiations ongoing with Iran, this could be helpful," the diplomat said.

The US president has repeatedly called Nato a "paper tiger" and threatened to withdraw from the 32-member transatlantic alliance in recent weeks.

"Nato wasn't there when we needed them, and they won't be there if we need them again," Trump posted on Truth Social after the meeting.

Dutchman Rutte, known in Europe as a "Trump whisperer" and who has faced criticism for

frequently praising the US leader, said in an interview with CNN after Wednesday's meeting that Trump "is clearly disappointed with many Nato allies, and I can see his point."

German Chancellor Friedrich Merz said he did not want the Nato alliance to split over the Iran war but included under reported threats by US.

Include Lebanon in ceasefire

European leaders condemned Israel's attack on Lebanon that killed more than 200 people and intensified their call for Lebanon to be included in the US-Iran ceasefire deal.

Yvette Cooper, the foreign secretary of Britain, criticised Israel's

attacks on Lebanon, calling them a "deeply damaging" escalation. She said that she wanted "to see Lebanon included in the cease-fire," because failure to do so would "destabilise the whole region."

French Foreign Minister Jean-Noël Barrot said "Iran must stop terrorising Israel through Hezbollah." However, he added, Lebanon should not be the "scapegoat" of an Israeli government that is "frustrated because a cease-fire has been reached between the US and Iran."

Kaja Kallas, the top EU diplomat said that the strikes had put the cease-fire "under severe strain," and that the truce should include Lebanon.

Meta debuts 1st AI model from superintelligence team

KATIE PAUL & ADITYA SONI
9 April

Meta Platforms on Wednesday unveiled Muse Spark, the first artificial intelligence (AI) model from a costly team that assembled last year to catch up with rivals in the AI race.

Shares of the company extended gains to trade up nearly 7 per cent.

US tech giants are under pressure to prove their massive AI outlays will pay off. The stakes are especially high for Meta after it hired Scale AI chief and former officer (CEO) Alex Wang last year under a \$4.3 billion deal and offered some engineers pay packages of hundreds of millions of dollars to staff a new superintelligence team, a bid to propel itself back into the AI world's top ranks after a disappointing showing with its Llama 4 models early last year.

* Superintelligence refers to AI machines that could outthink humans. Muse Spark is the first in a new series of models, known internally as Avocado, from that team.

New AI 'Spark'

- Available only on the lightly used Meta AI app and website
- It will replace Llama models powering chatbots on Meta's platform
- Analysis shows it gives tough competition to top models in language and visual understanding
- However, lagging in features like coding and abstract reasoning

The model, the first the company has released in about a year, initially will be available only on the lightly used Meta AI app and website. In the coming weeks, it will replace the existing Llama models powering chatbots on WhatsApp, Instagram, Facebook and Meta's collection of smart glasses, the company said.

Meta did not disclose Muse Spark's size, a key measure typically used to compare an AI system's computing power with rivals. It also changed course from previous open releases of its Llama models, instead sharing only a "private preview"

of Muse Spark with unnamed partners.

"The initial model is small and fast by design, yet capable enough to reason through complex questions in science, math, and health. It is a powerful foundation, and the next generation is already in development," the company said in a blog post.

Independent evaluations of Muse Spark's performance showed it catching up with top models from market leaders Google, OpenAI and Anthropic in some areas, like language and visual understanding, but lagging in others like coding and abstract reasoning.

The model tied for fourth place on a broad index of AI tests compiled by evaluation firm Artificial Analysis.

Rough edges

Meta CEO Mark Zuckerberg had tempered expectations for early performance, telling investors in January that he thought the team's first models "will be good but, more importantly, will show the rapid trajectory that we're on."

"I expect us to steadily push the frontier over the course of the year as we continue to release new models," he had said.

Wang, who runs the new superintelligence team, acknowledged in a series of social media posts on Wednesday that "there are certainly rough edges we will polish over time in model behavior."

He said bigger versions of the model were in development and that Meta was planning to release at least some of them openly. With the release, Meta gave a clearer sense of how it aims to use its models to make

money, teasing shopping features embedded within its Meta AI chatbot that point users directly to products they can purchase.

Broadly, the company is betting that applying AI to everyday personal tasks will boost engagement among the more than 3.5 billion users across its social media platforms, potentially giving it an edge over rivals with a smaller reach.

Muse Spark can also help users with tasks such as estimating the calories in a meal from a photo or superimposing an image of a mug on a shelf to see how it looks, the company said.

An extra Contemplating Mode, which runs multiple agents simultaneously to boost reasoning power, would allow Muse Spark to take on the extended thinking modes of Google's Gemini Deep Think and OpenAI's GPT Pro.

Meta said people could use the mode for efficiently planning a family vacation, having one agent draft a travel itinerary while the other looks up kid-friendly activities. **REUTERS**

Tesla developing a new smaller, cheaper EV

REUTERS
9 April

Tesla is developing an all-new smaller, cheaper electric SUV, four people familiar with the matter told Reuters.

The automaker has contacted suppliers in recent weeks to discuss details of the plan for the compact SUV which would be a new vehicle and not a variant of Tesla's current Model 3 or Y, the people said. The conversations involved the manufacturing process and specifications for various components, they said.

Three of the people said the compact SUV would be produced in China, and one said Tesla also aims to expand production to the United States and Europe. The car would be 4.28 meters in length, or about 14 feet, two of the sources said. That's significantly shorter than Tesla's top-selling Model Y SUV, which is about 15.7 feet long.

The effort follows a decision by Chief Executive Elon Musk to scrap a highly anticipated low-cost EV project in 2024 and pivot the company to focus

on robotaxis and humanoid robots. A key question is whether this latest effort to develop a smaller SUV signals a strategy shift back to mass-market human-driven EVs or whether the new model would align more with Tesla's vision for fully autonomous vehicles.

Such a model could potentially serve both purposes, according to one of the people familiar with the new-vehicle project and a Tesla employee with knowledge of its current product philosophy.

The Tesla employee declined to confirm or deny details of any specific vehicle but said, in general, the automaker now aims to build models that would be drivable but offer a human-driven option.

While aiming for full autonomy across its lineup, the person said, Tesla realises many global markets won't see meaningful adoption nor regulatory acceptance of driverless cars for years. Preserving the option to build a particular model with or without driving controls could enhance sales and help ensure Tesla can keep its car factories running near capacity, the person said.

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Uneasy ceasefire

Mutual mistrust portends trouble for talks

Two days into a widely welcomed ceasefire between the United States (US) and Iran, residual tensions can damage the prospect of a lasting peace even before US Vice-President JD Vance lands in Islamabad for talks starting this weekend. The immediate point of contention is Israel's continued attacks on Lebanon to flush out the Iranian-affiliated Hezbollah. Tehran has described these attacks as a grave violation of the ceasefire; Israel claims Lebanon was outside the purview of the agreement, a point Mr Vance has endorsed. If this is the case, it is unhelpful in assuaging Tehran's deep-seated mistrust. Instead, US President Donald Trump has doubled down on threats couched in the language of a spaghetti Western. These are scarcely appropriate atmospherics for a truce, which the US and its allies need as much as Iran does.

There is no doubt that after 41 days of violence, destruction, and the disruption of global supply chains, during which neither the US nor Israel has achieved its ostensible war aims, dialogue is more than welcome. The fact that the US agreed to Iran's request for Mr Vance to head the talks suggests a desire for an exit plan — though the Iranians can hardly consider the inclusion of Jared Kushner and Steve Witkoff, who headed the earlier failed negotiations, as reassuring. The details of the 10-point negotiating text, which the US has accepted as the basis for talks, are unclear but the maximalist positions reportedly adopted by both sides as conditions for reopening the Strait of Hormuz suggest that common ground could be elusive.

The US conditions stipulate Iran's surrender of its highly enriched uranium and a commitment not to possess nuclear weapons; the reopening of the strait under US supervision; a dismantling of Iran-backed regional proxies; and a continued presence of US troops to monitor compliance. Tehran's conditions, as reported in the media, appear to be mirror image of US demands, including a fundamental commitment of non-aggression from the US; controlled passage through the strait, lifting all sanctions, full compensation for war damage, and a ratification of these issues in a full United Nations (UN) Security Council resolution. The emphasis on approval from the UN is noteworthy. It suggests that Iran is keen to align itself to multilateral, rule-based institutions in contrast to the US' flagrant violations of UN rules in its attacks on Iran.

A truly durable peace will depend on whether the US chooses to restrain nuclear-armed Israel's violence against settled people in pursuit of a "Greater Israel". Indeed, if this war has underlined anything, it is a fundamental readjustment of the region's security architecture, which is unlikely to benefit the US or Israel. Iran's serial attacks on Israeli and US assets based in West Asian allies exposed holes in Washington's security umbrella, undermining the value of the 2020 Abraham Accords. Regional leaders have understood that they can no longer rely, for their security, on the world's sole superpower; they have been holding discussions among themselves on joint diplomatic efforts. Significantly, on April 8-9, the foreign ministers of Iran and Saudi Arabia reportedly spoke on the phone to discuss regional stability, marking the first official contact since the war began. Whatever the outcome of the talks, West Asia is headed for a significant shift.

A new beginning

Bangladesh foreign minister's visit enables a reset in relations

Bangladesh Foreign Minister Khalur Rahman, along with the new Prime Minister's advisor on foreign affairs, Humayun Kabir, visited New Delhi in what will hopefully reset relations between the new government in Dhaka, led by the Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP), and its Indian counterpart. This is not Mr Rahman's first visit abroad as foreign minister. Last month, he went to Saudi Arabia for meetings of the Organisation of Islamic Cooperation. There he held multiple bilateral meetings, including with Pakistan. Reports also indicate that his meeting in India included a demand from Bangladesh for the extradition of its former Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina, who is currently in exile in India.

Nevertheless, New Delhi must persevere in rebuilding this important relationship. It has already made mistakes in the past; it should have begun rebuilding ties with the BNP well before it was forced to by events and the elections in Bangladesh. It is not aided in this process by the contentious atmosphere surrounding the campaigning for the Assembly elections in Assam and West Bengal, where supposed "infiltration" is a major political issue. There have also been various street protests as well as fundamentalist activities in Bangladesh, targeting supposed "pro-Indian" interests and work, including newspapers. This difficult political atmosphere is something that diplomacy cannot ignore but instead must strive to surmount.

There is a practical agenda for cooperation on which both sides must act. Connectivity infrastructure, trade facilitation, and energy policy are all areas that can be effectively depoliticised. And those promise solutions on which both sides can claim victory. Such tangible deliverables might create goodwill and not require either government to confront the harder political questions immediately. While it cannot be denied that Beijing's increasing strategic footprint in Bangladesh is a matter of concern for India, and it will add urgency to this engagement, India should certainly avoid the temptation of treating Bangladesh as a pawn in its strategic competition with China. Nor for that matter should Bangladesh be assumed as being in thrall to Pakistan even if it is making a point of improving ties with that nation. Instead, it should focus its attention on maintaining sustained, high-level engagement, which would signal that India takes Bangladesh seriously as a neighbour with its own legitimate interests and political evolution.

The BNP leadership, on its part, must work harder to signal that it intends to govern inclusively and will rein in the anti-minority and anti-Indian elements in its political coalition. It must recognise that if it finds it hard to forgive and forget, so too does New Delhi. The party's last tenure in government has left a long bitter aftertaste in India. But that was decades ago, and much has changed since then. Both countries have grown economically, and face similar challenges on issues such as energy security. There is much that they can do to collaborate. What is most important is for the Indian leadership to impress upon the new Bangladesh establishment that it does not seek to oust or manipulate it, but rather to find a new form of coexistence and collaboration. Neighbourly relationships cannot be repaired by a single visit, but this will at least be a good beginning. It must be followed up with continuous engagement at various levels of government.



ILLUSTRATION: BINAY SINHA

Iran shock shows India's external vulnerability

Managing these risks may require reining in growth ambitions

Going by the revised gross domestic product (GDP) series, the Indian economy grew by 7.2 per cent, 7.1 per cent, and 7.6 per cent in FY 24, FY 25, and FY 26, respectively. This is a truly impressive growth record in an environment marked by the Ukraine conflict, high interest rates in Western economies, and Trump tariffs.

Even a tariff rate of over 50 per cent on much of India's exports to the United States could not stop the Indian economy in its stride. With the inflation rate at an extremely benign 3 per cent, it appeared that India was finally set on a 7 per cent growth trajectory even in a difficult global environment. The conflict in Iran, now paused for two weeks, threatens to undermine these expectations.

The truly unsettling element in the scenario has been the fall in the exchange rate of the rupee. The fall pre-dates the Iran conflict. The conflict has merely accentuated an underlying trend. The nominal effective exchange rate of the rupee has fallen by 8.5 per cent and the real effective exchange rate by 8.1 per cent in the period from February 2025 to February 2026 (trade-weighted 40 currency basket). The latter is well beyond the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI's) comfort zone of 5 per cent.

A growth rate of over 7 per cent, an inflation rate below 3 per cent and a current account deficit of 0.8 per

cent scarcely justify a fall of this order. The fall has to do entirely with capital flows. There was a net foreign portfolio investment (FPI) outflow of ₹1.52 trillion in FY26. These are the highest FPI outflows ever in any given year. They exceed the outflows of ₹1.22 trillion in the Covid-impacted year of 2021-22.

In 2021-22, the growth outlook was nowhere as positive as it is today. The inflation rate was running at 5.5 per cent. The banking system was under considerable stress. The flight of foreign institutional investors (FIIs) was entirely understandable. Why would FIIs want to exit an economy growing at over 7 per cent, with inflation at 3 per cent and banking system indicators that are highly favourable?

The outflows are perceived to have happened on account of the punitive tariffs imposed on India by the Trump administration. FIIs were said to perceive the US administration's stance towards India as a big negative for the economy. It was a risk factor that argued against staying exposed to India.

The tariff issue was resolved with the Indo-US interim trade agreement in February 2025. In the same month came the judgment of the US Supreme Court striking down the Trump administration's tariff regime. For the present, India, like everybody else, is subject to tariffs of 10 per cent on its exports to the US.



FINGER ON THE PULSE
T T RAM MOHAN

Rating noise rises as linear TV declines

You could hear these words echo out of homes at 9 pm every weeknight from July 2000 onwards: *Main Amitabh Bachchan bol raha hoon aur aap dekhi rahe hain Kaun Banega Crorepati*. Over half of India's 350 million TV viewers then kept their date with Mr Bachchan on Star Plus. When he finished at 10 pm, they hung around to meet Parvati Agarwal in *Kohani Ghar Ghar Ki*, followed by Tulsi Virani in *Yunkuni Saas Bhi Kabhi Bahu Thi* at 10:30 pm.

It was the golden era of television, which began in the early '90s with the entry of Star TV, Zee, Sony and Sun TV. For over 25 years, appointment television or linear TV ruled the media business, bringing in the largest share of audience and revenues. This remained true even after streaming arrived with Hotstar (2015) and Netflix and Amazon Prime Video (2016). That golden era is now ending.

Look at the numbers. In 2019, over 210 million Indian homes had a television set — an audience size of almost 900 million. Most of these were DTH (direct-to-home) or cable homes. Thanks to the pandemic and the rise of streaming, this is down to 157 million homes, reaching 659 million people. Break it down further. A little under half of those 157 million homes are on DD Free Dish — a free DTH service from the state broadcaster. The remaining 92 million homes are either hybrid (a combination of cable/DTH plus connected TV) or only one of these. That means just a little over half of these are linear (cable/DTH). Going by government figures, hundreds of multi-system operators (distributors of TV signals) have either surrendered their licences, let them expire or had them cancelled. There is, however, no rush for new licences.

Note that these are numbers from early 2025. They have fallen further, say analysts. They don't show because the Broadcast Audience Research Council (Barc), the official ratings body, has been floundering the same reach numbers since 2018. That is when the last baseline study was done. The biggest indicator of the decline of linear TV is the sharp fall in both ad and pay revenue — from a high of ₹78,800 crore in 2019 to ₹61,700 crore in 2025, going by the FICCI-Frames report from EY. The whole idea of appointment viewing, steady ratings and advertising contracts for six- and 12-months is on a downhill.

That is the first reason recent moves to regulate ratings are puzzling.

On March 6, the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting directed Barc to withhold the ratings of news channels for four weeks. This was in light of the over-the-top coverage of the United States-Israel attack on Iran. More than a month down the line, there has been complete silence from news broadcasters, advertisers and agencies. News, which is a sliver of total TV viewership, simply doesn't matter when the reach of TV itself is shrinking.

On March 27, the government came out with a TV Ratings Policy 2026. It undoes the whole regulatory tinkering that came after three different reports, a court case, much wrangling, and all that went into dismantling the TRP mechanism under TAM (television audience measurement) and creating Barc between 2010 and 2015.

The new policy states, "Any member of the Board of Directors of the television rating company shall not be in the business of broadcasting, advertising/advertising agency." This means Barc, a venture between the

It cannot be that the tariff factor is material to the exchange rate of the rupee any more.

The material factor is the war in Iran. It has changed the outlook far more drastically than the Trump tariffs had done. The impact on growth and inflation are still manageable. Several agencies now project India's growth at 6.5-7 per cent or even 6 per cent, down from 7 per cent earlier. Inflation is projected at 4.5 to 5 per cent, which is within the RBI's tolerance band. Neither projection is scary.

It is the current account position that is seriously impacted by higher oil prices. Analysts see the current account deficit (CAD) going up to 1.8 per cent of GDP if oil prices remain at \$85 per barrel throughout the year. That is what the RBI has assumed for FY 27 in its April Monetary Policy Report. If oil prices are above \$100, CAD could be higher than 2 per cent.

That does change the perspective drastically for foreign investors. India's policymakers have always believed that a CAD of up to 2.5 per cent is manageable. What investors will focus on, however, is a significant worsening in relation to the past five years. When FIIs see CAD increasing steeply from an average of 0.8 per cent of GDP in the past five years to around 2 per cent, expectations of a depreciation in the rupee are inevitable. As FIIs head for the exit to protect their returns, these expectations will prove self-fulfilling.

It is clear that improvements in the fundamentals of the Indian economy in recent years have concealed an important vulnerability: The impact of oil prices above \$100 a barrel on the CAD. This vulnerability was not noticed because world prices have stayed below \$100 for most of the past five years, except for about four months in 2022 after the Ukraine conflict erupted. They have stayed below \$80 over the past two years.

The conviction in the markets had been that oil prices would stay in the mid-60s under President Donald Trump. The rise in oil prices to well over \$100 a barrel over the past month has upset all calculations. No surprise that, until the announcement of the ceasefire in Iran, the downward pressure on the rupee seemed relentless.

There is not much the government can do about the prices of oil and related products. It can at best focus on ensuring supply and cushioning the price impact on consumers. So far, it has done a good job on both counts.

As for the exchange rate, intervention by the RBI can only manage the fall in the rupee, it cannot prevent it. If the ceasefire does not last and oil prices stay elevated for a long period, the RBI may have little choice but to increase the policy rate. The cumulative reduction in the RBI's policy rate of 125 basis points since February 2025 is now beginning to look somewhat imprudent. With the economy growing at around 7 per cent, it may have been wiser to have exercised restraint, given the enormous uncertainties in the international environment ever since President Donald Trump assumed office in January 2025.

There is an important lesson here for policymakers. If we are to effectively manage risks in the economy, if stability is not to be compromised, it is necessary to rein in aspirations for GDP growth. In a troubled global environment, a growth rate of close to 7 per cent is not something to be sniffed at. Macroeconomic policies that seek to accelerate the growth rate at the current level of savings and investment expose the economy to avoidable risk.

ttmohan28@gmail.com



MEDIASCOPE
VANITA KOHLI-KHANKOLKAR

Indian Broadcasting Foundation, the Indian Society of Advertisers, and the Advertising Agencies Association of India, will have to restructure itself within 30 days of the notification of the guidelines. It also means the power to decide the metrics that determine the fate of the rapidly declining ₹26,300-crore television advertising market now lies with non-industry figures.

You could argue that if linear TV is in decline, how does this intervention matter? Maybe because it could set a precedent for similar interventions in private businesses. Could the state be deciding how readership data, box-office takings of a film, or digital impressions are measured?

That brings this to the second reason on the regulatory overreach is puzzling. DD Free Dish is the single largest linear TV service. It reaches anywhere from 50 million to 65 million homes. The biggest indicator of its impact comes from the fact that the channels watched on DD Free Dish — such as Dangal TV and Star Utsav — show up strongly on existing rating charts. There is no issue or complaint from advertisers or broadcasters on this one. The big screen is thriving also because of on-demand services like YouTube and Netflix. But in this world, ratings are irrelevant. Advertising is performance, not ratings driven.

What is missing is something that bridges various screens to give a composite picture. The ratings policy talks of a technology-neutral mechanism that captures data across cable, DTH and streaming. And in the next breath talks of meters, homes, and mandates a sample. That is a tough ask. Barc, an industry body with the best minds in the business, has tried for over a decade to get this one going. It is not clear how a new body that cannot have people from the business will achieve that.

X: @vanitakohli

Misconceptions on media freedom



ANJALI CHAUHAN

In contemporary India, "press freedom" is invoked with a striking duality, as a constitutional guarantee on one hand

state regulation, legal frameworks, and market expansion. Ms Philipose shows that media freedom in India has always been conditional and negotiated, shaped by enduring structures of power. Moving across decades of policy shifts and legal developments, she maps how media in India has been continuously "framed", not only by governments but also by the intertwined logic of law, capital, and technological change. Rather than treating press freedom as a given democratic ideal that comes under per-

technology and governance, tracking the transitions from print to broadcasting and from state-controlled media to liberalised, market-driven ecosystems. In doing so, it brings into view the dense web of policies, judicial interventions, and institutional arrangements that have shaped media practice over time. Moments often treated as exceptional, such as the Emergency, appear here not as aberrations but as part of a longer continuum of regulation and control. By placing these developments

media and the growing dependence on advertising revenue reconfigure the terms of editorial autonomy. Ownership patterns, cross-media consolidation, and the increasing alignment between political and corporate interests emerge as central to understanding what can be reported and how. The result is not simply external censorship but a more diffuse and internalised set of constraints, where market imperatives and regulatory pressures operate together to



Framing the Media: Government Policies, Law, and Freedom of the Press in India
by Pamela Philipose
Published by

has, instead, introduced new and more complex forms of regulation, from intermediary liability rules to expanding regimes of surveillance and content control. The shift is not simply from censorship to freedom, but from visible forms of state restriction to more diffused mechanisms of governance that operate through platforms, data infrastructures, and legal ambiguity. As state oversight deepens and platform corporations acquire unprecedented power over the circulation of

ebullient narratives of a once free press now in decline, and instead showing that constraint has been constitutive of the media landscape across time. At the same time, the book leaves certain questions underexplored. The conditions of media labour, marked by precarity, contractualisation, and deepening hierarchies of genre and caste, remain largely outside its frame. This absence is significant, for the limits of press freedom are not only institutional but also embedded in the everyday organisation of work within newsrooms and media industries. Who gets to speak, whose voices are amplified, and whose labour sustains the production of news are

questions that demand closer attention. Even so, Ms Philpote's work offers an important foundation for such inquiries. It compels us to move beyond narrow defences of press freedom towards a more expansive understanding of the political and economic structures that shape it. In doing so, the book remains both timely and necessary, even as it invites further critical engagement.

The reviewer is a researcher and writer.
X: @chauhananjali08

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For Shanthi Gears Limited
Walter Vaseeth P J
Company Secretary

Place: Calicut
Date: 09 April 2026

For Ashi India Glass Limited
Sd/-
Gopal Gandra
Executive Director
General Counsel & Company Secretary
Membership No. FT790

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For Quantum Asset Management Company Private Limited
(Investment Manager - Quantum Mutual Fund)
Sd/-
Suman Shukla
Chief Executive Officer

Place: Mumbai
Date: April 09, 2026

Mutual Fund investments are subject to market risks, read all scheme related documents carefully.

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For Sundaram Asset Management Company Ltd
R Ajith Kumar
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer

Place: Chennai
Date: April 10, 2026

Corporate Office: 1st & 2nd Floor, Sundaram Towers, 46, Whites Road, Roopethal, Chennai-14.
Contact No. (India) 1860 425 7237, (IN) +91 40 2345 2215
www.sundarammutual.com
Regd. Office: No. 21, Puludurai Road, Chennai 600 002.

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Indian Overseas Bank
Information Technology Department
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Regd. Office: Regent Chambers, 7th Floor, Jambhalji Marg, 208, Nariman Point, Mumbai 400 021. Tel: 22822700/69829000
Email: ca.vinylchemicals@pdpilite.com; Website: www.vinylchemicals.com

NOTICE
Second 100 Days Campaign - "Saksham Niveshak" for KYC and other related updation and shareholder engagement to prevent transfer of unpaid/unclaimed dividends to Investor Education and Protection Fund (IEPF)

Pursuant to Investor's Education and Protection Fund Authority (IEPFA), Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA) email dated March 27, 2026 for KYC and other updation and shareholder engagement to prevent transfer of unpaid/unclaimed dividends to IEPF, a second 100 days Campaign - "Saksham Niveshak" has been relaunched starting from 1st April, 2026 to 9th July, 2026.

During this Campaign all the shareholders who have not claimed their Dividend or have not updated their KYC & nomination details or face any issues related to unclaimed dividends and shares may write to the Company's Registrar and Transfer Agent ("RTA") i.e. M/s. MUFG Intime India Private Limited (formerly Intime India Private Limited) Unit: Vinyl Chemicals (India) Limited C-101, 1st Floor, 247 Park, Lal Bahadur Shastri Marg, Vikhroli (West), Mumbai 400 083. Tel: 610 811 8484; fax: (022) 6656 8494 or e-mail: ca@vcl.com. Website: www.vinylchemicals.com and further mail to be sent to the company at ca.vinylchemicals@pdpilite.com

For Vinyl Chemicals (India) Limited
Sd/-
Aarti Falahar
Company Secretary
FCS 8726

Place: Mumbai
Date: 9 April, 2026

DBS Bank India Limited
29/35, West Pankaj Bagh, New Delhi - 110026

INVITATION FOR EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI) FOR SALE OF EXPOSURES PERTAINING TO VAYAM TECHNOLOGIES LTD UNDER SWISS CHALLENGE METHOD.

DBS BANK INDIA LIMITED, a company registered under the Companies Act, 2013, having its registered office at GF, Plot No. 115 & 12 & FF, Plot No. 115 to 115, Capital Park, BKS Marg, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110021 and Delhi office at 29/35, West Pankaj Bagh, New Delhi - 110026 (hereinafter referred to as "DBS India") proposes to sell (by way of assignment only) and on 100% cash basis debt exposures pertaining to Vayam Technologies Ltd ("VTL") as categorized in the table below. The bid process will be conducted through Swiss Challenge Method in accordance with the Master Direction - Reserve Bank of India (Transfer of Loan Exposures) Directions, 2021 as modified, updated, amended or replaced, from time to time.

Exposure Details	Principal OIS as on 31st Mar 2026 (in million)	Reserve Price (in million)	Terms of Sale
Working Capital Loan	190.77	42.50	Cash

The interested and eligible Qualified Buyers including but not limited to Scheduled Commercial Banks, Non-Banking Financial Companies, Asset Reconstruction Companies, Small Finance Banks and All India Financial Institutions, as eligible under the regulatory framework, who would like to participate in the competitive bidding process (Swiss Challenge Method) are required to intimate their willingness to participate by submitting in writing, the expression of interest ("EOI") and including non-disclosure agreement ("NDA") with DBS India, in the format acceptable to DBS India.

For details in respect of the eligibility to participate in this Swiss Challenge process, Intimates for submission of EOI and date of conducting Swiss Challenge process please visit website of DBS India: go.dbs.com/corporate/announcements

Further, for any queries, DBS India can be contacted at vinayagowda@dbsi.com / arvindg@dbsi.com

Place: Delhi
Date: 10-04-2026

Authorized Officer

NOTICE

DISCLOSURE OF HALF YEARLY PORTFOLIO STATEMENT OF THE SCHEMES OF NJ MUTUAL FUND ("THE FUND") FOR THE HALF YEAR ENDED MARCH 31, 2026.

Notice is hereby given to all the unitholders that in accordance with Regulation 59A of the SEBI (Mutual Funds) Regulations, 1996 read with Para 6.1 of SEBI Master Circular No. SEBI/HO/IMD-PD-1/PCIR/2024/90 dated June 27, 2024, the Half Yearly Portfolio Statement of the schemes of NJ Mutual Fund as on March 31, 2026, has been hosted on the website of the Fund viz. www.njmutualfund.com and on the website of AMFI viz. www.amfiindia.com accordingly view / download the half yearly portfolio statements from the said websites.

Unitholders can also submit a request for an electronic or physical copy of the

Arcil
ASSET RECONSTRUCTION COMPANY (INDIA) LTD.
Registered Office: The Ruby, 10th Floor, 29 Senapati Bapat Marg, Dadar (W), Mumbai-28.
Website: www.arcil.co.in; CIN: U65999MH2002PL134884

INVITATION FOR EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI) FOR ASSIGNMENT OF DEBT

Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Limited (acting as Trustee of Arcil-SBPS 026-I Trust & Arcil-AARF-II Trust-Scheme 1 (Series V) Trusts) (hereinafter referred to as "Arcil") being a secured creditor vide Assignment Agreement dated September 23, 2008 and March 08, 2011 respectively, under the provisions of Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 ("SARFESI Act"), 2002, invites all eligible Asset Reconstruction Companies ("Party"/ "Bidders") under the extant Reserve Bank of India guidelines for sale of the below mentioned Non-Performing Assets. Detailed Terms and Conditions of the process are captured in the Process Document which will be shared with the eligible bidders upon receipt of the EOI along with Earnest Money Deposit (EMD).

The sale will be on 100% cash basis and the auction shall be through "Swiss Challenge Process" on "As is where is", "As is what is" "Whatever there is" and "Without recourse" basis, under the SARFESI Act, 2002, based on an existing offer. Brief details of the Financial Asset are given below:

Sr. No.	Name of Borrower	Anchor Bid*	Terms of Sale (EMD)
1	L.D. Textiles Industries Limited	5.50	0.61

*Details provided in Bid Process Document. Reserve Price shall be at mark up of 10% of the Anchor Bid.

The eligible bidders who wish to participate in the said Swiss Challenge process to acquire Arcil's portion of debt in above mentioned accounts shall submit their bids to Arcil in such form and manner as may be specified by Arcil in the bid process documents. The anticipated timelines for the auction process are as detailed below:

Sr. No.	Activity	Indicative Date
1	Advertisement Date / Expression of Interest ("EOI") start date	April 10, 2026
2	Last date of Submission of EOI along with other documents	On or before April 17, 2026, before 4:00 pm
3	Last date for accessing data room for due diligence by eligible bidders (eligible participants who have submitted EOI along with all required documents to the satisfaction of Arcil)	April 25, 2026 - before 4:00 pm
4	Submission of binding bids by email (Password Protected) only along with the EMD or physical bids to reach Arcil's office	April 30, 2026 - before 1:00 pm
5	Opening of bids	April 30, 2026, 3:00 pm onwards
6	Date of Swiss Challenge (through E-Auction platform. Timing will be shared separately)	May 04, 2026
7	Exercise of right of first refusal ("ROFR") by Anchor Bidder within one day	May 05, 2026
8	Declaration of Successful Bidder	May 05, 2026
9	Execution of Assignment Agreement	As may be mutually agreed between Arcil in discussions with the Successful Bidder

In case of any query or any clarification, you may reach out to the following authorised representatives: Ashutosh Gupta (ashutosh.gupta@arcil.co.in); Bhakti Patel (bhakti.patel@arcil.co.in)

Please note that sale of Non-Performing Asset shall be subject to the terms and conditions as stated in the bid process document and Arcil reserves the right to cancel/modify the terms of this sale at any time.

Place: Mumbai
Date: 10/04/2026

For Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Limited
As trustee of Arcil-SBPS 026-I Trust & Arcil-AARF-II Trust-Scheme 1 (Series V) Trusts)
Sd/-

RSWM LIMITED
CIN: L17115RJ0800CO008216

Registered Office: Kharghar,
P.O. Gulabpura - 311 021, District, Bhiwara, Rajasthan
Phone: +91-1483-223144 to 223150, 223478, Fax: +91-1483-223361, 223479
Corporate Office: Bhiwara Towers, A-12, Sector -1, Noida-201 301 (U.P.)
Phone: +91-120-4390300 (EPABX), Fax: +91-120-4277841
E-mail: rswm.investor@bhiwara.com; Website: www.rswm.in

NOTICE OF EXTRA-ORDINARY GENERAL

Dear Member(s),

Notice is hereby given that the Extra-Ordinary General Meeting ("EOGM") of the Members of **RSWM Limited (The Company)** will be held through Video Conferencing/Other Audio Visual Means ("VC/OAVM") on **Friday, the 8th day of May, 2026 at 2:00 P.M. (IST)**, in compliance with all the applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 and the rules made thereunder and the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligation and Disclosure Requirements) Regulation, 2015 read with all the applicable circulars in this regard issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs ("MCA") and the securities Exchange Board of India ("SEBI"), to transact the business that will be set forth in the notice convening the EOGM.

Electronic copy of the Notice of the EOGM will be sent, only by email, to those members whose e-mail address is registered with the Company/Registrar & Transfer Agent (RTA)/ Depository Participant(s) as on **10th day of April, 2026 as (cut-off date)** fixed for the purpose. The Notice of the EOGM will also be available on the website of the Company (www.rswm.in); BSE Limited (www.bseindia.com); National Stock Exchange of India Limited (www.nseindia.com) and National Securities Depository Limited (www.evoting.nsdl.com). Members can attend and participate in the EOGM through ("VC/OAVM") facility only. The Instructions for attending the EOGM through ("VC/OAVM") will be provided in the Notice of EOGM. Members attending the EOGM through ("VC/OAVM") shall be counted for the purpose of reckoning the quorum under section 103 of the Companies Act, 2013. In case if you have not registered your email id please follow the below process for registering your email id:

In case Physical shareholding
Send a duly signed request letter in Form ISR-1 along with supporting documents to the RTA of the Company i.e. MCS Share Transfer Agent Limited (Unit : RSWM Limited), 179-180, DSDC Shed, 3rd Floor, Okhla Industrial Area, Phase-I, New Delhi-110020 or scanned copy on email at helpdesk@delhi@mcsharestrans.com and provide the following details/documents for registering email address:
a) Folio No., b) Name of shareholder, c) Email ID, d) Copy of PAN card (self-attested), e) Copy of Aadhaar (self-attested) f) Copy of share certificate (front and back) g) Contact Number.

Following additional details/documents need to be provided in case of updating Bank Account details: a) Name and Branch of the Bank in which you wish to receive the dividend, b) the Bank Account type, c) Bank Account Number, d) MICR Code Number, e) IFSC Code, and f) Copy of the cancelled cheque bearing the name of the first shareholder.

In case Demat
Please contact your Depository Participant (DP) and register your email

Jio BlackRock

Jio BlackRock Asset Management Private Limited
(CIN - U66301MH2004PTC043200)

Registered office: Unit No: 1301, 13th Floor, Altium Building, Plot No.130, Worli Estate, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400018, Maharashtra, India.
Website: www.jioblackrockamc.com

NOTICE NO. 01 / 2026-27
HALF YEARLY PORTFOLIO STATEMENT OF THE SCHEME(S) OF JIO BLACKROCK MUTUAL FUND.

Notice is hereby given that the half yearly portfolio statement of the scheme(s) of Jio BlackRock Mutual Fund ("the Fund") as on March 31, 2026, has been hosted on the website of Jio BlackRock Asset Management Private Limited viz. (<http://www.jioblackrockamc.com>) and on the website of AMFI viz. (<http://www.amfiindia.com>).

Unitholders may accordingly view / download the statements from the above-mentioned websites.

Unitholders can also submit a request for physical or electronic copy of the Half Yearly Portfolio Statement of the scheme(s) of the Fund through the following modes/options:

- Telephone:** Contact us at our Customer Care Centre at +91 22-352077005 & +91 22-69987700 (Monday - Friday, 9 a.m. - 6 p.m. & Saturday, 9 a.m. - 1 p.m.); or
- E-mail:** Send us an e-mail at service@jioblackrockamc.com from registered e-mail id; or
- Letter:** Submit a request letter at any of the Official Point of Acceptance ("OPA") of the schemes of the Fund. Investors can visit our website i.e. www.jioblackrockamc.com for the updated list of OPA.

For and on behalf of **Jio BlackRock Asset Management Private Limited** (Investment Manager to Jio BlackRock Mutual Fund)
Sd/-
Place: Mumbai
Date : April 09, 2026
Authorised Signatory

Mutual Fund investments are subject to market risks, read all scheme related documents carefully.

Berger
100 YEARS OF TRUST

BERGER PAINTS INDIA LIMITED
(CIN: L51434WB1925PL004760)
Registered Office: Berger House, 129 Park Street, Kolkata - 700017
Corporate Office: Plot No. CF-4, Action Area IC, New Town, Kolkata 700156, Telephone : 91477 24040
E mail: consumerfeedback@bergerindia.com; Website : www.bergerpaints.com

NOTICE TO SHAREHOLDERS
(SECOND 100 DAYS CAMPAIGN - "SAKSHAM NIVESHAK")

Dear Shareholders,

In line with the earlier campaign, the Investor Education and Protection Authority (IEPFA), Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA) through its communication dated 27th March 2026, has requested companies to initiate the Second 100 Days Campaign - "Saksham Niveshak".

In line with this initiative, your Company is pleased to inform you of the commencement of **Second 100 Days Campaign - "Saksham Niveshak"** which will be available till 9th July, 2026.

This initiative aims to proactively engage with shareholders and assist them in updating their records and claiming their rightful entitlements, thereby avoiding the transfer of their shares and unclaimed dividends to the Investor Education and Protection Fund Authority (IEPFA).

Benefits to Shareholders:

- Update PAN, Nomination details, Contact information (postal address, mobile number), Bank account details, and Specimen signature.
- Ensure dividends are credited directly to the shareholder's bank account.
- Claim their Unpaid / Unclaimed Dividends for any financial year in order to prevent their dividend amount and shares being transferred to IEPFA.

Required Forms and Documents:

Shareholders are requested to submit the following forms and documents:

- Form ISR-1: Duly filled and signed, with self-attested KYC documents.
- Form ISR-2: Duly filled and signed, with banker's attestation of your signature and original cancelled cheque (with your name printed) or self-attested bank passbook/statement.

the Half Yearly Portfolio Statement of NJ Mutual Fund schemes through the following modes/options:

1. Contact us at our Customer Care Centre at 1800502288 / 040-49703510 from 9.00 am to 7.30 pm (Monday to Saturday); or
2. Email us at customercare@njmutualfund.com from your registered e-mail id; or
3. Send a SMS to 7289005555 from your registered mobile number. SMS format: Type <IP> Space <Folio Number> Space <Scheme Code>; or
4. Write to us and submit a written request letter at any of the Investor Service Centres (ISC) of NJ Mutual Fund.

Unitholders can visit our website www.njmutualfund.com for the updated list of ISC.

Unitholders are requested to visit www.njmutualfund.com to claim their Unclaimed Redemption amounts and follow the procedure prescribed therein.

For NJ Asset Management Private Limited
(Investment Manager to NJ Mutual Fund)
Sd/-
Vineet Nayyar
Director and Chief Executive Officer
(DIN: 10690316)

Date: April 08, 2026
Place: Mumbai

For further details, please contact: NJ Asset Management Private Limited (CIN: U67100GJ2002PTC048958) Registered office: Block no. 801, 3rd Floor, C Tower, Ultraa Udyognagar Sarthi Commercial Complex, Central Road No.10, Ultraa, Sarthi - 394210, Gujarat. Telephone Number - 0281 8715601. Corporate office: Unit no. 101A, 1st Floor, Halkhumbh Business Plaza, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400051. Telephone number: 022 6940000 / 1800 500 288 / 040-49703510. Email id: customercare@njmutualfund.com Website: www.njmutualfund.com

MUTUAL FUND INVESTMENTS ARE SUBJECT TO MARKET RISKS, READ ALL SCHEME RELATED DOCUMENTS CAREFULLY.

shareholding address and bank account details in your demat account, as per the process advised by your DP.

Manner of casting vote(s) through e-voting:
Members may note that they have opportunity to cast their vote on the businesses that will be set forth in the notice of EOGM of the Company through e-voting system. The manner of remote e-voting and e-voting during EOGM for Members holding shares in physical mode, dematerialized form and for members who have not registered their email addresses will be provided in the Notice of EOGM.

Members are requested to carefully read the Notice of the EOGM and in particular instruction for joining the EOGM and the manner of casting vote through remote e-voting or e-voting during the EOGM.

This above information is being issued for the information and benefit of all the members of the Company and is in compliance with the Act, MCA Circulars and SEBI Circulars.

By Order of the Board of Directors
For RSWM LIMITED

Sd/-
Suresh Gupta
Sr. Vice President - Legal & Company Secretary
M.No.FCS-2615

Place : Noida
Date : 9th April, 2026

- Form 00-13: For casting a nominee.
- Form ISR-3: For opting out of nomination.

Shareholders who hold shares in physical mode are requested to complete the KYC updates and convert their shares into dematerialised form. The KYC forms are available on the website of the Company at <https://www.bergerpaints.com/investors/services> and on the RTA's website at <https://ebml.com/>. For conversion of physical securities into dematerialised form, kindly reach out to your respective depository participant.

Shareholders can submit their query(ies) or service requests regarding unclaimed dividend(s) and or share(s) and KYC documents to Company's Registrar & Transfer Agent (RTA) at the following address:
C B Management Services (P) Limited
Rajesh Court, 8th Floor,
20, Sir R N Mukherjee Road, Kolkata - 700 001
Telephone - +91 33 69068200
E-mail: rtab@ebml.com

We encourage all shareholders to act promptly within the campaign period to safeguard their entitlement and ensure compliance with statutory requirements.

For Berger Paints India Limited
Sd/-
Arunito Ganguly (FCS-9285)
Vice President & Company Secretary

Place : Kolkata
Date : 10th April, 2026

NOTICE

DISCLOSURE/HOSTING OF HALF YEARLY PORTFOLIO OF THE SCHEMES OF UNIFI MUTUAL FUND

All unit holders of Unifi Mutual Fund are hereby informed that, pursuant to Regulation 59A of the SEBI (Mutual Funds) Regulations, 1996, and SEBI circulars issued from time to time in this regard, the half-yearly portfolio disclosure for the period ended March 31, 2026, for the schemes of Unifi Mutual Fund is available on the following websites:

- www.unifimf.com
 - www.amfiindia.com (Association of Mutual Funds in India)
- Investors may access or download the portfolio disclosures from the above-mentioned websites.
- Further, investors may request a physical or electronic copy of the half-yearly portfolio, free of cost, through any of the following modes:
- Email: services@unifimf.com
 - Investor Help Line: 1800-309-2833
 - Written Request: Sent to the registered office of Unifi Asset Management Private Limited at the address provided below.

Investors are requested to take note of the above.

For Unifi Asset Management Private Limited,
(Investment Manager to Unifi Mutual Fund)
Authorised Signatory

Place: Chennai
Date: April 10, 2026

For more information please contact:
Unifi Asset Management Private Limited
(Investment Manager to Unifi Mutual Fund)
CIN: U66303TN2023PTC66661

Mutual Fund investments are subject to market risks, read all scheme related documents carefully.



NOTICE

DSP MUTUAL FUND

Disclosure of Half-Yearly Portfolio Statement of schemes of DSP Mutual Fund

NOTICE is hereby given to all Investor(s)/Unitholder(s) of DSP Mutual Fund ("Fund") that in accordance with Regulation 59A of Securities and Exchange Board of India (Mutual Funds) Regulations, 1996 read with clause 5.1.3. of SEBI circular no. SEBI/HO/IMD/POD-1/PCIR/2024/90 dated June 27, 2024 on Master Circular for Mutual Funds, the half-yearly portfolio statement of the schemes of the Fund for the half year ended March 31, 2026 has been hosted on the website of the Fund viz. www.dspim.com and on the website of AMFI viz. www.amfiindia.com. Investors may accordingly view/download the portfolio statement of the schemes from the website of the Fund.

Investors/Unitholders can request for physical or electronic copy of the statement of half yearly portfolio of the schemes through any of the following means:

- a. SMS:- Send an SMS to 926627288 from investor's registered mobile number. SMS format "HYPORTFOLIO<space>Folio". Example: HYPORTFOLIO 123456
- b. Telephone:- Give a call at our Contact Centre at 1800 208 4499 / 1800 200 4499
- c. Email:- Send an email to service@dspim.com
- d. Letter:- Submit a letter at any of the AMC Offices or CAMS Investor Service Centres, list available at www.dspim.com

Any queries/clarifications in this regard may be addressed to: **DSP Asset Managers Private Limited ("AMC")** CIN: U65990MH2021PTC362316, Investment Manager for DSP Mutual Fund, Address: The Ruby, 25th Floor, 29, Senapati Bapat Marg, Dadar (West), Mumbai - 400028, Tel. No.: 91-22-66578000, Toll-free: 1800 208 4499 or 1800 200 4499 Email ID: service@dspim.com Website: www.dspim.com

Unitholders are requested to update their PAN, KYC, email address, mobile number, nominee details with AMC and are also advised to link their PAN with Aadhaar Number. Additionally, Unitholders can view the Investor Charter, check for any unclaimed redemptions, Income Distribution cum Capital Withdrawal (IDCW) payments or any inactive and unclaimed folios on the Fund's website.

Place: Mumbai
Date: April 09, 2026

Mutual Fund investments are subject to market risks, read all scheme related documents carefully.

Business Standard MUMBAI | FRIDAY, 10 APRIL 2026

The Smart Investor

Direct MF plans outpaced regular schemes in FY26 folio growth

21 million folios were added via the direct route compared to 15 million in regular plans

ABHISHEK KUMAR
Mumbai, 9 April

Direct plans of mutual fund (MF) schemes added more folios than traditionally dominant regular plans during financial year 2025-26 (FY26), despite turbulence in equity markets.

These do-it-yourself (DIY) plans saw nearly 21 million individual investor folio additions in FY26 (as of February), compared to about 15 million net additions in regular plans. This marks only the second instance of direct plans outpacing regular plans in annual folio growth.

However, unlike the previous instance in FY24, the stronger growth in FY26 has come at an unexpected time. Direct plans typically see higher investor traction during favourable market conditions, while regular plans have historically fared better in periods of volatility. The divergence, experts said, can partly be



ILLUSTRATION: BINAY SINHA

Gaining ground

Direct plan folios have grown at a faster pace in each of the past 5 years

Month	Direct* (mn)	Y-o-Y growth (%)	Regular* (mn)	Y-o-Y growth (%)
Mar '22	31.7	77.1	97.0	22.2
Mar '23	37.2	17.4	107.7	11.0
Mar '24	54.1	45.4	127.7	13.9
Mar '25	80.0	48.6	153.0	24.4
Feb '26	101.0	25.9	168.0	9.8

*Individual investor folios Source: Industry data

attributed to a surge in investor interest in gold and silver exchange-traded funds (ETFs) and fund of funds (FoFs). Gold and silver offerings by mutual funds witnessed a sharp rise in inflows and folio additions in the second half (H2) of FY26, as a rally in precious metal prices and heightened geopolitical uncertainties brought them into focus.

Folio additions are considered a better gauge of retail investor behaviour than

inflows, as overall flows can be skewed by large institutional allocations. According to experts and mutual fund officials, the relatively higher growth in direct plan folios continues a trend seen in the post-Covid period. Direct plans, introduced in 2013, have consistently clocked higher growth rates, albeit on a lower base.

The pickup in direct plans among individual investors, they said, has been driven by ease of investing offered by fin-

tech platforms and rising awareness of their cost advantage. "I think the disproportionate growth in favour of direct plan is largely attributable to the reach provided by fintech platforms. The 'MF Sahi Hai' campaign of the Association of Mutual Funds in India (AMFI) has also contributed," said Aashish Somaiya, chief executive officer (CEO), WhiteOak Capital MF.

Dhirendra Kumar, CEO of Value Research, said that invest-

ors are increasingly becoming aware of the higher costs involved in regular plan.

"Investment platforms, Securities and Exchange Board of India's (Sebi's) push for transparency, and frankly the internet have made the cost of a regular plan visible in a way it never was before. Once an investor sees that number, the decision makes itself. Market volatility does not change this calculus. If anything, a falling market makes cost-consciousness sharper, because every basis point of expense drag hurts more when returns are lower," Kumar said.

Regular plans are costlier as they pay commissions to distributors. While folio additions in direct plans grew at a faster pace than regular plans, the impact of market volatility was evident in overall investor additions. The industry added 36 million individual investor folios in FY26 (as of February), compared to 56.2 million additions in FY25.

STREET VIEW

"THE SITUATION IN WEST ASIA HAS RELATIVELY IMPROVED BUT THINGS REMAIN FLUID. GIVEN THAT VOLATILE PARTICIPANTS ARE INVOLVED, IT COULD DETERIORATE AT ANY TIME"

Peter Dragicevich
Asia Pacific Currency Strategist, Compay Solutions



'West Asia war duration, oil price vital for markets'

Foreign investors have kept away from Indian markets for some months amid high valuations, the Iran war, and concerns about the impact of artificial intelligence. **Rashesh Shah**, chairman and managing director of Edelweiss Financial Services, tells Puneet Wadhwa in an email interview that over multiple market cycles, strong outcomes typically come from staying invested rather than reacting to swings. Edited excerpts:

You have seen several stock market cycles. What are the similarities and differences you see in this one?

■ Yes, the stock market has gone through many cycles since the start of my career in 1989 when the Sensex was at 680. There was the Harshad Mehta aftermath, the dotcom bust, 2008, the IL&FS crisis, and Covid-19. Each cycle had a different trigger, but the emotional texture was always the same—in the middle of it, the pessimism feels permanent. It never is.

What makes this phase distinct is the layering. You have a geopolitical shock in West Asia, an energy supply disruption through the Strait of Hormuz, aggressive FI (foreign institutional investor) selling, currency pressure, and a valuation reset—all arriving together.

In 2008, the shock was largely financial and psychological. During Covid-19, the impact was biological and societal in nature. This time, it is geopolitical and energy-led, which hits India's current account and fiscal math simultaneously. That said, the structural foundation—domestic savings, formalisation, digitisation—is far stronger today than in any previous downturn, which provides a resilient cushion through such phases.

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) maintained rates on Wednesday but cautioned against the West Asia war impact. What's your reading of the policy statement?

■ The key variable is the duration of the West Asia conflict and what happens to oil prices from here. If crude stays above \$100 for a sustained period, central banks face a very uncomfortable policy mix—slowing growth and sticky inflation at the same time.

event—it is more regional and rotating. The old comfort of India's synchronised global easing may not be available this time.

Do you think the government's policy support amid the West Asia war has been too late and too little?

■ In a fast-moving geopolitical crisis, policy response at times may look late in hindsight but may not actually be the case. Let's look at what has been done: Excise duty on fuel was cut by 110 paise, diesel duty brought to zero, export levies imposed to protect domestic supply, and the RBI has been active on currency management. The annualised fiscal cost of the fuel duty cut alone is estimated at over ₹1.5 trillion. These are not small steps.

If the conflict is prolonged, there may be more targeted interventions—support for energy-intensive sectors, facilitation of alternative crude sourcing, and calibrated liquidity measures. The priority should be to prevent a temporary external shock from turning into a domestic demand contraction. On that front, the government's instincts and directions have been right.



What is an ideal investment strategy now?

■ Avoiding any extreme decisions, the right approach would be asset allocation, not prediction. Keep adequate liquidity, stagger equity exposure through SIPs and staggered lump sums, and focus on businesses with strong balance sheets and pricing power. Cash has a role—but as optionality, not as a permanent thesis. The real risk is not the mark-to-market volatility of the next quarter, but the loss of

Demat a/c growth at 11-month low in March

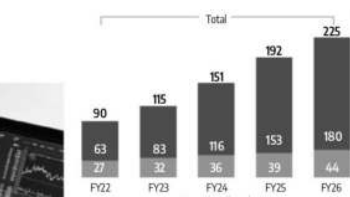
SUNDAR SETHURAMAN & MAYANK PATWADHAN
Mumbai, 9 April

The pace of new demat account additions in March hit an 11-month low, following the equity markets' sharpest monthly decline since the pandemic-led rout of March 2020. This slump came amid escalating tensions in West Asia, which drove up crude oil prices

Sharp decline

Active demat accounts in (mn)

SOURCE: NSE/CDSL



driver of account openings in FY25, also saw a shift in momentum. While FY26 was a record year in terms of fund mobilisation—12 IPOs raised ₹1.8 trillion—investor enthusiasm moderated. Average listing gains dropped sharply to 8 per cent from 30 per cent a year earlier, while retail participation weakened, with average IPO applications falling to 1.3 million from 2.13 million, accord-

and clouded India's prospects for growth and inflation.

About 2.15 million new accounts were added—the lowest since April 2023 and also below the 12-month average of 2.7 million. In March, the Sensex and the Nifty dropped more than 11 per cent. Overall growth also moderated in FY26, as weaker market returns and volatility weighed on retail sentiment.

Net additions slowed to about 32 million in FY26, even as the total number of demat accounts crossed 225 million, according to data from depositors NSDL and CDSL. This



As on March end
FY Net addition
CDSL: Central Depository Services (India) Limited,
NSDL: National Securities Depository Limited
Sources: Sebi, CDSL, NSDL. Compiled by BS Research Bureau

marks a 22 per cent decline from FY25, when a record 41 million accounts were added, driven by a strong bull run, robust activity in initial public offerings (IPOs), and heightened retail participation. The moderation comes against the backdrop of lack-

lustre equity market performance. India's benchmark indices logged their weakest showing in six years in FY26, with the Nifty 50 declining 5.1 per cent and the Sensex falling 7.1 per cent. The Nifty Midcap 100 gained 1.9 per cent, while the Smallcap 100

fell nearly 6 per cent. Heightened volatility further dampened investor appetite. Global uncertainties sustained foreign portfolio investor outflows and geopolitical tensions, triggered intermittent corrections in domestic equities. The primary market, a key

into Prime Database. Average daily turnover in the cash segment declined 6 per cent year-on-year to ₹1.13 trillion. While derivatives turnover rose modestly, activity on the NSE showed signs of strain. Demat account growth in FY27 is expected to remain steady but more normalised. Structural tailwinds such as financialisation of savings, digital adoption, and expanding investor awareness will support additions, though subdued returns and softer IPO traction may keep the pace below FY25 highs.

That is a stagflation-like scenario.

We see a situation where policy responses may diverge. The US Fed may hold firm on rates given its inflation mandate, while the RBI may prioritise growth and currency stability. This divergence creates volatility but it also means there is no single global risk-off

discipline that often may come with it—stepping away from long-term compounding in response to near-term noise. Over multiple market cycles, some of the strongest outcomes have typically come from staying invested through such phases rather than reacting to them.

Sebi bans Trdez Investment for 'ponzi-like scheme'

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) has imposed a penalty of ₹1 crore on stock broker Trdez Investment for allowing its registration to be misused by connected entities that allegedly mobilised funds from investors through high-return schemes.

Earlier, exchanges had expelled the broker. In an adjudication order, Sebi said

directors of the firm, along with associated persons, had created a network of partnership firms that raised money from the public while claiming links to the Sebi-registered broker.

These entities allegedly promised returns of 8-10 per cent per month and operated in a manner "akin to Ponzi schemes". BS REPORTER

Nippon India, ICICI Pru top MF growth charts in FY26

Nearly a third of the top 10 fund houses topped the industry's growth in 2025-26 (FY26). Nippon India Mutual Fund (NMF) topped the chart with a 30.1 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y) rise in average assets under management (AUM) in the fourth quarter. ICICI Prudential MF followed with a 25.5 per cent Y-o-Y growth as it continued to narrow the gap with industry leader SBIMF.

In absolute terms, ICICI Prudential MF and SBI MF contributed the most to the industry's growth in FY26,

adding ₹2.2 trillion and ₹1.8 trillion, respectively, to their quarterly average AUM.

Among the top 10 fund houses, Tata MF was the third and the only other fund house in the top 10 to grow faster than the industry average, registering a 21.2 per cent increase—marginally above the industry growth of 20.9 per cent.

The MF industry logged over 20 per cent growth in AUM for the third consecutive year in FY26, even as equity market volatility moderated the pace of expansion. ABHISHEK KUMAR

On growth path



Source: Amfi

Exchanges extend validity for SME IPO approvals amid global turmoil

Stock exchanges have extended the validity of in-principle approvals granted to small and medium enterprises (SMEs) planning to launch initial public offerings (IPOs), following a similar relaxation by the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) for main-board issuances. Under the revised framework, SMEs whose listing approvals are set to expire between April 1 and September 30 will get a one-time extension until September 2026, exchanges said.

Companies availing of the extension will be required to submit an undertaking confirming compliance with Sebi's Issue of Capital and Disclosure Requirements Regulations at the time of filing their offer documents. BS REPORTER

NCLT notice on Sebi plea in Jindal Poly Films class action

The Principal Bench of the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) on Thursday issued notice on an intervention application by the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) in an ongoing class action against Jindal Poly Films, seeking responses from the firm and other respondents. This arises out of a petition under Section 245 of the Companies Act, 2013, which allows shareholders to file class action proceedings against a firm for acts of alleged mismanagement. BS REPORTER

Kotak Mutual Fund launches Multi Asset Fund FoF

Kotak Mutual Fund on Thursday announced the launch of Kotak Multi Asset Active Fund of Fund (FoF), an asset allocation product which will dynamically invest into equity-oriented schemes, debt-oriented schemes and commodity-based schemes.

The scheme will invest 10-80 per cent of the corpus into equity and hybrid schemes, 10-60 per cent into debt funds, and 10-30 per cent into commodity ETFs. Nilesh Shah,

Managing Director at Kotak Mahindra AMC, said the scheme solves the complexity of allocating across schemes.

"Most investors either over-monitor and overtrade, or they set it and forget it and end up with a lopsided portfolio. The FoF would endeavour to solve this by doing the asset allocation, rebalancing, and scheme selection across Kotak and other AMC schemes within a single fund structure," he said. BS REPORTER

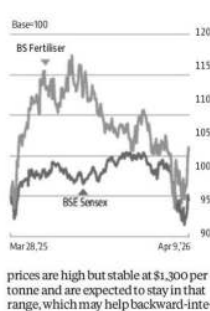
THE COMPASS

Margin pressures ahead for fertiliser sector

DEVANGSHU DATTA

The chemical industry, especially the fertiliser sector, has been considerably impacted by the Iran war as it uses crude and natural gas as feedstock. Prices have shot up, and prolonged conflict could lead to a supply squeeze.

The Government of India (GoI) has approved higher nutrient-based subsidy (NBS) rates on fertilisers for the first half of 2026-27 (H1FY27), for the Kharif season. There are 10 per cent hikes of subsidies on Nitrogen (N), Phosphate (P) and Sulphur (S) based fertilisers, while Potassium (K) rates remain unchanged. The Budgetary expectation is ₹4,500 crore in H1FY27, versus ₹3,200 crore in H1FY26. Manufacturers will still face margin pressure unless they undertake price hikes. So far, phosphoric acid



prices are high but stable at \$1,300 per tonne and are expected to stay in that range, which may help backward-integrated players with healthy margins. However, ammonia, and sulphur have seen sharp price jumps—30 per cent and 21 per cent, respectively quarter-on-quarter (Q-o-Q). Di-ammonium phosphate (DAP) prices at \$780 per tonne will also put pressure on margins for import-dependent players.

India imports 75 per cent of its ammonia and 53 per cent of sulphur. Around 20 per cent of urea and one-third of DAP consumption is also directly imported, apart from natural gas imports as feedstock. West Asia is a key fertiliser manufacturing region, and most Indian imports come from there.

If the war is prolonged, there may be supply chain disruptions, which will impact production of complex fertilisers and urea, by 10-15 per cent. Apart from profitability, capacity utilisation

may drop. Higher prices will also mean higher working capital requirements and may raise the subsidy bill more than estimated.

Backward integration could help corporates like Coromandel International and Paradeep Phosphates as they are better placed to ride out the crisis. In contrast, Deepak Fertilisers has no backward integration and faces higher risk. Chambal Fertilisers, which is urea-focused, is exposed to natural gas availability and price volatility.

Given the politically sensitive nature of the sector, the government has a track record of fast subsidy disbursement. In India, urea accounts for 45 per cent of fertiliser consumption, while complex fertilisers like DAP and nitrogen, phosphorus and potassium (NPK), account for one-third consumption, and single super phosphate (SSP) and muriate of potash (MOP) contribute about 20 per cent.

This is a crucial time for Kharif planting. An El Niño effect is expected in cal-

endar year 2026 (CY26), which could lead to monsoon deficit compared to CY2025's 8 per cent above-normal rainfall. This could mean lower sowing, leading to lower agricultural output and hence softer demand for agrochemicals and fertilisers. The government has tried to offset possible LNG shortages by allocating 70 per cent gas to urea producers.

It's also estimated by Crisil that the industry's inventory of raw material will last around three months, assuming imports from alternate sources continue. Urea manufacture is energy-intensive and profitability is also dependent on differences between prescribed energy norms and actual energy consumption, while natural gas costs are passed through. Efficient manufacturers consume less energy than prescribed norms, which boosts their profitability.

But if capacity utilisation is down, energy efficiency also takes a hit. The industry may require additional subsidy support beyond NBS hikes. The overall

FY27 subsidy Budget could increase 12-15 per cent from the Budget estimates of ₹1.71 trillion for FY27.

Agrochemical companies, including pesticides, such as Coromandel, Paradeep, PI Industries, UPL, Sharda Cropchem, Bayer CropScience and Rallis, could all be affected as well as pure fertiliser players. There will be a base effect since in Q4FY25 most companies liquidated inventory, leading to a jump in volumes and creating a high base. This could lead to muted growth.

For fertiliser urea, Q4 is typically the weakest in terms of volumes and margins. In Q4FY26, volumes may be flat year-on-year (Y-o-Y), but profitability is likely down, given the gas price spikes in March. There are serious concerns for Q1FY27 and beyond. This could in turn lead to sharp food inflation if agricultural production is down. This is a challenging environment for the agricultural sector and has broader implications too.

Info Edge Q4 billings slow on muted hiring, Gulf risks

Iran spillover drags growth; margins on edge

RAM PRASAD SAHU
Mumbai, 9 April

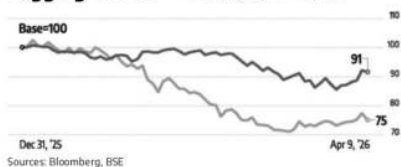
The stock of Info Edge (India) fell 2.9 per cent at close on Thursday after the company reported muted growth in recruitment billings for the fourth quarter (January-March/Q4) of 2025-26. Brokerages expect its operating performance to be impacted, with margins likely to contract on a sequential basis.

The stock has declined 25 per cent since the start of calendar year 2026, weighed down by weak hiring trends, uncertainty in the information technology sector, and concerns that higher marketing spends might pressure margins. Any rerating at current valuations would require a meaningful improvement in the macroeconomic (macro) environment. At current levels, the stock trades at about 55x its 2026-27 (FY27) earnings estimates.

Q4 performance is the near-term trigger for the stock. In a pre-quarter business update, the company reported standalone billings (across segments) growth of 7.4 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y), lower than the 11.8 per cent growth recorded in the third quarter (October-December/Q3). Growth was also affected by a high base of 18.4 per cent last year. Its largest segment, recruitment (Naukri)



Lagging behind



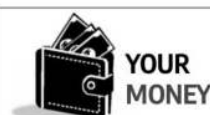
Sources: Bloomberg, BSE

the first nine months of the year. These factors also weighed on billings in the business-to-business (B2B) segment during the quarter, it added.

JM Financial Research has a "reduce" rating on the stock with a target price of ₹1,050 per share. According to the brokerage, macro pressures and a high base weighed on recruitment trends in Q4. Ana-

said changes in the sales organisation and processes had a transitional impact on Q4 billings.

The matrimonial (Jeevasathi) business maintained over 20 per cent Y-o-Y growth in Q4, with full-year growth at 28.5 per cent. The education (Shiksha) segment remains under pressure, declining 13 per cent Y-o-Y. Revenue has been hit as artificial intelligence-driven



PRICE GROWTH SLOWDOWN IN HOUSING

Smaller developers with high inventory may negotiate on price

SANJEEV SINHA

India's residential property market has entered a phase of moderation after a period of sharp post-pandemic acceleration. According to Anarock Group, average housing prices across the top seven cities inched up to ₹9,456 per sq ft in the first quarter of 2026, a modest 2.1 per cent sequential rise, signalling that the earlier momentum is losing steam.

A similar note of caution came recently from Crisil, which expects residential price growth to slow to 3-5 per cent in 2026-27 (FY27), a sharp drop from the robust 11 per cent annualised growth seen between FY22 and FY25.

Elevated the slowdown

Why the property prices have strained affordability and slowed down the pace of transactions. "After a phase of strong double-digit growth, some flattening in prices was inevitable," says Ashwin Chadha, chief executive officer (CEO), India Sotheby's International Realty.

"The war in West Asia and broader global headwinds, leading

to layoffs and job uncertainties, have led many buyers to put their purchase decisions on hold," says Prashant Thakur, executive director and head, research and advisory, Anarock Group. Housing supply has risen across the top seven cities, with over 125,000 units being launched in January-March quarter of 2026, while demand has softened.

Tap into opportunities

The moderation in price growth spells opportunity for buyers.

Mkt momentum losing steam



"While large developers are not offering major discounts, some are offering flexi-payment options. Smaller developers with high inventory remain open to negotiations," says Thakur.

Experts say opportunity is emerging in secondary markets across the top seven cities. "Opportunity is also available selectively in the luxury segment where some investors may become impatient and offer better deals," says Chadha.

Negotiating with large, listed developers, especially in low-inventory projects, may be challenging. "Buyers seeking a good price may consider smaller developers, provided they have a good construction track record," says Thakur. Chadha suggests that while developers are unlikely to publicly cut prices, there is room for negotiation behind closed doors.

Beware of delays

Construction costs have gone up amid the war. Most large and listed developers remain financially sound. They have also become more cautious about delays and non-completion. "However, projects by

smaller developers with high available stock may face issues, making careful due diligence by buyers essential," says Thakur.

Do not overleverage

In the current environment, buyers must avoid overleveraging. "Maintaining a conservative loan-to-value ratio helps keep debt manageable in case there are interest rate hikes or income fluctuations," says Abhishek Kumar, Sebi-registered investment adviser and founder, SahajMoney.com.

A married couple should limit their total equated monthly instalment (EMI) to 35-40 per cent of net take-home income. "Buyers should maintain an emergency fund covering 6-12 months of expenses, including EMIs," says Kumar.

Investors face longer exit timelines

The premium segment (₹5-20 crore), where investor activity has been high, especially in markets such as Gurugram, Noida, Pune, and Hyderabad, poses risks. "Investors who entered during the 2024-25 upcycle may face longer exit timelines. They should temper their return expectations," says Chadha.

Risks could grow in case of prolonged market stagnation. "Interest costs could erode the returns of leveraged investors," says Chadha. He suggests that investors planning exits in 2026 should reset their price expectations, especially in areas with a lot of new supply. Those holding quality assets in strong micro-markets should stay patient and wait until they get a good exit.

The writer is a New Delhi-based independent journalist

of Coastal Cloud Holdings, LLC along with its subsidiaries ("Coastal Cloud") for a consideration of \$707 million (\$6,386 crore).

4. The above is an extract of the detailed form of financial results filed with the Stock Exchange under Regulation 33 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2012. The full form for three months ended and year ended March 31, 2026, are available on the BSE Limited website (URL: www.bseindia.com) the National Stock Exchange of India Limited website (URL: www.nseindia.com) and on the company's website (URL: www.tcs.com/investors). The same can be accessed by scanning the QR code provided below.



Mumbai
April 9, 2026

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors
K. Krishnan
CEO and Managing Director
DIN: 10106739

PUBLIC NOTICE

Form No. URC-2

Advertisement giving notice about registration under Part I of Chapter XXI (Pursuant to section 374(1) of the Companies Act, 2013 and rule 4(1) of the companies (Authorized to Register) Rules, 2014).

1. Notice is hereby given that in pursuance of sub-section of section 366 of the Companies Act, 2013, an application has been made to the Registrar at Mumbai, Maharashtra that M/s. K T Metals Inc. a partnership firm may be registered under Part I of Chapter XXI of the Companies Act, 2013, as a company limited by shares.

2. The principal objects of the company are as follows: To carry on business of dealing in metals like iron and steel as a Trader/Import/Export/Job Worker/Authorized Stockholder/Distributors in respect thereof and as a Commission Agent/Manufacturer's Representative in respect thereof and any other business activities and such other related lawful business for the given object as may be mutually agreed upon by the parties in India or abroad.

3. A copy of the draft memorandum and articles of association of the proposed company may be inspected at the office at 801, 8th Floor, Plot - 435, Gata Alkappa, Jai Shankar Vignik Road, Near Sharmahandhan Hall, East, Mumbai 400022.

4. Notice is hereby given that any person objecting to this application may file an objection to the Registrar in writing to the Registrar at Central Registration Centre (CRC), Indian Institute of Corporate Affairs (IICA), Plot No. 6, 7, & 8, Sector 5, IIT, New Delhi - 110029, India, on or before 14th January 2026, by depositing a copy of the objection with the Registrar, with a copy to the company at its registered office. Dated this 10th day of April, 2026.

For K T Metals Inc.

1. Shri Deepak Purushottam Mehta
2. Shri Ashish Kashish Mehta
3. Shri Ruchi Deepak Mehta
4. Shri Nimish Ashish Mehta

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the public at large that the said "Member" is member and registered share holder of the Million Apartments Co-operative Housing Society Ltd., a society registered under the provisions of the Maharashtra Co-operative Societies Act 1960 having its registered address at Juhu Azad Road, Juhu, Mumbai - 400049.

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HDFC BANK

Registered Office: HDFC Bank House, Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Panel (West), Mumbai - 400 013 and having one of its office at Real Estate Management at HDFC Bank Ltd, 1st Floor, L-Link Techs Campus, Karjuram (East), Mumbai - 400042.

SALE INTIMATION AND PUBLIC NOTICE FOR SALE OF SECURITIES PLEDGED TO HDFC BANK LTD.

The below mentioned Borrowers of HDFC Bank Ltd. (the "Bank") are hereby notified regarding the sale of securities pledged to the Bank, for availing credit facilities in the nature of Loan/Overdraft/Against Securities.

Sl. No.	Loan Account Number	Borrower's Name	Outstanding Amount as on 07 April 2026	Date of Sale Notice
1	XXXXXXXXXXXX0002971	RINA JETENDRAKUMAR PATEL	9,51,019.64	07-04-2026
2	XXXXXXXXXXXX0009362	TIRTHU JAYSH VASHI	7,28,849.20	07-04-2026
3	XXXXXXXXXXXX0006498	BAMANJAYA HARSHWANT SOMA	1,03,732.50	07-04-2026
4	XXXXXXXXXXXX0007351	SANTOSH KUMAR PRASAD	1,32,759.72	06-04-2026
5	XXXXXXXXXXXX0000363	NISHA DILIP SOLANKI	335.82	07-04-2026
6	XXXXXXXXXXXX0007781	ROHIT SHALENDRA KUMAR	29,430.00	06-04-2026
7	XXXXXXXXXXXX0003738	TANDEL HEMANTKUMAR GOPALBHAI	6,66,796.92	07-04-2026
8	XXXXXXXXXXXX0003635	ABHISHEK KUMAR PATEL	4,35,644.82	07-04-2026

DATE: 10.04.2026

PLACE: DADRA AND NAGAR HAVELI AND DAMAN AND DIU HDFC BANK LTD.

Sd/-

Project Director (Technical)

[JUDCO Ltd, Ranchi]

PR 377087 (Urban Development and Housing) 26-27 (D)

Sd/-

Project Director (Technical)

[JUDCO Ltd, Ranchi]

PR 377087 (Urban Development and Housing) 26-27 (D)

Sd/-

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[JUDCO Ltd, Ranchi]

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Sd/-

Project Director (Technical)

[JUDCO Ltd, Ranchi]

PR 377087 (Urban Development and Housing) 26-27 (D)

Sd/-

JHARKHAND URBAN INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT COMPANY LIMITED

(Govt. of Jharkhand Undertaking)

RUDCO Bhawan, Kutchery Road, Ranchi-834001, Jharkhand. Ph. No. 91-651-2225878. E-mail: judco@judcoindia.com

GIN: 0452001021353001752, e-mail: judco@judcoindia.com

NIT No. JUDCO/NIT/Ku to Abt/R/695 Date: 09-04-2026

Procurement (Tender Notice)

2nd Call of Tender

Sl. No.	Name of Work	Mode of Bid Submission	Estimated Cost (Rs.)	Time of Completion	Tender Fee and Bid Security to be submitted online	Date/Time of Publication of Tender on Website	Last Date/Time of Bid Submission	Date/Time of Bid Opening	Bid Submission Address	Helpline Number of e-procurement Cell
1	Development of Kutchery Chowk to Albert Ekka Chowk via Shabud Chowk (Borewells, Road, Drainage, Sewerage, etc.)	e-tendering (http://www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in)	Rs. 25,93,53,00/- (Rupees Twenty Five Crores Fifty Nine Lakhs Ninety Three Thousand Five Hundred Thirty) only	06 Months	Tender document fee: Rs. 25,000/- (Rupees Twenty Five Thousand) only. Non-Refundable.	10.04.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.	04.05.2026 at 17:00 Hrs.	05.05.2026 at 17:00 Hrs.	Jharkhand Urban Infrastructure Development Company Limited, RUDCO Bhawan, Kutchery Chowk, Ranchi, Jharkhand-834001	0651-2225878

Further details can be seen on website <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>

Sd/-

Project Director (Technical)

[JUDCO Ltd, Ranchi]

PR 377087 (Urban Development and Housing) 26-27 (D)

Sd/-

Project Director (Technical)

[JUDCO Ltd, Ranchi]

PR 377087 (Urban Development and Housing) 26-27 (D)

Sd/-

Project Director (Technical)

[JUDCO Ltd, Ranchi]

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Sd/-

Project Director (Technical)

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[JUDCO Ltd, Ranchi]

PR 377087 (Urban Development and Housing) 26-27 (D)

Sd/-

Project Director (Technical)

[JUDCO Ltd, Ranchi]

PR 377087 (Urban Development and Housing)

anyone in more or any one may give up shares of Rs.50 each bearing Distinctive nos. 378 to 380 issued under Share Certificate no. 76 dated 6th February 1990 (The said Shares) and setting flat no.311 in the E-Wing of the Society's Building known as "Million Apartments" (The said Flat) which is more particularly described in the Schedule hereunder.

The said Member has informed the Society that the Original Share Certificate No. 76 issued in respect of the said Shares and the said Flat is lost and/or misplaced and not traceable by her and that all due care and diligent search on her part and as such the said Member has applied to the Society for the issue of duplicate share certificate.

Any person having any objection or claim to issue a duplicate share certificate in lieu of the lost one, in the name of the said Member, should communicate his objection in writing along with supporting documentary evidence to the undersigned at the above referred office address within Fifteen Days (15) from the date of issue of this Notice (being which the claim and/or objection, if any, shall be considered as waived or abandoned and a duplicate certificate will be issued in lieu of the lost/untraceable certificate).

SCHEDULE

All those 5 fully paid up shares of Rs.50 each bearing Distinctive nos. 378 to 380 issued under Share Certificate no. 76 dated 6th February 1990 issued by Million Apartments Co-operative Housing Society Limited, Flat bearing No. 311 in the E-Wing of the building known as "Million Apartments" Co-operative Housing Society Ltd., situated lying and being at A/24 Road, Juhu Koliwada, Juhu, Mumbai - 400048

Mumbai dated this 10th day of April, 2026

Hon. Secretary
"Million Apartments Co-operative Housing Society Ltd."

SCHEDULE

All those 5 fully paid up shares of Rs.50 each bearing Distinctive nos. 345 to 350 issued under Share Certificate no. 70 dated 16th January 1989 issued by Million Apartments Co-operative Housing Society Limited, Flat bearing No. 709 in the D-Wing of the building known as "Million Apartments" Co-operative Housing Society Ltd., situated lying and being at A/24 Road, Juhu Koliwada, Juhu, Mumbai - 400048

Mumbai dated this 10th day of April, 2026

Hon. Secretary
"Million Apartments Co-operative Housing Society Ltd."

DESCRIPTION OF THE PROPERTY:-

Building of Sai Trishul Co-operative Housing Society Ltd. along with land as mention below

Survey No.	Hissa No.	Plot No.	C.T.S. No. & Claimed Area
883	89, 90, 91, 92, 93, 94, 94A, 94B, 95, 95A, 95B, 95C, 95D, 95E, 95F, 95G, 95H, 95I, 95J, 95K, 95L, 95M, 95N, 95O, 95P, 95Q, 95R, 95S, 95T, 95U, 95V, 95W, 95X, 95Y, 95Z, 96, 96A, 96B, 96C, 96D, 96E, 96F, 96G, 96H, 96I, 96J, 96K, 96L, 96M, 96N, 96O, 96P, 96Q, 96R, 96S, 96T, 96U, 96V, 96W, 96X, 96Y, 96Z, 97, 97A, 97B, 97C, 97D, 97E, 97F, 97G, 97H, 97I, 97J, 97K, 97L, 97M, 97N, 97O, 97P, 97Q, 97R, 97S, 97T, 97U, 97V, 97W, 97X, 97Y, 97Z, 98, 98A, 98B, 98C, 98D, 98E, 98F, 98G, 98H, 98I, 98J, 98K, 98L, 98M, 98N, 98O, 98P, 98Q, 98R, 98S, 98T, 98U, 98V, 98W, 98X, 98Y, 98Z, 99, 99A, 99B, 99C, 99D, 99E, 99F, 99G, 99H, 99I, 99J, 99K, 99L, 99M, 99N, 99O, 99P, 99Q, 99R, 99S, 99T, 99U, 99V, 99W, 99X, 99Y, 99Z, 100, 100A, 100B, 100C, 100D, 100E, 100F, 100G, 100H, 100I, 100J, 100K, 100L, 100M, 100N, 100O, 100P, 100Q, 100R, 100S, 100T, 100U, 100V, 100W, 100X, 100Y, 100Z, 101, 101A, 101B, 101C, 101D, 101E, 101F, 101G, 101H, 101I, 101J, 101K, 101L, 101M, 101N, 101O, 101P, 101Q, 101R, 101S, 101T, 101U, 101V, 101W, 101X, 101Y, 101Z, 102, 102A, 102B, 102C, 102D, 102E, 102F, 102G, 102H, 102I, 102J, 102K, 102L, 102M, 102N, 102O, 102P, 102Q, 102R, 102S, 102T, 102U, 102V, 102W, 102X, 102Y, 102Z, 103, 103A, 103B, 103C, 103D, 103E, 103F, 103G, 103H, 103I, 103J, 103K, 103L, 103M, 103N, 103O, 103P, 103Q, 103R, 103S, 103T, 103U, 103V, 103W, 103X, 103Y, 103Z, 104, 104A, 104B, 104C, 104D, 104E, 104F, 104G, 104H, 104I, 104J, 104K, 104L, 104M, 104N, 104O, 104P, 104Q, 104R, 104S, 104T, 104U, 104V, 104W, 104X, 104Y, 104Z, 105, 105A, 105B, 105C, 105D, 105E, 105F, 105G, 105H, 105I, 105J, 105K, 105L, 105M, 105N, 105O, 105P, 105Q, 105R, 105S, 105T, 105U, 105V, 105W, 105X, 105Y, 105Z, 106, 106A, 106B, 106C, 106D, 106E, 106F, 106G, 106H, 106I, 106J, 106K, 106L, 106M, 106N, 106O, 106P, 106Q, 106R, 106S, 106T, 106U, 106V, 106W, 106X, 106Y, 106Z, 107, 107A, 107B, 107C, 107D, 107E, 107F, 107G, 107H, 107I, 107J, 107K, 107L, 107M, 107N, 107O, 107P, 107Q, 107R, 107S, 107T, 107U, 107V, 107W, 107X, 107Y, 107Z, 108, 108A, 108B, 108C, 108D, 108E, 108F, 108G, 108H, 108I, 108J, 108K, 108L, 108M, 108N, 108O, 108P, 108Q, 108R, 108S, 108T, 108U, 108V, 108W, 108X, 108Y, 108Z, 109, 109A, 109B, 109C, 109D, 109E, 109F, 109G, 109H, 109I, 109J, 109K, 109L, 109M, 109N, 109O, 109P, 109Q, 109R, 109S, 109T, 109U, 109V, 109W, 109X, 109Y, 109Z, 110, 110A, 110B, 110C, 110D, 110E, 110F, 110G, 110H, 110I, 110J, 110K, 110L, 110M, 110N, 110O, 110P, 110Q, 110R, 110S, 110T, 110U, 110V, 110W, 110X, 110Y, 110Z, 111, 111A, 111B, 111C, 111D, 111E, 111F, 111G, 111H, 111I, 111J, 111K, 111L, 111M, 111N, 111O, 111P, 111Q, 111R, 111S, 111T, 111U, 111V, 111W, 111X, 111Y, 111Z, 112, 112A, 112B, 112C, 112D, 112E, 112F, 112G, 112H, 112I, 112J, 112K, 112L, 112M, 112N, 112O, 112P, 112Q, 112R, 112S, 112T, 112U, 112V, 112W, 112X, 112Y, 112Z, 113, 113A, 113B, 113C, 113D, 113E, 113F, 113G, 113H, 113I, 113J, 113K, 113L, 113M, 113N, 113O, 113P, 113Q, 113R, 113S, 113T, 113U, 113V, 113W, 113X, 113Y, 113Z, 114, 114A, 114B, 114C, 114D, 114E, 114F, 114G, 114H, 114I, 114J, 114K, 114L, 114M, 114N, 114O, 114P, 114Q, 114R, 114S, 114T, 114U, 114V, 114W, 114X, 114Y, 114Z, 115, 115A, 115B, 115C, 115D, 115E, 115F, 115G, 115H, 115I, 115J, 115K, 115L, 115M, 115N, 115O, 115P, 115Q, 115R, 115S, 115T, 115U, 115V, 115W, 115X, 115Y, 115Z, 116, 116A, 116B, 116C, 116D, 116E, 116F, 116G, 116H, 116I, 116J, 116K, 116L, 116M, 116N, 116O, 116P, 116Q, 116R, 116S, 116T, 116U, 116V, 116W, 116X, 116Y, 116Z, 117, 117A, 117B, 117C, 117D, 117E, 117F, 117G, 117H, 117I, 117J, 117K, 117L, 117M, 117N, 117O, 117P, 117Q, 117R, 117S, 117T, 117U, 117V, 117W, 117X, 117Y, 117Z, 118, 118A, 118B, 118C, 118D, 118E, 118F, 118G, 118H, 118I, 118J, 118K, 118L, 118M, 118N, 118O, 118P, 118Q, 118R, 118S, 118T, 118U, 118V, 118W, 118X, 118Y, 118Z, 119, 119A, 119B, 119C, 119D, 119E, 119F, 119G, 119H, 119I, 119J, 119K, 119L, 119M, 119N, 119O, 119P, 119Q, 119R, 119S, 119T, 119U, 119V, 119W, 119X, 119Y, 119Z, 120, 120A, 120B, 120C, 120D, 120E, 120F, 120G, 120H, 120I, 120J, 120K, 120L, 120M, 120N, 120O, 120P, 120Q, 120R, 120S, 120T, 120U, 120V, 120W, 120X, 120Y, 120Z, 121, 121A, 121B, 121C, 121D, 121E, 121F, 121G, 121H, 121I, 121J, 121K, 121L, 121M, 121N, 121O, 121P, 121Q, 121R, 121S, 121T, 121U, 121V, 121W, 121X, 121Y, 121Z, 122, 122A, 122B, 122C, 122D, 122E, 122F, 122G, 122H, 122I, 122J, 122K, 122L, 122M, 122N, 122O, 122P, 122Q, 122R, 122S, 122T, 122U, 122V, 122W, 122X, 122Y, 122Z, 123, 123A, 123B, 123C, 123D, 123E, 123F, 123G, 123H, 123I, 123J, 123K, 123L, 123M, 123N, 123O, 123P, 123Q, 123R, 123S, 123T, 123U, 123V, 123W, 123X, 123Y, 123Z, 124, 124A, 124B, 124C, 124D, 124E, 124F, 124G, 124H, 124I, 124J, 124K, 124L, 124M, 124N, 124O, 124P, 124Q, 124R, 124S, 124T, 124U, 124V, 124W, 124X, 124Y, 124Z, 125, 125A, 125B, 125C, 125D, 125E, 125F, 125G, 125H, 125I, 125J, 125K, 125L, 125M, 125N, 125O, 125P, 125Q, 125R, 125S, 125T, 125U, 125V, 125W, 125X, 125Y, 125Z, 126, 126A, 126B, 126C, 126D, 126E, 126F, 126G, 126H, 126I, 126J, 126K, 126L, 126M, 126N, 126O, 126P, 126Q, 126R, 126S, 126T, 126U, 126V, 126W, 126X, 126Y, 126Z, 127, 127A, 127B, 127C, 127D, 127E, 127F, 127G, 127H, 127I, 127J, 127K, 127L, 127M, 127N, 127O, 127P, 127Q, 127R, 127S, 127T, 127U, 127V, 127W, 127X, 127Y, 127Z, 128, 128A, 128B, 128C, 128D, 128E, 128F, 128G, 128H, 128I, 128J, 128K, 128L, 128M, 128N, 128O, 128P, 128Q, 128R, 128S, 128T, 128U, 128V, 128W, 128X, 128Y, 128Z, 129, 129A, 129B, 129C, 129D, 129E, 129F, 129G, 129H, 129I, 129J, 129K, 129L, 129M, 129N, 129O, 129P, 129Q, 129R, 129S, 129T, 129U, 129V, 129W, 129X, 129Y, 129Z, 130, 130A, 130B, 130C, 130D, 130E, 130F, 130G, 130H, 130I, 130J, 130K, 130L, 130M, 130N, 130O, 130P, 130Q, 130R, 130S, 130T, 130U, 130V, 130W, 130X, 130Y, 130Z, 131, 131A, 131B, 131C, 131D, 131E, 131F, 131G, 131H, 131I, 131J, 131K, 131L, 131M, 131N, 131O, 131P, 131Q, 131R, 131S, 131T, 131U, 131V, 131W, 131X, 131Y, 131Z, 132, 132A, 132B, 132C, 132D, 132E, 132F, 132G, 132H, 132I, 132J, 132K, 132L, 132M, 132N, 132O, 132P, 132Q, 132R, 132S, 132T, 132U, 132V, 132W, 132X, 132Y, 132Z, 133, 133A, 133B, 133C, 133D, 133E, 133F, 133G, 133H, 133I, 133J, 133K, 133L, 133M, 133N, 133O, 133P, 133Q, 133R, 133S, 133T, 133U, 133V, 133W, 133X, 133Y, 133Z, 134, 134A, 134B, 134C, 134D, 134E, 134F, 134G, 134H, 134I, 134J, 134K, 134L, 134M, 134N, 134O, 134P, 134Q, 134R, 134S, 134T, 134U, 134V, 134W, 134X, 134Y, 134Z, 135, 135A, 135B, 135C, 135D, 135E, 135F, 135G, 135H, 135I, 135J, 135K, 135L, 135M, 135N, 135O, 135P, 135Q, 135R, 135S, 135T, 135U, 135V, 135W, 135X, 135Y, 135Z, 136, 136A, 136B, 136C, 136D, 136E, 136F, 136G, 136H, 136I, 136J, 136K, 136L, 136M, 136N, 136O, 136P, 136Q, 136R, 136S, 136T, 136U, 136V, 136W, 136X, 136Y, 136Z, 137, 137A, 137B, 137C, 137D, 137E, 137F, 137G, 137H, 137I, 137J, 137K, 137L, 137M, 137N, 137O, 137P, 137Q, 137R, 137S, 137T, 137U, 137V, 137W, 137X, 137Y, 137Z, 138, 138A, 138B, 138C, 138D, 138E, 138F, 138G, 138H, 138I, 138J, 138K, 138L, 138M, 138N, 138O, 138P, 138Q, 138R, 138S, 138T, 138U, 138V, 138W, 138X, 138Y, 138Z, 139, 139A, 139B, 139C, 139D, 139E, 139F, 139G, 139H, 139I, 139J, 139K, 139L, 139M, 139N, 139O, 139P, 139Q, 139R, 139S, 139T, 139U, 139V, 139W, 139X, 139Y, 139Z, 140, 140A, 140B, 140C, 140D, 140E, 140F, 140G, 140H, 140I, 140J, 140K, 140L, 140M, 140N, 140O, 140P, 140Q, 140R, 140S, 140T, 140U, 140V, 140W, 140X, 140Y, 140Z, 141, 141A, 141B, 141C, 141D, 141E, 141F, 141G, 141H, 141I, 141J, 141K, 141L, 141M, 141N, 141O, 141P, 141Q, 141R, 141S, 141T, 141U, 141V, 141W, 141X, 141Y, 141Z, 142, 142A, 142B, 142C, 142D, 142E, 142F, 142G, 142H, 142I, 142J, 142K, 142L, 142M, 142N, 142O, 142P, 142Q, 142R, 142S, 142T, 142U, 142V, 142W, 142X, 142Y, 142Z, 143, 143A, 143B, 143C, 143D, 143E, 143F, 143G, 143H, 143I, 143J, 143K, 143L, 143M, 143N, 143O, 143P, 143Q, 143R, 143S, 143T, 143U, 143V, 143W, 143X, 143Y, 143Z, 144, 144A, 144B, 144C, 144D, 144E, 144F, 144G, 144H, 144I, 144J, 144K, 144L, 144M, 144N, 144O, 144P, 144Q, 144R, 144S, 144T, 144U, 144V, 144W, 144X, 144Y, 144Z, 145, 145A, 145B, 145C, 145D, 145E, 145F, 145G, 145H, 145I, 145J, 145K, 145L, 145M, 145N, 145O, 145P, 145Q, 145R, 145S, 145T, 145U, 145V, 145W, 145X, 145Y, 145Z, 146, 146A, 146B, 146C, 146D, 146E, 146F, 146G, 146H, 146I, 146J, 146K, 146L, 146M, 146N, 146O, 146P, 146Q, 146R, 146S, 146T, 146U, 146V, 146W, 146X, 146Y, 146Z, 147, 147A, 147B, 147C, 147D, 147E, 147F, 147G, 147H, 147I, 147J, 147K, 147L, 147M, 147N, 147O, 147P, 147Q, 147R, 147S, 147T, 147U, 147V, 147W, 147X, 147Y, 147Z, 148, 148A, 148B, 148C, 148D, 148E, 148F, 148G, 148H, 148I, 148J, 148K, 148L, 148M, 148N, 148O, 148P, 148Q, 148R, 148S, 148T, 148U, 148V, 148W, 148X, 148Y, 148Z, 149, 149A, 149B, 149C, 149D, 149E, 149F, 149G, 149H, 149I, 149J, 149K, 149L, 149M, 149N, 149O, 149P, 149Q, 149R, 149S, 149T, 149U, 149V, 149W, 149X, 149Y, 149Z, 150, 150A, 150B, 150C, 150D, 150E, 150F, 150G, 150H, 150I, 150J, 150K, 150L, 150M, 150N, 150O, 150P, 150Q, 150R, 150S, 150T, 150U, 150V, 150W, 150X, 150Y, 150Z, 151, 151A, 151B, 151C, 151D, 151E, 151F, 151G, 151H, 151I, 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COMPANY SCHEME APPLICATION NO. CA, (CAA) / 281 (MB) / 2025
In the matter of the Companies Act, 2013

AND

In the matter of Sections 230 to 232 and other applicable provisions, if any, of the Companies Act, 2013 read with Companies (Compromises, Arrangements and Amalgamations) Rules, 2016.

AND

In the matter of Composite Scheme of Arrangement of Anandheo India Private Limited (Formerly known as Andasia Private Limited) ("Transferor Company" or "First Petitioner Company") with and into Asia Investments Private Limited ("Transferee Company" or "Second Petitioner Company") and into Gabriel India Limited ("Resulting Company" or "Third Petitioner Company") and their respective shareholders under Sections 230-232 of the Companies Act, 2013 and other applicable provisions, if any, of the Companies Act, 2013 ("Scheme")

Anandheo India Private Limited (Formerly known as Andasia Private Limited)
...the First Petitioner Company

Asia Investments Private Limited
...the Second Petitioner Company

Gabriel India Limited
...the Third Petitioner Company

NOTICE OF PETITION

A Petition under Sections 230 to 232 and other applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013, for the sanction of Composite Scheme of Arrangement of Anandheo India Private Limited (Formerly known as Andasia Private Limited) ("Transferor Company" or "First Petitioner Company") with and into Asia Investments Private Limited ("Transferee Company" or "Second Petitioner Company") and into Gabriel India Limited ("Resulting Company" or "Third Petitioner Company") and their respective shareholders under Sections 230-232 of the Companies Act, 2013 and other applicable provisions, if any, of the Companies Act, 2013 ("Scheme") presented by the Petitioner Companies before the Hon'ble National Company Law Tribunal, Mumbai Bench (Hon'ble NCLT) was admitted by the Hon'ble NCLT vide its order delivered on 27th March 2025. The aforesaid petition is fixed for final hearing before the Hon'ble NCLT on April 24, 2025.

If any person concerned is desirous of supporting or opposing the said petition, he/she should send to the undersigned Authorized Representatives at the registered office of the Petitioner Companies, the notice of his/her intention signed by himself or his/her advocate, not later than two days before the date fixed for the hearing of the Petition. Where any person concerned seeks to oppose the aforesaid petition, the grounds of opposition or a copy of affidavit in that behalf should be furnished with such notice. A copy of the Joint Company Scheme Petition along with all the exhibits will be furnished by the Petitioner's Authorized Representative to any person requesting the same on payment of the prescribed fees for the same.

Dated this 10th day of April, 2025

For and on behalf of Anandheo India Private Limited (Formerly known as Andasia Private Limited):

Authorized Signatory
Name: Anshul Bhargava
Designation: Director
RO Address: 29th Milestone Pune Nashik Highway, Sakinaka Road, Village Kurla, Pune, Maharashtra, India - 411001.
Tel. No.: 011-26564542
Email: anshul.bhargava@anandheoindia.com

For and on behalf of Asia Investments Private Limited

Authorized Signatory
Name: Chanchal Singh
Designation: Director
RO Address: 29th Milestone Pune Nashik Highway, Sakinaka Road, Village Kurla, Pune, Maharashtra, India - 411001.
Tel. No.: 011-26564542
Email: anshul.bhargava@anandheoindia.com

For and on behalf of Gabriel India Limited

Authorized Signatory
Name: Nishit Jain
Designation: Company Secretary
RO Address: 29th Milestone Pune Nashik Highway, Sakinaka Road, Village Kurla, Pune, Maharashtra, India - 411001.
Tel. No.: 011-26564542
Email: nishit.jain@anandheoindia.com

Summit Securities Limited
Corporate Identification Number: L16621MH1907PL16471
Regd. Office: 213, Bessie Complex, Wing 71, Sen-Tier Road, Chembur, Mumbai - 400071.
Tel. No.: +91-22-40008881/89
Website: www.summitsec.com
Email: investor@summitsec.com, info@summitsec.com

NOTICE TO SHAREHOLDERS

Special Window for Transfer and Dematerialisation of Physical Securities
Punjab National Bank (PNB) has opened a special window for a period of one year from February 05, 2025 to February 04, 2026 to facilitate transfer and dematerialisation of physical securities which were sold / purchased prior to April 01, 2019, and/or were rejected / returned / not attended due to deficiency in the documents / process / or otherwise and will be applicable in following cases:

- Where original share transfer request(s) is/are not lodged prior to April 01, 2019, and the transferor's holding original share certificate.
- Where original share transfer request(s) were lodged prior to April 01, 2019, and those were rejected / returned / not attended due to deficiency in the documents / process / or otherwise and the transferor's holding original share certificate.

Investor are encouraged to utilize the facility by furnishing necessary documents to MUFG India Private Limited, the Company's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent at G-101, 1st Floor, Embassy 247, Lal Bahadur Shastri Marg, Vilepar (West), Mumbai-400083, Maharashtra, India. Tel. No.: +91-022-118444. Website: https://www.mufig.co.in/shareholders/Service_Request.html.

Please note that these shares shall be mandatorily credited to the transferee, only in demat mode and shall be under lock-in for a period of one year from the date of registration of transfer. These securities shall not be transferred / loaned / pledged during the said lock-in period.

For Summit Securities Limited
Place: Mumbai Date: April 08, 2025
Jiya Gargwal
Company Secretary

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The serious business of gaming

India's esports ecosystem is expanding beyond gameplay as the country prepares for the global stage



AYUSHI SINGH
New Delhi, 9 April

An Indian jersey, a national squad and a shot at becoming world champions—all for a competition many still hesitate to call a sport. Yet, as India prepares to participate in the Esports Nations Cup in Riyadh this November, where players will compete in a nation-based format rather than as clubs or creators, such ideas are beginning to take shape.

The process will be led by Nodwin Gaming, appointed by the Esports World Cup Foundation as India's national team partner to run qualifiers, build team structures and manage the country's representation at the tournament.

Until recently, gaming was seen as a distraction rather than a serious sport. In less than a decade, it has begun to fill arenas, create professional careers and evolve into an industry.



The next level
India leads in users but trails in revenue

Esports audience	Market revenue	Arpu (\$)	Mobile share	PC/console share (%)
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(Clockwise from top left) Players at the Battlegrounds Mobile India Series (BGIS) 2026 in Chennai; SRUL's Team Soul won the BGIS 2026 edition and a prize of ₹1 crore; With an esports audience of 80-100 million, the sector is now pushing on the policy radar

"In the early years, tournament winnings played a significant role," Mathur said. "Today, revenue is diversified across streaming platforms, brand partnerships, appearances and IP collaborations."

"Convincing families that gaming could be a serious career was once one of the hardest battles," he added. "Today, that perception has changed considerably."

"When I began, preparation was largely instinct-driven," said Raj Varma. Today, the approach is more systematic, with coaches and analysts contributing through data-driven insights and structured training. "There is a greater

emphasis on discipline, physical fitness and mental well-being."

"Gaming and cricket audiences overlap far more than people assume," said Payal Dhare, among the most prominent creators today, referring to her collaboration with the International Cricket Council around the Men's T20 World Cup. "Gaming creators are not confined to niche communities anymore."

"Participation has grown significantly," she added. "But women's esports still requires deeper structural investment."

"Competitive careers can be relatively short," Varma said. "That makes long-term planning essential."

Hardware catches up

In India, competitive play has largely been smartphone-led, with more than 90 per cent of Indian gamers playing on mobile phones. That, however, is begin-

ning to shift as PC-based esports titles gain traction.

"We've definitely felt the change," said Vishal Parekh, chief operating officer of CyberPowerPC India. "Competitive gaming highlights every small performance dip, and that awareness is shaping buying decisions."

As titles such as Valorant and Counter-Strike 2 gain traction, expectations are rising. "Earlier, many players adjusted to whatever system they had," Parekh said. "Today, players expect stable performance right out of the box."

"Gamers understand how small dips can affect timing, confidence and overall experience," he said. "When players experience professional setups at tournaments, it influences what they expect from their own systems."

Gaming in India is being approached with more seriousness and intent," Parekh said. "When that happens, better infrastructure and higher standards follow."

Policy and regulatory crossroads

With an esports audience of 80-100 million, the sector is now pushing on the policy radar.

India is moving towards separating competitive gaming from real-money play. The proposed Promotion and Regulation of Online Gaming Bill, 2025 seeks to curb betting-style formats while recognising esports as a distinct category.

"Earlier we were trying to justify the existence of esports in India," said Mathur. "Now we are proving that it can scale sustainably."

The shift builds on recent regulatory steps, including amendments to the Information Technology Rules in 2023 and the government's recognition of esports as a multi-sport event in 2022. "Greater access to venues at viable costs and smoother coordination with authorities would materially improve execution confidence," said Agarwal.

For now, the system is still catching up with the scale—across publishers, organisers, teams and the infrastructure around them. But that's unlikely to hold up orders for team jerseys in India's latest sporting craze.

India (BGM), a recent update brought in the IPL franchise Chennai Super Kings through limited in-game items, collectibles and a photo booth experience.

Players can access Royal Enfield motorcycles and Mahindra vehicles as in-game assets, while partnerships with Jio Link gamelplay to prepaid gaming plans bundled with in-game rewards. "BGM today functions as a mainstream interactive entertainment platform," said Siddharth Merotra, head of business development and partnerships at Krafton India, a division of the Korean gaming company, adding that brands are built into the game rather than placed around it.

Similar approaches are visible across other titles, from Free Fire MAX collaborations with franchises such as Money Heist to crossover seasons in Call of Duty: Mobile. Globally, platforms such as Fortnite and Roblox have made in-game events central to gameplay.

"In gaming environments, players are not just watching content — they are participating in it," said Karan Pathak, associate director of esports at Krafton India. BGM has crossed 250 million downloads in India, with nearly a million tournament registrations over the past four years. "The biggest difference today is structure and continuity," Pathak said. "Earlier, competitive opportunities were concentrated around a few marquee events. Today the circuit runs through the year."

Competitive play now runs alongside this expansion. The BGMPS 2024 Grand Finals recorded nearly 500,000 peak concurrent viewers and over 11 million hours watched. For publishers, the focus remains on balancing growth with competitive integrity, through rulebooks, anti-cheat systems and roster regulations. "Credibility comes first. Commercial growth follows from that credibility," Pathak added.

The Esports Nations Cup introduces a new layer to the competitive environment. Unlike club-based tournaments such as the Esports World Cup, where teams compete as organisations, it is built around national representation, with countries fielding line-ups through qualifiers and selection systems. Backed by a \$45 million commitment across prize money and ecosystem development, it signals a shift towards organised, country-level competition in esports.

When tournaments become media properties

Inside an arena, fans crowd against barricades as spotlights sweep across a stage framed by towering LED screens and broadcast rigs. When the competitors walk out, the hall erupts in a roar familiar to any cricket final or football derby.

"The biggest shift is from execution to orchestration," said Gautam Virk, cofounder and chief executive of Nodwin Gaming. "A few years ago, organisers were largely event operators. Today, we operate like media and IP companies."

"Building a tournament IP now involves calendar strategy, broadcast planning, commercial structuring, regional feeds, global distribution and long-term brand alignment," Virk said, adding that the focus is on building properties that compound over time. Large-format competitions now

	(mn)		(\$ mn)		(%)	
US	35		430	12.3	60	40
South Korea	28		240	8.6	40	60
India	90		180	2.0	90	10

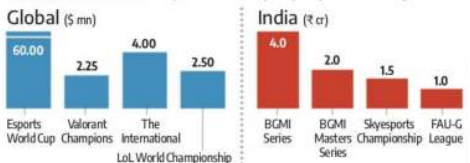
Note: Arpu based on industry estimates

Source: Newzoo, Niko Partners, Ficc-EY

Note: Arpu based on industry estimates

Source: Newzoo, Niko Partners, Fico-EY

Uneven stakes Major tournaments' prize pool (2025-26 season)



Source: Press releases, official announcements

resemble sports broadcasts, with multi-camera production, replay systems, analyst desks and regional language feeds. "Early esports events were passion-driven. Today they are process-driven."

"Tournament-day is the visible tip of the iceberg," Virk said, pointing to work across qualifiers, campus circuits, content pipelines and partnerships. These formats are not just talent pipelines but audience engines, building local fandom.

"Sponsorship remains a major pillar, but media rights can equal or exceed this in select IPs," Virk said. Publisher partnerships, digital distribution and ticketing are also becoming significant. Brands, he added, are moving from campaign-led activations to multi-season partnerships.

Prize money now runs into crores — from Battlegrounds Mobile India Series (BGIS) 2024 at ₹4 crore to FAU-G Bharat League 2.0 at ₹1 crore. Nodwin Gaming is currently in a pre-IPO fundraising, as it expands across esports, content and youth media.

Teams become institutions

Globally, teams such as the Netherlands-based Team Liquid and UK-based Fnatic, which operate across multiple titles, have evolved into multi-title, media-led organisations that extend far beyond competitive play.

In India, SSUL Esports reflects that shift. The organisation was selected as India's only representative among 40 global teams in the Club Partner Programme of the Esports World Cup.

"What has evolved most meaningfully is our strategic maturity," said Animesh Agarwal, cofounder and CEO of SSUL Esports. "In the early years, we were scaling aggressively and experimenting constantly. Today, growth is far more deliberate, driven by data-backed evaluation and long-term planning."

That global push has translated into a competitive scale. SSUL fielded line-ups across multiple titles at the Esports World Cup and secured qualifications in games such as Apex Legends, Chess and EA Sports FC, with players reaching advanced stages.

"The objective is sustained brand equity and institutional strength, not short-term attention," Agarwal said. "Each roster functions with dedicated coaches, analysts and performance personnel. Global competition does not

reward improvisation."

The company's operations include coaching, analytics, content, talent management and commercial strategy. Its Navi Mumbai gaming house functions as both a high-performance training centre and a content studio, with annual operating costs of ₹8.5 crore. "Performance drives credibility. Content drives distribution. Neither can compromise the other," Agarwal said.

SSUL recently won the Ral Star X Gyan Gaming Cup, a tournament that drew more than 1,000 teams, securing ₹12.5 lakh in prize money. "This victory is a testament to the structure and long-term vision we are building," Agarwal said.

"The majority of our revenue now stems from long-term brand partnerships and structured content monetisation."

In publisher-led circuits such as the BGIS, SSUL teams have continued to deliver results, with Team Soul winning the 2026 edition and a prize of ₹1 crore.

Prize winnings remain important, but are no longer the economic backbone of the organisation. "The industry has moved beyond campaign-driven visibility towards deeper strategic integration," Agarwal said. "As teams scale, the objective is to build an institution, not merely a roster."

Playing for a living

The growth of esports has expanded what it means to build a career in gaming and is also being shaped by platforms such as STAN, a Bengaluru-based social gaming platform where players, creators and fans interact through chats, tournaments and live sessions. "The shift is from gameplay-as-content to gameplay-as-social infrastructure," said Parth Chaddha, cofounder and CEO of STAN.

"Creators can start earning from day one without expensive setups," Chaddha said. "All you need is a phone and a good internet connection to participate." The platform has crossed 30 million downloads and hosts over 200,000 creators, adding more than 100,000 earning creators each month, with revenue flowing through formats such as subscriptions and brand-led activations.

For Naman Mathur, cofounder of SSUL Esports, the change has been visible firsthand. "When I started, there was immense passion but very little structure," he said. "Today, the ecosystem is far more organised and credible."

NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that in accordance with Regulation 59A of SEBI (Mutual Funds) Regulation 1996 read with Paragraph 5.1 of SEBI Master Circular dated June 27, 2024, the unit holders of all the Scheme(s) of PGIM India Mutual Fund ("Fund") are requested to note that the half yearly portfolio of all the Scheme(s) of the Fund for the half year ended March 31, 2026, are hosted on the website www.pgimindia.com/mutual-funds/ and www.amfindia.com.

The unit holders can submit a request for a physical or electronic copy of the statement of scheme portfolio of the Fund for the half year ended March 31, 2026, by calling on 1800 209 7446 or by sending an email to care@pgimindia.com or by writing to PGIM India Asset Management Private Limited at 4th Floor, C Wing, Laxmi Towers, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 051.

For PGIM India Asset Management Private Limited (Investment Manager for PGIM India Mutual Fund)

Place: Mumbai

Date: April 09, 2026

Sd/-

Authorized Signatory

Unit holders are requested to update their PAN, KYC, email address, mobile number, nominee details with AMC and are also advised to link their PAN with Aadhaar Number. Further, Unit holders can view the Investor Charter available on website of the Mutual Fund as well as check for any unclaimed redemptions or Income Distribution cum Capital Withdrawal (IDCW) payments.

MUTUAL FUND INVESTMENTS ARE SUBJECT TO MARKET RISKS, READ ALL SCHEME RELATED DOCUMENTS CAREFULLY.

— Advertorial

IMC CHAMBER OF COMMERCE AND INDUSTRY WINS RECOGNITION AT IAA OLIVE CROWN AWARDS 2026 FOR CLIMATE CAMPAIGN "I WILL"

The IMC Chamber of Commerce and Industry is proud to receive the Award of Recognition at the prestigious IAA Olive Crown Awards 2026 in the Print Production Category for its impactful climate campaign titled "Green Thumbprint - I WILL."

The award was received by Ms. Sunita Ramnathkar, President of IMC, and Dr. Ram Gandhi, Governor and Past President of IMC and Chairman of the IMC Environment Protection Committee, in recognition of IMC's commitment to advancing sustainability through innovative communication and citizen engagement.

The IAA Olive Crown Awards, instituted by the International Advertising Association (IAA), are among India's most respected recognitions for excellence in green communication. These awards celebrate organizations and initiatives that effectively promote environmental sustainability and responsible behavior through creative messaging and impactful outreach.

IMC's award-winning campaign, "I WILL," is a climate action movement aligned with India's LIFE (Lifestyle for Environment) vision. The campaign emphasizes simple, actionable lifestyle changes that individuals and organizations can adopt to reduce their carbon footprint and contribute to a greener future. The initiative is built around five key pillars: Water Conservation, Energy Efficiency, Sustainable Transport, Waste Reduction & Recycling, and Tree Plantation & Biodiversity.



Restoration. A key feature of the campaign was the design and printing of an engaging booklet, showcasing practical steps across these five pillars. The booklet creatively translated sustainability into everyday actions—encouraging individuals to make small but meaningful changes in their daily lives.

In addition, IMC amplified the campaign through an extensive social media outreach strategy, deploying visually rich creatives across platforms such as WhatsApp,

LinkedIn, Facebook, and X. These creatives, as seen in the campaign materials, provided simple tips on energy saving, water conservation, recycling, green mobility, and eco-friendly living—driving widespread public participation.

The IMC Chamber continues to champion responsible business practices and citizen-driven initiatives, positioning itself as a leading voice in India's journey towards a sustainable and climate-resilient future.

Govt cites curbs on men at temples in Sabarimala defence

Says exclusions rooted in faith, not hierarchy

BAHAVINI MISHRA
New Delhi, 9 April

The Centre on Thursday told the Supreme Court that exclusionary practices at temples were not uniformly directed at women, pointing to instances where men were also barred from entry. It argued that the restriction at the Sabarimala temple should not be viewed purely through a gender lens.

Appearing for the Centre, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta contended that the court's 2018 ruling permitting entry of women of all ages to Sabarimala was based on an assumption of gender hierarchy.

"I have given instances of temples where men are not allowed. Because it is a Devi Bhagwati temple, there are certain faiths and beliefs. There are temples, details of which I have mentioned, where male priests are under a religious mandate to wash the feet of female devotees.



About the hearing

- Nine-judge Bench examines scope of Articles 25, 26 and 14
- Justice Nagarathna stresses openness in places of worship
- Q1 questions argument against Article 25(2)(b) override
- 2018 verdict under review, ruling may impact similar disputes

on religious freedom.

During the hearing, Justice Nagarathna emphasised the importance of openness in places of worship.

"If you say it is my practice, it is a matter of religion that only my sect, my denomination, must attend my temple and none else; that is not good for Hinduism,"

realities of Hindu society, while the CJI expressed scepticism about the argument.

"These arguments will probably not survive for two reasons. One, what you are arguing is directly in the teeth of the language of Article 25(2)(b). Directly in the teeth of it. Assuming Article 25(2)(b) applies, you are using the

HEMANT KUMAR ROUT
Bhubaneswar, 9 April

The Orissa High Court has ruled that a company's chairman cannot be held criminally liable for a defective product sold by a local dealer, just as the railway minister or postal authorities cannot be summoned for delayed trains or lost letters.

Justice Sanjeev K Panigrahi dismissed a criminal complaint filed against Reliance Industries Limited (RIL) and its chairman Mukesh Ambani (pictured) over a faulty cellphone worth ₹501 sold in Rourkela more than 23 years ago.

Censuring a lower court for issuing summons in the matter, the High Court ruled that the case was a clear instance of harassment. It imposed a fine of ₹1,000 on the complainant, lawyer Prafulla Kumar Mishra, directing that the amount be deposited with the Juvenile Justice Fund of the Odisha State Legal Services Authority within four weeks.

The High Court observed that the

complaint's premise was legally untenable. "If such an approach were accepted, it would open the floodgates for indiscriminate criminal prosecution, allowing passengers to summon the Railway Minister for delayed trains or the Postmaster General for a lost letter, or even the Union Food Minister for a defective item supplied through a ration outlet," said the March 31 order uploaded on the court's website on Wednesday.

Criminal law rests on a direct and personal nexus between the accused and the alleged offence. In the absence of

such a connection, merely holding a high office or public profile cannot be grounds to implicate an individual in criminal proceedings, it said.

The court said the attempt to arraign Ambani had no connection with the pursuit of a legitimate criminal remedy. Instead, it described the case as, in substance, a publicity-driven exercise presented in the form of a criminal complaint.

The case traces back to 2003, when Mishra, who was then practising in Rourkela, bought a telecom scheme of Reliance Infocomm by paying ₹501 and agreeing to monthly payments. He alleged that the phone supplied by a local dealer as part of the scheme was defective and he was served fake bills of ₹6,308 when the phone was with the dealer for repairs.

Over the years, the complainant initiated multiple criminal proceedings against Ambani and Reliance companies. Mishra filed a

fresh complaint before the Sub-Divisional Judicial Magistrate (SDJM), Panposh in Rourkela in 2025, leading to notices being issued in January this year, prompting RIL and Ambani to approach the High Court.

Quashing the proceedings, the High Court underscored that the dispute involved a "trivial" transaction value of ₹501 but had led to an almost unrelenting pursuit of criminal litigation spanning over two decades.

It found no legal basis to prosecute Ambani, reiterating the settled principle that criminal liability is personal and cannot be imposed vicariously on company officials unless specifically provided by statute. Besides, Reliance Industries was found to have no connection with the telecom entities involved in the original transaction.

The High Court expressed concern over the conduct of the SDJM, maintaining that summons had been issued without adequate scrutiny despite the long litigation history.

More on business-standard.com



There are temples like the Pushkar temple, the only Brahma temple in the country, where married men are not allowed. There is also a temple in Kerala where the system is that men go dressed as women. I have read in detail that they go to beauty parlours, and their female family members help them dress in saris and other attire. Only males go there. So it is not a question of male-centric or female-centric religious beliefs. In the present case, it happens to be woman-centric," he submitted.

The arguments were made before a nine-judge Constitution Bench led by Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant, along with Justices B V Nagarathna, M M Sundresh, Ashwini Kumar, Augustine George Masih, Prasanna B Varale, R Mahadevan, and Joydip Bagchi, which is examining broader constitutional questions

she said, adding that her remarks were not confined to the Sabarimala dispute.

Senior Advocate CS Vaidyanathan, appearing in the matter, pointed to the existence of temples, particularly private ones, that restrict entry.

"Denominations also... if they want their denomination, they cannot seek funds from the State, private donors or the public because they are not dependent on footfall from others. The question is whether it is contrary to the constitutional prohibition. If it is not contrary to public order, morality, and health, what would be the realistic consequences?" he said.

Vaidyanathan also cautioned that Hindu institutions alone may be affected if Article 25(2)(b) is interpreted to override denominational rights under Article 26(b).

Justice Nagarathna noted that Article 25(2)(b) reflects historical

argument that it will have no effect on Article 26. But Article 26 itself is subject to public order, morality, and health. Article 17 (abolition of untouchability) is based on the principle of morality," the CJI said.

Responding, Vaidyanathan submitted that if a law satisfies those constitutional limitations, he would have no further objection.

The lead-up

The reference before the Constitution Bench arises from the court's September 2018 ruling, delivered by a five-judge Bench, which, by a 4:1 majority, permitted entry of women of all age groups into the Sabarimala shrine, overturning the earlier practice that excluded women of menstruating age. The verdict triggered widespread protests and led to multiple review petitions.

office to register AI artwork

BAHAVINI MISHRA
New Delhi, 9 April

The Delhi High Court (HC) on Thursday asked the copyright office to take a final call within eight weeks on a long-pending application seeking registration of an artwork created using artificial intelligence (AI). The direction came on a petition by Stephen Thaler, who is seeking copyright protection for the work titled "A Recent Entrance to Paradise". The artwork is claimed to have been generated autonomously by his AI system DABUS (Device for the Autonomous Bootstrapping of Unified Sentience).

Justice Tushar Rao Gedela disposed of the matter after

noting that the copyright office has fixed a hearing on the matter on April 27, 2026. The court instructed the Registrar of Copyrights to complete the adjudication process as expeditiously as possible, preferably within eight weeks from that date. The disputed work has been described as a surreal visual output produced without direct human intervention.

Thaler has maintained that the image is the result of independent creative processes carried out by the AI system. His application, filed in 2022, has remained undecided for nearly four years

now, prompting him to approach the court for directions.

At the centre of the dispute lies the key legal question of whether works generated entirely by AI can qualify for protection under the Copyright Act, 1957.

While the law recognises "computer-generated works", it does not explicitly address authorship by non-human entities, creating uncertainty in interpretation.

During scrutiny of the application, objections were raised on the ground that only a natural person can be recognised as an author under the existing law.

regulate children's social media use

In a significant policy move aimed at safeguarding children in the digital ecosystem, Andhra Pradesh Minister for Education, Information Technology and Electronics, Nara Lokesh, has directed officials to prepare a comprehensive regulatory framework to restrict access to social media for children below 13 years and to design an age-appropriate digital environment for teenagers.

Chairing a high-level Group of Ministers (GoM) meeting with senior officials and representatives from leading social media platforms at his Undavalli residence, the minister called for the drafting of legislation that balances digital access with child safety, creativity, and mental well-being.

Representatives from major social media platforms briefed the GoM on existing safeguards to restrict sensitive content and handle user complaints. They expressed willingness to collaborate closely with the Andhra Pradesh government in implementing these measures. Companies present at the meeting included Meta, Google, Grok, Snapchat, Sharechat, and Josh.

BS REPORTER

Bank of Baroda
TENDER NOTICE
Bank of Baroda, Head Office Baroda invites tenders through Government e-Marketplace GeM portal in two bid system. Technical Bid and Commercial Bid are invited from Eligible bidders for printing & dispatch of Self Service Pass Books (SSPB) for 3 years with extendable period of 1 year.
Detailed tender document is available in the Tenders section of Bank's website: <https://bankofbaroda.bank.in> and on GeM portal.
Any Addendum/Corrigendum including modification in the tender document shall be notified only on GeM portal and on Bank's website: <https://bankofbaroda.bank.in>.
Last date for submission of Tender is 05.05.2026
Place: Baroda General Manager (Operations & Services)
Date: 10.04.2026 Head Office, Baroda

SHAKUMBARI SUGAR
Cancellation of Extraordinary General Meeting
Notice is hereby given that the Extraordinary General Meeting (EGM) of the Members of Shakumbari Sugar & Allied Industries Limited, which was scheduled to be held on Saturday, April 11, 2026 at 11:00 A.M. through Video Conferencing ("VC")/Other Audio Visual Means ("OAVM") as well as physically at the Registered Office of the Company, has been cancelled.
The said meeting was convened by the Requestioner Shareholder under Section 100(4) of the Companies Act, 2013.
Accordingly, the aforesaid EGM will not be held as scheduled, and all concerned Members, Directors, Auditors and other stakeholders are requested to take note of the cancellation.
Any inconvenience caused in this regard is deeply regretted.
For and on behalf of the Requestioner
(Pursuant to Section 100(4) of the Companies Act, 2013)
Date: 9th April, 2026 Manpreet Kaur
Place: Chandigarh Regulatory Shareholder

IFB INDUSTRIES LIMITED
CIN: L51099IN174PLC22937
Regd. Office: 14, Taratala Road, Kolkata - 700098
Phone: 91 33 30489299, Fax: 91 33 30489230
Email: investor@ifbglobal.com, Website: www.ifbindustries.com
NOTICE OF SPECIAL WINDOW FOR TRANSFER AND DEMATERIALIZATION OF PHYSICAL SECURITIES
NOTICE IS HEREBY GIVEN THAT Securities Exchange Board of India ("SEBI") vide its circular dated July 02, 2025 has introduced a one-time special window for re-issuance of transfer requests for physical shares which was closed on January 06, 2026.
Further pursuant to SEBI Circular HQ/36/13/11(2)2026-MRSD-PDD/1(37)50/2026 dated 30th January, 2026 to facilitate ease of investing for investors and to secure the rights of the investors another special window has been opened for transfer and dematerialisation ("demat") of physical securities which were sold/purchased prior to April 01, 2019.
The special window shall also be available for such transfer requests which were submitted earlier and were rejected/returned/not attended to due to deficiency in the documents/processor/otherwise for a period of one year from February 05, 2026 to February 04, 2027.
Eligible shareholders may re-lodge their earlier requests with the Company's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent (RTA) C B Management Services (P) Ltd alongwith requisite documents rectifying the deficiency, if any, during the one-time special window period of one year i.e. from February 05, 2026 till February 04, 2027.
Shareholders are informed that pursuant to said circular the securities relogged for transfer shall be issued only in demat mode after following due process for such transfer-cum-demat requests.
Shareholders can send the documents on any address given below:
IFB INDUSTRIES LIMITED
The Company Secretary
Regd. Office: 14 Taratala Road
Kolkata - 700098
Ph: (033) 3048 9299
Email: investors@ifbglobal.com
We urge all the shareholders who had submitted transfer requests in the past and are yet to receive transferred shares due to deficiencies, to take benefit of this Special Window introduced in the benefit of the shareholders.
The detailed circular is also available on the website of the Company at www.ifbindustries.com
For IFB Industries Limited
Sd/-
(Ritesh Agarwal)
Company Secretary
Place: Kolkata
Date: 10.4.2026

Punjab & Sind Bank
(A Government of India Undertaking)
H.O. Provident Fund Department,
Bihartha Enclave, Ashoka Chowk, New Delhi-110014
Phone: 011 - 42418871 / 42418872
E-mail: ho.pf@punjab.bank.in
Where service is a way of life
Request for proposal Notice
Request for proposal is invited through GEM Portal (GEM/2026/B/7421614 dated 07.04.2026) for Group Personal Accident Insurance policy for the Serving Employees & In-service Whole Time Directors of Punjab & Sind Bank. The RFP (Request for Proposal) has been uploaded on the bank's website <https://punjabandsind.bank.in> and GEM portal <https://gem.gov.in/>. For tender details and future amendments, if any, keep referring to the following: <https://punjabandsind.bank.in> & on Government E-market Portal (GEM).
Assistant General Manager

PUBLIC NOTICE
NOTICE is given to the public at large that, we are investigating the right, title, share or interest of the Owner in / to the Property or any part thereof, in accordance to or under any sale, transfer, assignment, gift, exchange, lease, loan and license, tenancy, possession, use, occupation, trust, maintenance, easement, acquisition, requisition, right of development, right to utilize development potential, PFI consumption, power of attorney, in person, mortgage, lien, charge, hypothecation (including of receivables), pledge, guarantee, loans, debts, advances, inheritance, devise, bequest, partition, settlement, or under any corporate restructuring or restructuring (including under any merger, demerger, reabsorption, liquidation, or even otherwise), or under any attachment, injunction, decree, order, judgment, or award by any court of law, tribunal, revenue or statutory authority or arbitration or under any agreement, memorandum of understanding, term sheet and/or any other deed or document (either agitated in any litigation or otherwise) or any claim or demand which is adverse to or inconsistent with the right, title or interest of the Owner or even otherwise any other right, title, demand, claim or interest whatsoever to or in respect of or concerning the Property ("Claims") are hereby requested to make the same known in writing to the undersigned at Khaitan & Co., Advocates at One World Centre, Tower-1, 15th Floor, 841 Senapati Bapat Marg, Mumbai 400 013 and by email addressed to mumbai@khaitan.co (marked to the attention of Mr. Devendra Deshmukh) along with copies of all necessary supporting documents, within a period of 14 (fourteen) days from the date of publication hereof, failing which, it shall be presumed that no such Claims exist or that the claimant(s) has / have relinquished such Claims and/or such Claims have been waived or abandoned and / or not binding upon our client.
THE SCHEDULE REFERRED TO HEREINAFORE
(Description of the Property)
All that piece and parcel of demarcated portion of land admeasuring in the aggregate 20,174.16 square meters and comprising (i) Plot No 3 admeasuring 18,136.66 square meters and (ii) adjacent open space No 3 admeasuring 2,017.30 square meters from and out of demarcated portion of total land admeasuring 53,515.76 square meters forming part of a common layout approved by Pune Municipal Corporation on 13 January 2026 vide its letter bearing No. GC/3989/25, proposed to be developed on land admeasuring in the aggregate 96,600 square meters comprising portion of lands bearing Survey Nos 68/1, 68/2 and 68/3 and corresponding to CTS No. 2044 (formed by amalgamation of CTS Nos 2044, 2045, 2046, 2047, 2048, 2049 and 2050), situate at Village Mundhwa, Taluka Haveli, District Pune - 411036 and situate within limits of Registration District of Pune Registration Sub-District of Taluka Haveli Pune and situate within the limits of Pune Municipal Corporation and bounded as under:
On or towards the East : By Amenity Space 2 of Plot 3 and a portion of Plot 2;
On or towards the West : By 12-meter-wide DP road and a portion of Plot 2;
On or towards the North : By Plot 2 and adjacent Open Space 2; and
On or towards the South : By 12-meter-wide DP road and 12-meter-wide area under road
Dated this 10th day of April, 2026
For Khaitan & Co
Sd/-
Devendra Deshmukh
Partner

From Global Conflicts to Strategic Shifts, Stay Ahead With Insight Into What's Shaping the World.

Gain perspective on the decisions and developments shaping nations, markets, and industries, with in-depth analysis and clarity from Blueprint, helping you navigate a complex global landscape

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Business Standard
BLUEPRINT
DEFENCE & GEOPOLITICS
SLENDER HOPES
INDIA-CHINA RESET
PALESTINE
THE HYPERWAR IS HERE
Predictive AI is changing international conflict



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